

RAS Prelims 2026 · Handwritten Class Notes

Geography of Rajasthan

*Chapter-by-chapter notes in coaching-lecture style —
concept first, then the facts, with flow charts, mind
maps, previous-year callouts and current-affairs links.*

- RG01** *Location, Extent and Physiographic Divisions*
- RG02** *Drainage: Rivers and Lakes of Rajasthan*
- RG03** *Climate of Rajasthan*
- RG04** *Natural Vegetation and Forests of Rajasthan*
- RG05** *Soils of Rajasthan*
- RG06** *Biodiversity Conservation: Parks, Sanctuaries, Reserves*
- RG07** *Agriculture and Crops of Rajasthan*
- RG08** *Livestock, Dairy and Fisheries of Rajasthan*
- RG09** *Irrigation Projects and Canal Systems of Rajasthan*
- RG10** *Population, Urbanisation and Tribes of Rajasthan*
- RG11** *Minerals, Energy, Tourism and Transport of Rajasthan*

*RPSC RAS & RTS Preliminary Examination · 6 December 2026 · 150 questions · 200 marks · 1/3
negative marking*

RG01

Location, Extent and Physiographic Divisions

Rajasthan Geography is 11-15 questions in every paper and this chapter supplies 2-4 of them. Peaks, the Aravalli's extent, boundaries and the four physiographic divisions are the standing favourites; the district count has now become a current-affairs question as well.

This is the map chapter - where Rajasthan sits, who it touches, and how the land is built. RPSC asks it as pure recall: a number, a district, a peak height, a sub-region name. There is no reasoning to do here, only clean memorising, which makes it the cheapest block of marks in the whole Rajasthan Geography section.

Rajasthan - Location & Physiography

Size & extent

- 3,42,239 sq km = 10.41%
- Largest since 2000
- 826 km N-S, 869 km E-W
- 23-30 deg N, 69-78 deg E
- Tropic of Cancer -
Banswara, Dungarpur

Boundaries

- Pakistan 1,070 km - 4 districts
- Radcliffe Line, 1947
- MP longest ~1,600 km
- Punjab shortest ~89 km
- UP - Bharatpur and Dholpur only

Administrative

- 41 districts, 7 divisions
- December 2024 denotification
- Lalit K. Panwar committee
- 8 new districts retained

Western Sandy Plain (61%)

- Marusthali / Thar
- Bagar, Rohi, Nali
- Dunes - barchan, seif, parabolic
- Godwar, Shekhawati, Nagauri upland

Aravalli (9%)

- 692 km, 80% in Rajasthan
- Guru Shikhar 1,722 m, Sirohi
- Borat plateau, Girwa
- Passes - Desuri, Haldighati, Som

Eastern Plain (23%)

- Banas basin / Mewar plain
- Chambal beehad, Dang
- Chappan, Vagad, Kanthal

Hadoti Plateau (7%)

- Vindhyan scarpland
- Deccan lava, black soil
- Mukundara & Bundi hills
- Ukhalda, Vindhyan outliers

Size, shape and where exactly Rajasthan sits

Start with the numbers, because RPSC starts with the numbers. Rajasthan is the largest state of India by area - 3,42,239 sq km, which is 10.41 per cent of the country. It became the largest only on 1 November 2000, when Chhattisgarh was carved out of Madhya Pradesh and MP dropped to second. That date is asked on its own. In population Rajasthan is only seventh, so never mix the two ranks.

- Area 3,42,239 sq km = 10.41% of India's area. Largest state by area since 1 November 2000.
- Latitudinal extent 23 deg 3' N to 30 deg 12' N - a spread of 7 deg 9'.
- Longitudinal extent 69 deg 30' E to 78 deg 17' E - a spread of 8 deg 47'.
- North-south length 826 km; east-west length 869 km; difference exactly 43 km.
- Shape is roughly a rhombus or kite - wider than it is tall.
- The Tropic of Cancer (23.5 deg N) only grazes the extreme south - Banswara and Dungarpur districts.

The four extreme points - learn the village AND the district

Direction	Extreme point	District
North	Kona village	Sri Ganganagar
South	Borkunda village	Banswara
East	Silana village	Dholpur
West	Katra village	Jaisalmer

TRAP

Students flip the two lengths every time. North-SOUTH is 826 km, east-WEST is 869 km - the state is wider than it is tall, so the bigger number goes with east-west. Second trap: the Tropic of Cancer touches Banswara and Dungarpur ONLY; do not add Pratapgarh or Udaipur. Third: the easternmost point is in Dholpur, not Bharatpur.

YAAD RAKHO

Extreme points, clockwise from the top: KOna (north, Ganganagar), Silana (east, Dholpur), BOrkunda (south, Banswara), KAtra (west, Jaisalmer). KO-SI-BO-KA. Ganganagar on top, Banswara at the bottom, Dholpur on the right, Jaisalmer on the left - that is the whole map in one line.

The boundaries - one international, five inter-state

Rajasthan touches one country and five states. Take the international boundary first, because it is short, precise and endlessly asked. It is the Radcliffe Line, drawn on 17 August 1947, and in Rajasthan it runs 1,070 km from Hindumal Kot in Sri Ganganagar in the north to the Shahgarh bulge in Barmer in the south. Four districts front it.

- Pakistan border in Rajasthan = 1,070 km, the Radcliffe award of 17 August 1947.
- Runs from Hindumal Kot (Sri Ganganagar) in the north to the Shahgarh bulge (Barmer) in the south.
- Four border districts - Sri Ganganagar, Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Barmer. Jodhpur does NOT touch Pakistan.
- Jaisalmer has the longest stretch, about 464 km; Bikaner about 168 km.
- Jhalawar has the longest frontage on Madhya Pradesh (about 520 km) and Bhilwara the shortest (about 16 km).
- Udaipur has the longest frontage on Gujarat; Barmer the shortest (about 14 km).
- Districts facing two states at once - Hanumangarh (Punjab + Haryana), Bharatpur (Haryana + UP), Dholpur (UP + MP), Banswara (MP + Gujarat).
- Memory hook for the Pakistan border, north to south - GA-BI-JAI-BAR: Sri Ganganagar, Bikaner, JAIsalmer, BARmer.

The five neighbouring states - length and the districts that touch each

State	Approx. length	Districts of Rajasthan that touch it
Madhya Pradesh	~1,600 km (longest)	Dholpur, Karauli, Sawai Madhopur, Kota, Baran, Jhalawar, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh, Banswara
Haryana	~1,262 km	Hanumangarh, Churu, Jhunjhunu, Sikar, Jaipur, Alwar, Bharatpur

State	Approx. length	Districts of Rajasthan that touch it
Gujarat	~1,022 km	Barmer, Jalore, Sirohi, Udaipur, Dungarpur, Banswara
Uttar Pradesh	~877 km	Bharatpur, Dholpur
Punjab	~89 km (shortest)	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh

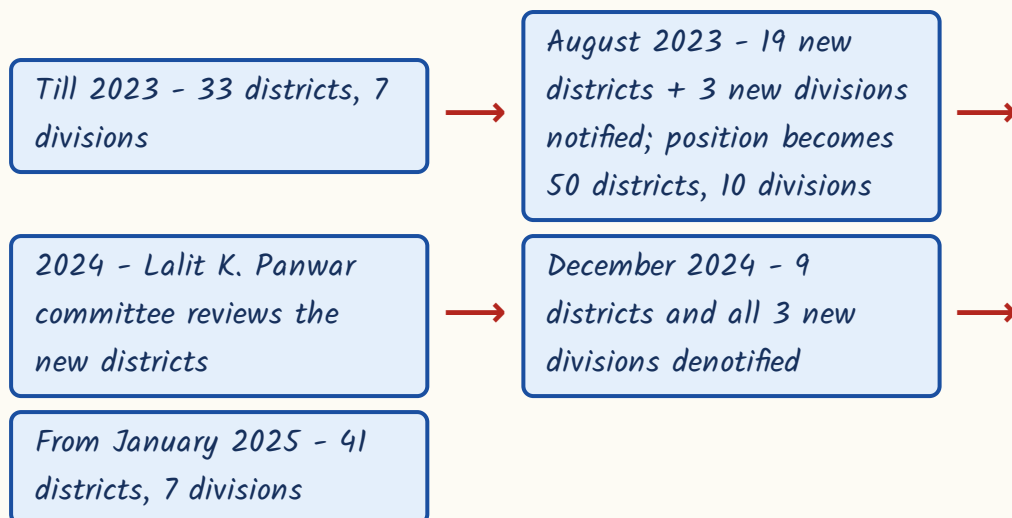
TRAP

Uttar Pradesh touches only TWO districts - Bharatpur and Dholpur - and that is the standard RPSC answer. Be aware the 2023 reorganisation carved Deeg out of Bharatpur, so newer state maps also show Deeg fronting UP and Haryana; the classic two-district answer still stands. Separately, the Haryana list is drawn on the pre-2023 names - Jaipur's frontage now belongs to Kotputli-Behror and part of Alwar's to Khairthal-Tijara.

The administrative map as it stands now - 41 districts, 7 divisions

This is the most volatile part of the chapter, so pin a date to it. Rajasthan had 33 districts and 7 divisions for years. In August 2023 the state notified 19 new districts and 3 new divisions, taking the position to 50 districts and 10 divisions. The next government set up a review committee under Lalit K. Panwar. On its report, in December 2024, nine of those districts and all three new divisions were denotified. The position that took effect from January 2025 - and the one you write in the exam - is 41 districts and 7 divisions.

How Rajasthan got to 41 districts



- The 7 divisions are Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer, Kota, Udaipur, Bikaner and Bharatpur.
- The 3 divisions created in 2023 and abolished in 2024 were Banswara, Pali and Sikar.
- Eight new districts **RETAINED** - Balotra, Beawar, Deeg, Didwana-Kuchaman, Khairthal-Tijara, Kotputli-Behror, Phalodi, Salumbar.
- Nine **DENOTIFIED** - Anupgarh, Dudu, Gangapur City, Jaipur Rural, Jodhpur Rural, Kekri, Neem ka Thana, Sanchore, Shahpura.
- Net effect: $33 + 8 = 41$ districts.
- Place names that moved - Pachpadra is now in Balotra (erstwhile Barmer); Khichan and Bhadla in Phalodi (erstwhile Jodhpur); Makrana, Didwana and Kuchaman in Didwana-Kuchaman (erstwhile Nagaur).

YAAD RAKHO

The eight survivors in alphabetical order run B-B-D-D-K-K-P-S: Balotra, Beawar, Deeg, Didwana-Kuchaman, Khairthal-Tijara, Kotputli-Behror, Phalodi, Salumbar. Four pairs of initials. If a district name is not on that list and did not exist in 2022, it does not exist today.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Rajasthan stands at 41 districts and 7 divisions, in force since January 2025. Get the two committees straight - the 2023 creation followed the Ram Lubhaya committee, the December 2024 denotification followed the Lalit K. Panwar committee. Any option saying 50 districts or 10 divisions is testing whether you have updated. District creation is a live political issue in the state, so re-check the count in November 2026.

Cultural regions - RPSC often asks place-to-region, not place-to-district

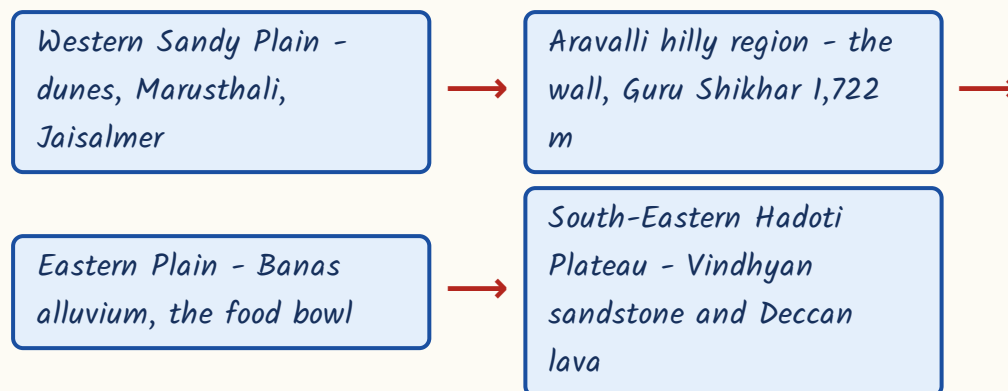
Region	Core districts
Marwar	Jodhpur, Pali, Nagaur
Mewar	Udaipur, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh, Rajsamand
Hadoti	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar
Shekhawati	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Churu
Dhundhar	Jaipur
Mewat	Alwar, Bharatpur (the Deeg belt)
Braj	Bharatpur, Dholpur
Vagad	Dungarpur, Banswara
Godwar	Pali, Sirohi, Jalore
Kanthal	Pratapgarh

The four physiographic divisions - the spine of this chapter

Everything else in Rajasthan geography hangs off these four divisions. Learn them west to east, because that is how the land actually changes as you walk across the state - sand first, then the Aravalli wall, then the fertile plain, then the plateau. Learn area share and population share as a pair, because RPSC asks them as a paired statement question. Read the table as a story: the west has

almost two-thirds of the land and only two-fifths of the people, because it is desert. The eastern plain has under a quarter of the land and almost the same number of people, because it is watered and farmed. One line carries all four: area 61 - 23 - 9 - 7, population 40 - 39 - 10 - 11. The population figures for the top two are nearly equal while the area figures are miles apart - that gap IS the desert.

A west-to-east walk across Rajasthan



The four divisions - area and population share

Division	Share of area	Share of population
Western Sandy Plain	about 61%	about 40%
Eastern Plain	about 23%	about 39%
Aravalli hilly region	about 9%	about 10%
South-Eastern Hadoti Plateau	about 7% (smallest)	about 11%

Western Sandy Plain vs Eastern Plain - the contrast RPSC loves

Western Sandy Plain	Eastern Plain
West and north-west of the Aravalli	East and south-east of the Aravalli
About 61% of the area, about 40% of the people	About 23% of the area, about 39% of the people
Rainfall below 50 cm; much of it below 25 cm	Rainfall roughly 50-100 cm
Sandy, desert and saline soils	Alluvial soils - the most fertile in the state
Drainage internal or seasonal - Luni, Kantli, Ghaggar, Kakni	Drained by the Banas, Chambal and Mahi systems
Sub-units - Marusthali, Bagar, Nali, Shekhawati, Nagauri upland, Godwar	Sub-units - Banas basin (Mewar and Malpura-Karauli plains), Chambal beehad, Mahi basin
Lowest population density; Jaisalmer the emptiest district	Highest densities; Jaipur, Bharatpur, Dholpur crowded
Bajra, moth and guar; pastoralism dominant	Wheat, gram and mustard; canal and well irrigation

Division I - the Western Sandy Plain (Thar)

This is the Thar, called Marusthali in the older books. It is India's largest desert. Inside Rajasthan it stretches roughly 640 km north-east to south-west and is 300 to 360 km wide. Do not picture one flat sheet of sand. It has a genuinely arid western half and a semi-arid eastern half, and almost every question comes from the sub-region names. The arid west - rainfall under 25 cm - is the true Marusthali: Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner and the Phalodi belt, with the 'Desert Triangle' of Jodhpur-Jaisalmer-Bikaner at its heart. Bhadla in Phalodi district (erstwhile Jodhpur) sits on this plain and now carries the world's largest solar park. Local terms worth knowing: rocky floors are 'magra', sandy expanses 'dhran', low salt depressions 'ranns' or 'tals'.

The semi-arid Bagar and its four sub-regions

East of the true desert rainfall climbs past 25 cm and cultivation becomes possible. That strip is the Bagar - written Bangar in some texts, and the two words mean the same tract here. The cultivated land within it is called Rohi. Four named sub-regions sit inside the Bagar and every one of them has been examined.

Sub-regions of the semi-arid Bagar

Sub-region	Where	Marker
Ghaggar plain	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh	Locally called 'Nali'; Kalibangan stands on it
Shekhawati - Torawati	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Churu	Internal drainage; the Kantli dies here
Nagauri upland	Nagaur, Didwana-Kuchaman	Saline depressions - Didwana, Kuchaman
Luni basin / Godwar	Pali, Sirohi, Jalore	The most humid part of the western plain

Sand dunes of Rajasthan

Dune type	Shape / how it forms	Where
Barchan	Crescent, formed transverse to the wind, horns point downwind	Shekhawati and the Churu belt
Longitudinal (seif)	Long ridges lying PARALLEL to the wind	Maximum in Jaisalmer
Transverse	Ridges at right angles to the wind	Scattered in the western plain
Parabolic	U-shaped, horns point UPWIND - the reverse of a barchan	Bikaner belt
Star	Many arms; forms where wind blows from several directions	Pokhran, Mohangarh

Dune type	Shape / how it forms	Where
Coppice / Nabkha	Sand piled around a bush or shrub	All over the desert

TRAP

Barchan and parabolic are mirror images and RPSC exploits it. Barchan horns point DOWNWIND; parabolic horns point UPWIND. Longitudinal dunes lie PARALLEL to the wind, transverse dunes lie ACROSS it. So a statement reading 'parabolic dunes are crescent-shaped with horns pointing downwind' is false - that describes a barchan. Memory hook: longitudinal is the long word for the long dune with its maximum in the longest desert district, Jaisalmer.

Division 2 - the Aravalli and the hilly region

The Aravalli is the oldest fold mountain range in India - a Pre-Cambrian range worn down to stumps, which is why it is called a relict range. It runs south-west to north-east for about 692 km, from Palanpur in Gujarat through Rajasthan to Delhi, and roughly 80 per cent of that length lies in Rajasthan. It is broad and high in the south, near 150 km wide around Sirohi and Udaipur, and thins into a broken chain of ridges near Jaipur and Alwar - barely 10 km wide by Delhi. Its north-eastern margin is marked by the Great Boundary Fault, where the Aravalli rocks meet the Vindhyan sandstone.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 as a three-statement set - the Aravalli is India's oldest fold mountain range; it runs SW-NE for about 692 km; about 80 per cent of it lies in Rajasthan. All three correct. Aravalli extent has returned in 2018, 2023 and 2024. Learn 692 and 80 per cent as a pair.

The four blocks of the Aravalli, south to north

Block	Districts	What defines it
Abu block (south-west end)	Sirohi	A detached granite mass, an inselberg; Guru Shikhar, Ser, Delwara, Achalgarh; Nakki lake; Rajasthan's only hill station
Southern / Mewar hills	Udaipur, Rajsamand, Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh	Highest and widest; Jarga and Kumbhalgarh; Bhorat plateau; the Girwa basin around Udaipur
Central / Merwara hills	Ajmer, Beawar, Pali, Bhilwara	Narrow ridges; Todgarh, Taragarh, Nag Pahar; divides Marwar from Mewar; most passes lie here
Northern / Alwar-Torawati hills	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Jaipur, Alwar	Broken, low and discontinuous; Raghunathgarh, Malkhet, Khoh, Harshnath, Bairath

Peaks of the Aravalli – the single highest-peak table in this chapter

Peak	Height (m)	District
Guru Shikhar	1,722	Sirohi - highest in Rajasthan and in the whole Aravalli
Ser	1,597	Sirohi - second highest
Delwara	1,442	Sirohi
Jarga	1,431	Udaipur - highest in Udaipur
Achalgarh	1,380	Sirohi
Kumbhalgarh	1,224	Rajsamand
Raghunathgarh	1,055	Sikar - highest peak of Shekhawati
Malkhet	1,052	Sikar
Todgarh (Morarji)	934	Ajmer belt - Todgarh now falls in Beawar district
Khoh	920	Jaipur - highest in Jaipur district
Taragarh	873	Ajmer
Harshnath	820	Sikar
Nag Pahar	795	Ajmer - the Luni rises here
Bairath / Bhairach	792	Alwar

ASKED IN RAS

Three separate appearances of this one table. RAS Pre 2018 - Guru Shikhar's district and height (Sirohi, 1,722 m). RAS Pre 2016 - peak-to-district matching (Jarga-Udaipur, Kumbhalgarh-Rajsamand, Taragarh-Ajmer, Delwara-Sirohi). RAS Pre 2024 - peak-to-height matching (Guru Shikhar 1,722, Ser 1,597, Achalgarh 1,380, Raghunathgarh 1,055). Descending-order questions come from the same six names.

YAAD RAKHO

Descending order of the big six - G, S, D, J, A, K: Guru Shikhar, Ser, Delwara, Jarga, Achalgarh, Kumbhalgarh. Four of the six are in Sirohi; the two exceptions are Jarga (Udaipur) and Kumbhalgarh (Rajsamand). That one sentence answers most ordering and matching questions on peaks.

TRAP

Harshnath is in SIKAR, not Alwar; Bairath peak is in Alwar. RPSC has used exactly that pair in a 'not correctly matched' question. Guru Shikhar is in Sirohi, never Udaipur - Udaipur's highest is Jarga. And 692 km is the TOTAL Aravalli length, Palanpur to Delhi, not its length inside Rajasthan.

- Bhorat plateau, about 1,225 m, lies between Gogunda and Kumbhalgarh - the highest plateau of Rajasthan.
- Girwa is the saucer-shaped basin around Udaipur, ringed by hills - an Aravalli feature, not a plains feature.
- Passes are called 'nal' or 'dara' - Desuri Nal (the main Marwar-Mewar crossing, Pali side), Haldighati (Rajsamand-Udaipur, battle of 1576), Som, Deobari, Kevada ki Nal, Pipli, Hathi Guda.
- Most passes lie in the central Aravalli, where the range is narrowest.

- Mount Abu (Sirohi) is Rajasthan's only hill station and carries both Guru Shikhar and Nakki lake.

Division 3 – the Eastern Plain

East of the Aravalli the land flattens into alluvium. This is Rajasthan's agricultural heart – under a quarter of the area but nearly two-fifths of the people. Three river basins carve it up, and the sub-region names come straight out of those basins.

- Banas basin – the Mewar plain in its upper part (Bhilwara, Chittorgarh, Rajsamand) and the Malpura-Karauli plain lower down (Tonk, Sawai Madhopur, Karauli).
- Bisalpur dam on the Banas at Todaraisingh (Tonk) waters Jaipur, Ajmer and Tonk from this plain.
- Chambal basin – the river has cut deep gullies into soft alluvium, the ravines or 'beehad'.
- The beehad is best developed in Dholpur, Karauli and Sawai Madhopur; the whole ravine tract is also called 'Dang'.
- Mahi basin – the southern end of the plain, running into the tribal belt.

Mahi basin sub-regions

Region	Districts	Meaning / marker
Chappan plain	Banswara, Pratapgarh	'Chappan' = 56 – named for its 56 streams or villages
Vagad	Dungarpur, Banswara	The Bhil tribal heartland; the Beneshwar fair site
Kanthal	Pratapgarh	The southernmost tract, on the Madhya Pradesh border

TRAP

Three names, three traps. Chappan is Banswara-Pratapgarh, NOT Dungarpur. Vagad is Dungarpur-Banswara. Kanthal is Pratapgarh alone. And the Girwa is an Aravalli feature around Udaipur - a statement that places Girwa in the Eastern Plain is false, and RPSC has set exactly that.

Division 4 - the South-Eastern Hadoti Plateau

The smallest division, about 7 per cent of the state, but geologically the most distinctive. It is called the Hadoti or Pathar plateau and it sits in the south-east - Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar and the Vindhyan belt to their north. It has two clearly different halves, and the exam asks you to separate them.

The two halves of the Hadoti plateau

Vindhyan scarpland	Deccan lava plateau
Lies between the Banas and the Chambal	Lies south and east of the Chambal
Karauli, Sawai Madhopur, Bundi and northern Kota	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar
Vindhyan sandstone, 350-550 m	Basalt - the northern edge of the Deccan Trap
Red and sandy soils; stone quarrying	Black cotton soil - Rajasthan's soybean belt
Scarps and flat-topped sandstone ridges	Rolling lava-capped uplands

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a statement set - the Vindhyan scarpland lies between the Banas and the Chambal; the Deccan lava plateau of Rajasthan has black soil; the Mukundara hills form part of this division. All three correct. The 'between the Banas and the Chambal' wording repeats verbatim, so memorise it in those words.

- Mukundara and the Bundi hills are the arc-shaped ranges of the Hadoti plateau.
- The Chittorgarh plateau and Bhainsrorgarh lie on the western edge of this division.
- 'Dang' - the ravine tract of Dholpur, Karauli and Sawai Madhopur - forms its northern fringe.
- 'Ukhalda' is the local name for the pitted, pot-holed rocky surface of the plateau.
- Detached Vindhyan sandstone hills stand beyond the main scarp in the Karauli-Dholpur belt - the Vindhyan outliers.

TRAP

The Bhorat plateau is NOT part of the Hadoti plateau. Bhorat sits in the Aravalli, between Gogunda and Kumbhalgarh, at about 1,225 m, and it is the highest plateau of Rajasthan. Hadoti is the low south-eastern plateau. RPSC has planted 'Bhorat' as the wrong option in a 'which is NOT part of the South-Eastern plateau' question.

Rocks, the rain-shadow logic, and the last-minute sweep

Two more things get asked and neither takes long. First the rocks. Rajasthan's foundation is Pre-Cambrian - the Aravalli Supergroup and the Delhi Supergroup - overlain by Vindhyan sandstone in the south-east and Deccan basalt in the Hadoti corner. The Malani igneous suite of the Jodhpur-Barmer belt is among the oldest volcanic rock formations in India. Marble, including Makrana marble from Didwana-Kuchaman district (erstwhile Nagaur), comes out of these old metamorphic rocks, and so does the state's lead-zinc, copper and rock-phosphate wealth.

Second, why the west is dry. The Aravalli runs south-west to north-east - which is very nearly PARALLEL to the direction the Arabian Sea branch of the south-west monsoon travels. A mountain only wrings rain out of a wind when it stands ACROSS the wind. The Aravalli stands alongside it. So the moist air slides past the range without being forced up, and the west stays dry while the eastern slopes and the plateau get the rain. That is the entire explanation, and it is set as an assertion-reason question.

ASKED IN RAS

Assertion-reason, in this exact shape - Assertion: the western part of Rajasthan is far drier than the eastern part. Reason: the Aravalli lies parallel to the path of the south-west monsoon's Arabian Sea branch and fails to obstruct it. Both true, and the reason IS the correct explanation. The load-bearing word is 'parallel'.

YAAD RAKHO

Last-week sweep, one breath: 3,42,239 sq km, 10.41 per cent, largest since 2000. 826 north-south, 869 east-west, difference 43. Pakistan 1,070 km, four districts, Jaisalmer longest. MP longest state border, Punjab shortest. 41 districts, 7 divisions. Divisions 61-23-9-7 by area. Guru Shikhar 1,722 m, Sirohi. Aravalli 692 km, 80 per cent in Rajasthan.

REVISION RECAP

1. Area 3,42,239 sq km = 10.41% of India; largest state by area since 1 November 2000.
2. Latitude 23 deg 3' N - 30 deg 12' N; longitude 69 deg 30' E - 78 deg 17' E.
3. 826 km north-south, 869 km east-west, difference 43 km; shape a rhombus.
4. Extreme points - Kona (Sri Ganganagar) N, Borkunda (Banswara) S, Silana (Dholpur) E, Katra (Jaisalmer) W.
5. Tropic of Cancer clips only Banswara and Dungarpur.
6. Pakistan border 1,070 km along the Radcliffe Line, Hindumal Kot to the Shahgarh bulge; four districts, Jaisalmer longest at about 464 km.

7. MP longest state border (~1,600 km), Punjab shortest (~89 km); UP touches only Bharatpur and Dholpur.
8. As of September 2026 Rajasthan has 41 districts and 7 divisions - 9 districts and 3 divisions denotified in December 2024 on the Lalit K. Panwar committee's report.
9. Retained new districts - Balotra, Beawar, Deeg, Didwana-Kuchaman, Khairthal-Tijara, Kotputli-Behror, Phalodi, Salumbar.
10. Division shares by area - Western Sandy Plain 61%, Eastern Plain 23%, Aravalli 9%, Hadoti 7%; by population 40, 39, 10, 11.
11. Thar is India's largest desert; desert triangle Jodhpur-Jaisalmer-Bikaner; the Ghaggar plain is locally 'Nali'.
12. Dunes - barchan horns downwind, longitudinal parallel to the wind and commonest in Jaisalmer, parabolic horns upwind, star dunes at Pokhran-Mohangarh.
13. Aravalli - India's oldest fold range, 692 km SW-NE, about 80% in Rajasthan, Great Boundary Fault on its north-eastern margin.
14. Peak order - Guru Shikhar 1,722, Ser 1,597, Delwara 1,442, Jarga 1,431, Achalgarh 1,380, Kumbhalgarh 1,224.
15. Peak districts - Guru Shikhar/Ser/Delwara/Achalgarh in Sirohi, Jarga in Udaipur, Kumbhalgarh in Rajsamand, Raghunathgarh and Harshnath in Sikar, Bairath in Alwar.
16. Bhorat (about 1,225 m) is the highest plateau, in the Aravalli; Girwa is the Udaipur saucer; Mount Abu is the only hill station.
17. Passes - Desuri Nal, Haldighati, Som, Deobari, Kevada ki Nal; most lie in the central Aravalli.
18. Eastern Plain - Mewar and Malpura-Karauli plains on the Banas, Chambal beehad in Dholpur-Karauli-Sawai Madhopur, Mahi basin with Chappan (S6), Vagad and Kanthal.
19. Hadoti - Vindhyan scarpland between the Banas and the Chambal plus the black-soil Deccan lava plateau; Mukundara and Bundi hills; Ukhaldia surface; Vindhyan outliers in the Karauli-Dholpur belt.
20. The Aravalli runs parallel to the Arabian Sea monsoon branch and so fails to block it - that is why western Rajasthan is dry.

RG02

Drainage: Rivers and Lakes of Rajasthan

3-5 questions a paper out of the 11-15 that Rajasthan Geography carries. The Banas and its Triveni Sangam at Bigod is a documented repeat (2013, 2021, 2023, 2024); Sambhar and the Ramsar sites are a second standing cluster; Chambal dam ordering and Luni tributaries fill the rest.

Rivers and lakes are the highest-scoring block in Rajasthan Geography because the questions are matching questions - river to origin, river to tributary, lake to district, lake to builder. The Banas alone has appeared in four papers. Build the tables once, revise them weekly, and this chapter pays every year.

Drainage of Rajasthan

Bay of Bengal

- Chambal - only perennial
- Banas - longest wholly inside
- Kali Sindh, Parvati, Parwan
- Mej, Berach, Kothari, Morel

Arabian Sea

- Luni - Rann of Kutch
- Mahi - Gulf of Khambhat
- Sabarmati, West Banas
- Som, Jakham, Anas

Internal (about 60%)

- Ghaggar - mrit nadi
- Kantli, Kakni (17 km)
- Sabi to Najafgarh jheel
- Banganga, Ruparel

Trivenis

- Bigod (Bhilwara) - Banas + Berach + Menali
- Beneshwar (Dungarpur) - Mahi + Som + Jakham

Freshwater lakes

- Jaisamand - Asia's largest artificial
- Rajsamand - Raj Prashasti
- Pichola, Fateh Sagar, Udai Sagar
- Nakki - highest, freezes
- Ana Sagar, Foy Sagar, Pushkar

Saline lakes

- Sambhar - largest inland saline
- Pachpadra (Balotra) - purest salt
- Didwana - sodium sulphate
- Lunkaransar, Kuchaman, Talchhapar

Ramsar (5 sites)

- Keoladeo 1981
- Sambhar 1990
- Menar 2025
- Khichan 2025
- Siliserh 2025

Dams & falls

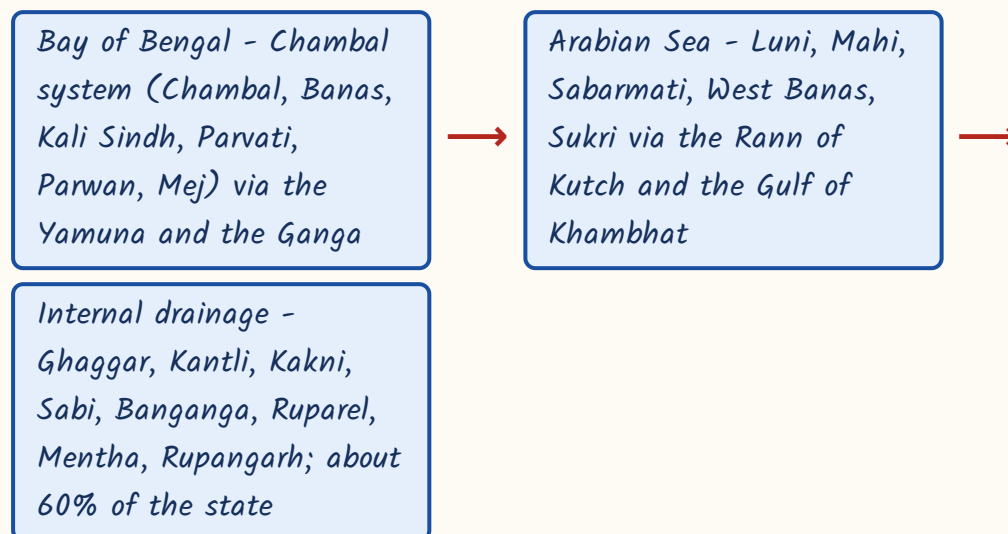
- Gandhi Sagar to Kota Barrage
- Bisalpur, Jawai, Jakham
- Chulia, Menal, Bhimlat, Damoh

Three destinations – sort every river before you learn a single

name

Do not start by memorising rivers. Start by asking where the water finally goes. Every river of Rajasthan ends in one of three places – the Bay of Bengal, the Arabian Sea, or nowhere at all. That third bucket is the big one: roughly 60 per cent of Rajasthan has internal or inland drainage, which means the water sinks into sand or evaporates in a salt flat and never reaches any sea. That single figure explains the salt lakes, the ephemeral rivers and half the questions in this chapter.

Sort first, then learn



- Bay of Bengal system drains the east and south-east; the Aravalli is the broad divide.
- Arabian Sea system drains the west and the south.
- Internal drainage covers about 60 per cent of the area – the whole western and Shekhawati belt.
- The Chambal is the ONLY perennial river of Rajasthan; everything else is seasonal.
- The Banas is the longest river flowing entirely within Rajasthan – 512 km.

- The Kakni (Masurdi) of Jaisalmer is the shortest, about 17 km.

YAAD RAKHO

Sort by the last letter of the destination. If it reaches a SEA it is either Chambal-family (east, so Bay of Bengal) or Luni/Mahi-family (west and south, so Arabian Sea). If it just stops - Ghaggar, Kantli, Kakni, Sabi, Banganga, Ruparel - it is internal. Six internal names, and five of them start with a hard consonant: G-K-K-S-B-R.

TRAP

Two constant confusions. First - longest river IN Rajasthan versus longest river flowing ENTIRELY WITHIN Rajasthan. The Chambal is longer overall but is not wholly inside the state; the answer to 'entirely within' is always the Banas. Second - the Berach and the Morel feel like western rivers but they are Banas tributaries, so they belong to the Bay of Bengal system, not to internal drainage.

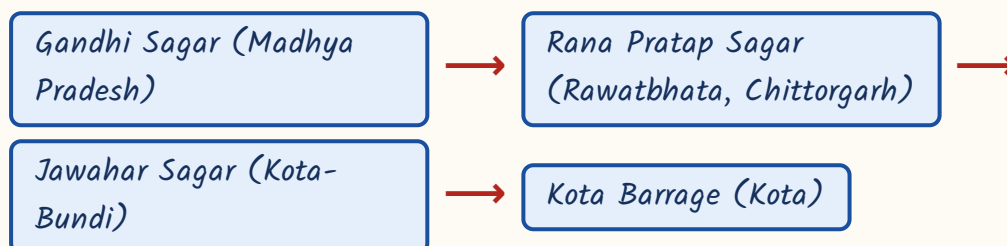
The Bay of Bengal system - Chambal and its family

The Chambal is the backbone of eastern Rajasthan. Its ancient name is Charmanyavati. It rises at the Janapav hills near Mhow in Indore district of Madhya Pradesh, enters Rajasthan at Chaurasigarh in Chittorgarh, runs north-east, forms a long stretch of the Rajasthan-Madhya Pradesh border, and finally joins the Yamuna in Etawah district of Uttar Pradesh. It is the only perennial river of Rajasthan - the only one that carries water all year - and that is why every big Chambal project sits on it.

Bay of Bengal system - origin, tributaries, outfall

River	Origin	Main tributaries	Falls into
Chambal (Charmanyavati)	Janapav hills, Mhow, Indore district, MP	Banas, Kali Sindh, Parvati, Parwan, Mej, Kural, Chhoti Kali Sindh, Brahmani, Aalaniya, Chakan, Retam, Shipra, Kunu	Yamuna, in Etawah district, UP
Banas	Khamnor hills, Rajsamand	Berach, Kothari, Menali, Khari, Dai, Dheel, Sohadara, Morel, Bandi, Mansi	Chambal at Rameshwar Ghat, Sawai Madhopur
Berach (ancient Ayad)	Gogunda hills, Udaipur	Gambhiri, Wagli	Banas at Bigod, Bhilwara
Kothari	Diver, Rajsamand	-	Banas at Bhilwara; Meja dam built on it
Morel	Chainpura hills, Jaipur	Dheel	Banas, in Sawai Madhopur
Kali Sindh	Bagli hills, Dewas district, MP	Parwan, Aahu, Niwaj	Chambal at Nonera, Kota
Parvati	Vindhyan hills, Sehore district, MP	-	Chambal, on the Baran-Sawai Madhopur side
Mej	Bundi hills	Mangli	Chambal, on the Bundi-Sawai Madhopur border

The four Chambal dams, upstream to downstream - an ordering question in its own right



- Chulia waterfall lies on the Chambal near Bhainsrorgarh, Chittorgarh.
- The Chambal ravines - 'beehad' - scar Dholpur, Karauli and Sawai Madhopur.

- The National Chambal Sanctuary on this stretch protects the gharial and the Gangetic dolphin.
- Kali Sindh joins at Nonera (Kota); Parvati and Parwan both enter Rajasthan from Madhya Pradesh.
- The Chambal is a LEFT-bank tributary of the Yamuna; the Banas is a RIGHT-bank tributary of the Chambal.

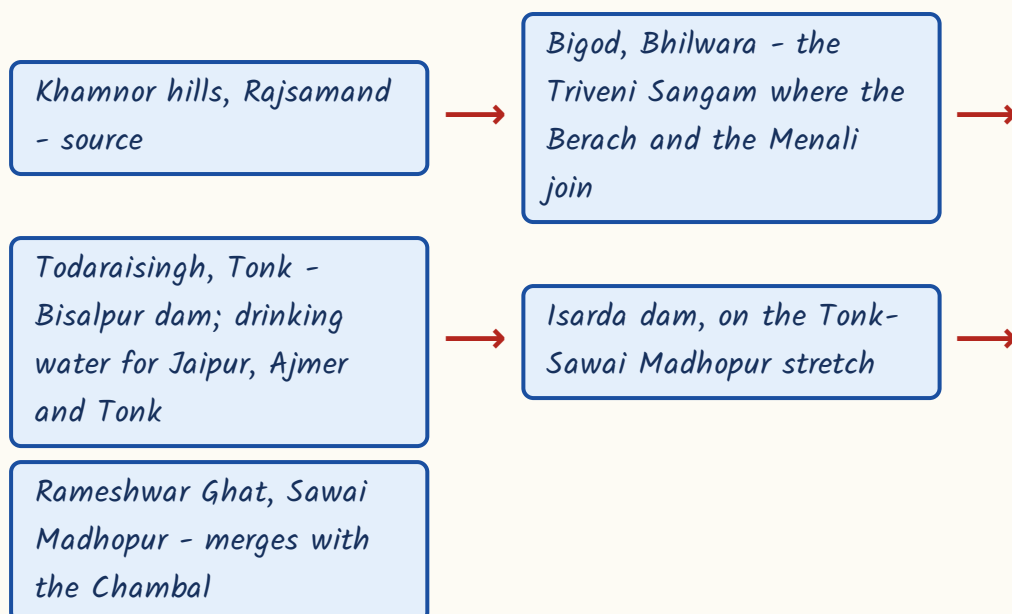
ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 as a negative question - which of these is NOT a tributary of the Chambal? The answer was Jojri, because the Jojri belongs to the Luni. Chambal dam ordering (Gandhi Sagar - Rana Pratap Sagar - Jawahar Sagar - Kota Barrage) is the other standing question from this section. Memory hook for the dams: GA-RA-JA-KO.

Banas - the documented repeat, learn this section cold

If you learn one river completely, make it the Banas. RPSC has asked it in 2013, 2021, 2023 and 2024 - four papers. The name means 'Van ki Asha', the hope of the forest. It rises in the Khamnor hills of the Aravalli in Rajsamand district, runs 512 km, and joins the Chambal at Rameshwar Ghat in Sawai Madhopur. It is the longest river flowing entirely within Rajasthan and it never leaves the state. Its whole basin is the Mewar plain.

The Banas from source to mouth - every stop has been asked



- Tributaries - Berach, Kothari, Menali, Khari, Dai, Dheel, Sohadara, Morel, Bandi, Mansi.
- Berach rises in the Gogunda hills, Udaipur; its ancient name is Ayad; Udai Sagar lake lies on it.
- Kothari rises at Diver in Rajsamand and feeds the Meja dam in Bhilwara.
- Bisalpur is the single most important drinking-water source of eastern Rajasthan.
- The Banas is a right-bank tributary of the Chambal, so all its water eventually reaches the Bay of Bengal.

ASKED IN RAS

The repeat cluster in full. RAS Pre 2013 - the Banas originates from the Khamnor hills. RAS Pre 2021 - the Triveni Sangam at Bigod in Bhilwara is formed by the Banas, Berach and Menali. RAS Pre 2023 - the longest river flowing entirely within Rajasthan is the Banas. RAS Pre 2024 - the Banas merges with the Chambal at Rameshwar Ghat, Sawai Madhopur, and a three-statement set on its origin, tributaries and right-bank status.

YAAD RAKHO

Two Trivenis, two mnemonics. BIGOD = B-B-M: Banas + Berach + Menali, in Bhilwara. BENESHWAR = M-S-J: Mahi + Som + Jakham, in Dungarpur. Bigod begins with B and all three of its rivers begin with B or M-for-Menali; Beneshwar is the tribal fair site, so it goes with the tribal river, the Mahi.

TRAP

Do not swap the two Trivenis. Bigod (Bhilwara) is Banas-Berach-Menali. Beneshwar (Dungarpur) is Mahi-Som-Jakham. And the Menali joins the Banas - it is not a Luni tributary, however much the name sounds western. RPSC has used Menali as the wrong option in a Luni-tributary question.

The Arabian Sea system - Luni, Mahi, Sabarmati, West Banas

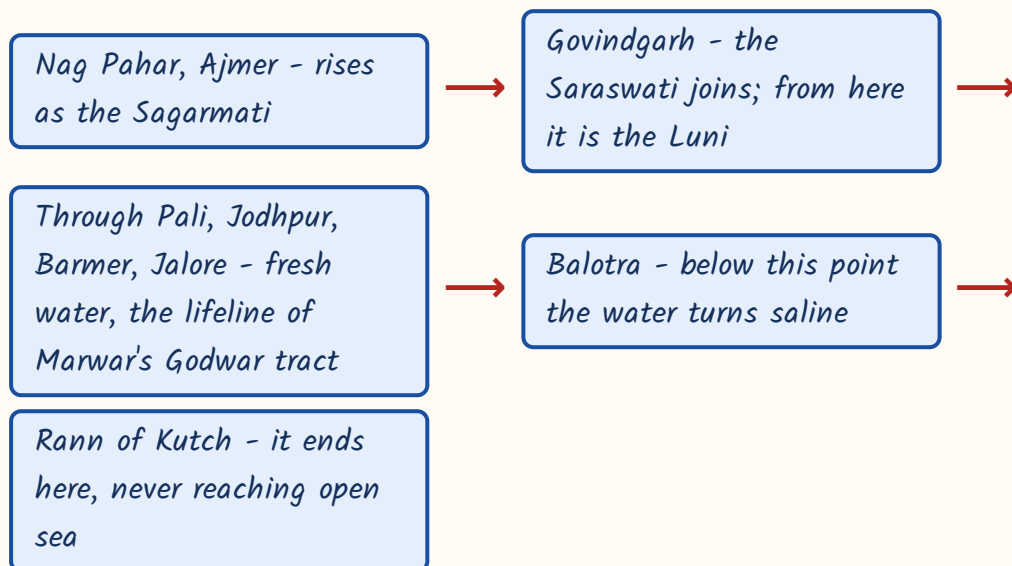
West and south of the Aravalli the water heads for the Arabian Sea. Two rivers matter most. The Luni is the great river of the desert - its ancient name is Lavanavari, the salt-bearer. It begins on the Nag Pahar or Naga hills near Ajmer as the Sagarmati, is joined by the Saraswati at Govindgarh, and from there is called the Luni. It runs about 495 km and ends not in open sea but in the Rann of Kutch. The Mahi is the tribal river of the south - it rises at Amjhera near Mehad in Dhar district of Madhya Pradesh, runs 576 km in all with about 171 km inside Rajasthan, and empties into the Gulf of Khambhat.

Arabian Sea system - origin, tributaries, outfall

River	Origin	Main tributaries	Falls into
Luni (Lavanavari)	Nag Pahar / Naga hills near Ajmer, as the Sagarmati; the Saraswati joins at Govindgarh	Jojri (only left bank); Sukri, Mithri, Bandi, Jawai, Guhiya, Sagi, Khari (all right bank)	Rann of Kutch

River	Origin	Main tributaries	Falls into
Mahi	Amjhera / Mehad, Dhar district, MP	Som, Jakham, Anas, Eru, Chap, Moran	Gulf of Khambhat
Som	Bichhamera hills, Udaipur	Jakham, Gomti	Mahi at Beneshwar, Dungarpur
Jakham	Bhanwar Mata hills, Pratapgarh	-	Som; Jakham dam is Rajasthan's highest dam (about 81 m)
Sabarmati	Padrada hills, Udaipur	Wakal, Sei, Harnav	Gulf of Khambhat - only about 45 km of it is in Rajasthan
West Banas	Aravalli near Sirohi	Sukli	Little Rann of Kutch
Jawai	Goramji hills, Pali (Aravalli)	-	Luni; Jawai dam at Sumerpur is western Rajasthan's largest

The Luni - sweet at the top, salty at the bottom



Chambal vs Luni - the eastern river against the western river

Chambal	Luni
Bay of Bengal system	Arabian Sea system
Rises outside Rajasthan, at Janapav, MP	Rises inside Rajasthan, at Nag Pahar, Ajmer
Perennial - the only one in the state	Seasonal; dries to a trickle in summer
Ends in the Yamuna at Etawah	Ends in the Rann of Kutch
Water stays sweet throughout	Sweet above Balotra, saline below it
Deep gorges and ravines (beehad)	Broad shallow sandy bed
Big dams - Gandhi Sagar, Rana Pratap Sagar, Jawahar Sagar, Kota Barrage	Big dams on its tributaries - Jawai, Sardar Samand, Bankli
Tributaries join from both banks	Only one left-bank tributary, the Jojri

- Jawai dam at Sumerpur (Pali) is the largest dam of western Rajasthan - the 'lifeline of Marwar'.
- Sardar Samand dam lies on the Sukri, in Pali district.
- Mahi Bajaj Sagar dam is at Borkheda, Banswara - a joint Rajasthan-Gujarat project.
- Som-Kamla-Amba dam is in Dungarpur, on the Som.
- The Mahi is the only river in India that crosses the Tropic of Cancer TWICE.
- Length order of the big four - Mahi 576 km, Banas 512 km, Luni about 495 km, Sabarmati shortest in Rajasthan at about 45 km.

TRAP

Three traps in this section. One - the Luni ends in the Rann of Kutch, not in the Gulf of Khambhat; the Mahi and the Sabarmati go to the Gulf of Khambhat. Two - Jojri is the ONLY left-bank tributary of the Luni, and it is not a Chambal tributary. Three - the Luni is 'half sweet, half salty' with the changeover at BALOTRA, not at Barmer or Jalore.

Internal drainage - the 60 per cent that goes nowhere

About 60 per cent of Rajasthan drains into itself. The rivers here start in the Aravalli or the Shivaliks, run a short way into the sand or a salt flat, and vanish. Nothing reaches the sea. This is where the salt lakes get their salt - water carries dissolved minerals in, evaporates, and leaves the salt behind. It is also where the strangest exam facts live: a dead river, a 17 km river, and a river that flows out of the state to a lake near Delhi.

Internal drainage - origin and where the water dies

River	Origin	Where it ends
Ghaggar ('mrit nadi')	Kalka / Shivalik hills, Himachal Pradesh	Enters Rajasthan at Talwara jheel, Hanumangarh; sinks into the sands; locally called 'Nali'; Kalibangan stands on its bank
Kantli	Khandela hills, Sikar	Runs through Sikar and Jhunjhunu and vanishes in the sands; Ganeshwar lies on it
Kakni (Masurdi)	Jaisalmer	Bhuj jheel, Jaisalmer - the shortest river of Rajasthan, about 17 km
Sabi / Sahibi	Sewar hills, Jaipur	Najafgarh jheel, near Delhi
Banganga ('Arjun ki Ganga')	Bairath hills, Jaipur	Disappears in the Bharatpur plains
Ruparel	Udainath hills, Alwar	Dies out in Bharatpur
Mentha	Jaipur	Sambhar lake
Rupangarh	Ajmer	Sambhar lake
Khari and Khandela	Aravalli, Ajmer-Sikar belt	Sambhar lake

- The Ghaggar is identified with the Vedic Saraswati - hence 'mrit nadi', the dead river.
- Four rivers feed Sambhar lake - Mentha, Rupangarh, Khari and Khandela.
- The Shekhawati-Torawati belt is the classic internal-drainage tract of the state.

- Internal drainage plus high evaporation is the whole reason Rajasthan has a saline lake belt.
- The Sabi is the one internal-drainage river that leaves Rajasthan - it flows on into Haryana and Delhi.

TRAP

The Sabi ends in the Najafgarh jheel, NOT in Sambhar lake - RPSC has set exactly that wrong pairing. And the Kantli does not empty into Sambhar either; it simply dies in the sands of Jhunjhunu. The four Sambhar feeders are Mentha, Rupangarh, Khari and Khandela, and only those four.

Dams and waterfalls - the quick-reference tables

Dam-to-river matching is a standing RPSC format and it is pure recall. Keep this table separate from the irrigation chapter's canal material - here you only need the dam, its river and its district.

Dam to river to district

Dam / project	River	District
Gandhi Sagar	Chambal	Madhya Pradesh (upstream of Rajasthan)
Rana Pratap Sagar	Chambal	Rawatbhata, Chittorgarh
Jawahar Sagar	Chambal	Kota-Bundi
Kota Barrage	Chambal	Kota
Bisalpur	Banas	Todaraisingh, Tonk
Isarda	Banas	Tonk-Sawai Madhopur
Meja	Kothari	Bhilwara
Jawai	Jawai	Sumerpur, Pali
Sardar Samand	Sukri	Pali
Jakham	Jakham	Pratapgarh - highest dam of Rajasthan, about 81 m

Dam / project	River	District
Mahi Bajaj Sagar	Mahi	Borkheda, Banswara
Som-Kamla-Amba	Som	Dungarpur
Panchana	Gambhir	Karauli

Waterfalls of Rajasthan

Waterfall	River / setting	District
Chulia	Chambal, near Bhainsrorgarh	Chittorgarh
Menal	Menali	Chittorgarh-Bhilwara border area
Bhimlat	Mej basin	Bundi
Damoh	Chambal ravine country	Dholpur
Apsara falls	Near Mount Abu	Sirohi

YAAD RAKHO

Waterfall shortcut - Chulia and Menal are both Chittorgarh side, Bhimlat is Bundi, Damoh is Dholpur, Apsara is Abu. Two C's together, then B-B, D-D and A-A. Every pair shares a letter.

Freshwater lakes - mostly man-made, mostly Mewar

Almost every freshwater lake in Rajasthan is artificial. A ruler dammed a stream, the water backed up, and a lake appeared with his name on it. That is why lake-to-builder matching is such a reliable RPSC format. Two facts carry outsized weight - Jaisamand is traditionally described as the largest artificial freshwater lake in Asia, and Nakki at Mount Abu is the highest lake in Rajasthan and the only one that freezes.

Freshwater lakes - the Mewar cluster

Lake	District	Builder / key fact
Jaisamand (Dhebar)	Udaipur	Maharana Jai Singh, 1685-91, on the Gomti; Asia's largest artificial freshwater lake; seven islands settled by Bhil and Mina families
Rajsamand	Rajsamand	Maharana Raj Singh I, 1662, on the Gomti; its Nauchowki embankment carries the Raj Prashasti - India's largest inscription, 25 slabs, composed by Ranchhod Bhatt
Pichola	Udaipur	Dug in Rana Lakha's reign by a Banjara; Jag Mandir and Jag Niwas stand in it
Fateh Sagar	Udaipur	Maharana Fateh Singh; the Udaipur Solar Observatory sits on an island in it
Udai Sagar	Udaipur	Maharana Udai Singh, built on the Berach
Swaroop Sagar	Udaipur	Links Pichola with Fateh Sagar
Badi (Jiyan Sagar)	Udaipur	Famine-relief work of Maharana Raj Singh II

Freshwater lakes - the rest of the state

Lake	District	Key fact
Ana Sagar	Ajmer	Built by Arnoraj Chauhan; Jahangir's Daulat Bagh and Shah Jahan's baradari on its bank
Foy Sagar	Ajmer	1892 famine-relief work, named for the engineer Foy
Pushkar	Ajmer	Natural lake, 52 ghats, the Brahma temple; the Pushkar fair
Nakki	Sirohi (Mount Abu)	Highest lake in Rajasthan and the only one that freezes
Balsamand	Jodhpur	Built in 1159 - among the oldest artificial lakes of the state
Kaylana	Jodhpur	Built by Pratap Singh, 1872
Siliserh	Alwar	Palace lake; became a Ramsar site in 2025
Gadsisar	Jaisalmer	The old water supply of Jaisalmer city
Kolayat and Gajner	Bikaner	Kolayat has the Kapil Muni temple and its annual fair

Lake	District	Key fact
Ramgarh crater lake	Baran	Sits in a meteorite impact crater; a notified geo-heritage site
Menar	Udaipur	The 'bird village' wetland; Ramsar site since 2025

YAAD RAKHO

Lake-to-builder, four pairs that come up again and again - Ana Sagar goes with Arnoraj (both start with A), Rajsamand with Raj Singh (both start with Raj), Udai Sagar with Udai Singh, Fateh Sagar with Fateh Singh. The lake is named after the man in three of the four cases. Jaisamand is the fifth - Jai Singh.

TRAP

The Jai Singh who built Jaisamand is MAHARANA Jai Singh of Mewar in the 1680s - not Sawai Jai Singh II of Jaipur, who founded Jaipur in 1727. Second trap: Fateh Sagar carries the Udaipur Solar Observatory, not Pichola. Third: Gadsisar is in Jaisalmer, never Barmer - RPSC has used that exact wrong pairing.

Saline lakes and the salt economy

The saline lakes are the direct consequence of internal drainage. Water runs in, cannot run out, evaporates, and leaves its dissolved salt behind. The result is a belt of salt lakes across the Jaipur-Ajmer-Nagaur-Bikaner tract. Sambhar is the giant - India's largest inland saline lake, about 190 sq km, spread across the Jaipur, Ajmer and Nagaur districts. It has been a Ramsar site since 23 March 1990, it is worked by Sambhar Salts Limited, it is a flamingo habitat, and the Shakambhari Devi temple stands beside it.

Saline lakes of Rajasthan - use the post-2024 district names

Lake	District	Key fact
Sambhar	Jaipur-Ajmer-Nagaur tract	India's largest inland saline lake; about 190 sq km; Ramsar site 23 March 1990; flamingos; Shakambhari Devi temple
Pachpadra	Balotra (erstwhile Barmer)	The best-quality salt in India, about 98% sodium chloride; made by the traditional 'mora' method
Didwana	Didwana-Kuchaman (erstwhile Nagaur)	A source of sodium sulphate, not just common salt
Kuchaman	Didwana-Kuchaman (erstwhile Nagaur)	Part of the Nagauri upland salt belt
Lunkaransar	Bikaner	Northern end of the salt belt
Phulera	Jaipur	Adjoins the Sambhar basin
Talchhapar	Churu	Salt flat with the blackbuck sanctuary alongside it
Rewasa	Sikar	Small Shekhawati salt lake
Kawad	Jodhpur	Western salt depression

- Rajasthan is India's largest producer of inland salt; Sambhar alone supplies a large share.
- Sambhar Salts Limited works Sambhar; RSMML handles the state's wider mineral operations.
- Pachpadra salt is the purest because its brine is fed by an underground salt source, not by rainfall runoff.
- The 'mora' method at Pachpadra uses branches of the khejri or babool placed in the brine to crystallise salt.
- Sambhar's flamingo season and Shakambhari Devi make it a tourism and biodiversity question as well as a geography one.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a three-statement set on Sambhar - it is India's largest inland saline lake; it was designated a Ramsar site in 1990; the Mentha and the Rupangarh are among the rivers that feed it. All three correct. Sambhar and Keoladeo as a Ramsar pair have also come up in 2016. Learn the 1990 date.

TRAP

Lunkaransar is in BIKANER; Talchhappar is in CHURU. Students swap them because both sound like desert names. Also - Pachpadra gives the highest-purity salt, but Sambhar is the largest producer by quantity; a question about 'best quality' and one about 'largest' have different answers.

Ramsar sites and the final sweep

Ramsar sites are wetlands of international importance listed under the Ramsar Convention of 1971. For decades Rajasthan had only two. Three more were added in 2025, so the number you write today is FIVE. This is exactly the kind of fact RPSC updates and then tests, so carry the date with it.

The five Ramsar sites of Rajasthan (as of September 2026)

Site	District	Listed	Why it qualified
Keoladeo Ghana	Bharatpur	1981	Rajasthan's first; also a UNESCO World Heritage site and a national park
Sambhar	Jaipur-Ajmer-Nagaur	1990 (23 March)	India's largest inland saline lake; flamingo habitat
Menar	Udaipur	2025	The 'bird village' wetland complex of Mewar
Khichan	Phalodi (erstwhile Jodhpur)	2025	Winter home of the demoiselle crane, the 'kurjan'

Site	District	Listed	Why it qualified
Siliserh Lake	Alwar	2025	Aravalli foothill lake; India's 95th Ramsar site

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Rajasthan has FIVE Ramsar sites after the 2025 additions of Menar, Khichan and Siliserh Lake. Menar and Khichan were listed together and took India's tally to 91; Siliserh followed as India's 95th. Note the district shift too - Khichan is now in Phalodi district, carved out of Jodhpur in 2023 and retained in the December 2024 review. Re-check India's national Ramsar total closer to the exam, since it keeps rising.

YAAD RAKHO

Last-week sweep. Chambal - Janapav, Charmanyavati, only perennial, Chaurasigarh entry, Yamuna at Etawah, GA-RA-JA-KO dams. Banas - Khamnor, 512 km, longest wholly inside Rajasthan, Bigod Triveni, Bisalpur, Rameshwar Ghat. Luni - Nag Pahar, Sagarmati plus Saraswati, Jojri the only left-bank tributary, saline below Balotra, Rann of Kutch. Mahi - Amjhera, crosses the Tropic of Cancer twice, Beneshwar Triveni. Internal - Ghaggar the dead river, Kakni the shortest at 17 km, Sabi to Najafgarh. Lakes - Jaisamand largest artificial freshwater in Asia, Nakki highest and the only one that freezes, Sambhar largest inland saline, Pachpadra purest salt. Five Ramsar sites.

REVISION RECAP

1. Roughly 60% of Rajasthan has internal drainage; the rest splits between the Bay of Bengal (Chambal system) and the Arabian Sea (Luni, Mahi, Sabarmati, West Banas).
2. Chambal - ancient Charmanyavati, rises at Janapav hills (Mhow, Indore, MP), enters Rajasthan at Chaurasigarh (Chittorgarh), joins the Yamuna at Etawah; the state's only perennial river.

3. Chambal dams upstream to downstream - Gandhi Sagar, Rana Pratap Sagar (Rawatbhata), Jawahar Sagar, Kota Barrage; Chulia falls near Bhainsrorgarh.
4. Kali Sindh joins the Chambal at Nonera (Kota); Parvati and Parwan enter from Madhya Pradesh; Jojri is NOT a Chambal tributary.
5. Banas - 'Van ki Asha', Khamnor hills (Rajsamand), 512 km, longest river entirely within Rajasthan, joins the Chambal at Rameshwar Ghat (Sawai Madhopur).
6. Triveni Sangam at Bigod (Bhilwara) = Banas + Berach + Menali; Beneshwar (Dungarpur) = Mahi + Som + Jakham.
7. Bisalpur dam on the Banas at Todaraisingh (Tonk) supplies Jaipur, Ajmer and Tonk; Meja dam on the Kothari (Bhilwara).
8. Luni - Lavanavari, rises at Nag Pahar (Ajmer) as the Sagarmati, Saraswati joins at Govindgarh, about 495 km, saline below Balotra, ends in the Rann of Kutch.
9. Jojri is the Luni's only left-bank tributary; Sukri, Mithri, Bandi, Jawai, Guhiya, Sagi and Khari join from the right.
10. Jawai dam at Sumerpur (Pali) is western Rajasthan's largest - the lifeline of Marwar; Sardar Samand is on the Sukri.
11. Mahi - Amjhera (Dhar, MP), 576 km with about 171 km in Rajasthan, the only Indian river crossing the Tropic of Cancer twice, ends in the Gulf of Khambhat; Mahi Bajaj Sagar at Borkheda (Banswara).
12. Jakham dam (Pratapgarh) is Rajasthan's highest at about 81 m; Som-Kamla-Amba is in Dungarpur.
13. Ghaggar - the 'mrit nadi', Vedic Saraswati, enters at Talwara jheel (Hanumangarh), locally 'Nali', Kalibangan on its bank.
14. Kakni (Masurdi) of Jaisalmer is the shortest river at about 17 km; Sabi ends in the Najafgarh jheel; Banganga and Ruparel die in the Bharatpur plains; Kantli vanishes in Jhunjhunu.
15. Sambhar is fed by the Mentha, Rupangarh, Khari and Khandela.
16. Jaisamand (Dhebar) on the Gomti, Maharana Jai Singh 1685-91 - Asia's largest artificial freshwater lake, seven islands; Rajsamand (Raj Singh I, 1662) carries the Raj Prashasti on its Nauchowki.
17. Nakki (Mount Abu, Sirohi) is the highest lake and the only one that freezes; Ramgarh in Baran sits in a meteorite crater.
18. Ana Sagar - Arnoraj Chauhan (Ajmer); Foy Sagar - 1892 famine relief; Fateh Sagar carries the Udaipur Solar Observatory; Udai Sagar is on the Berach.
19. Sambhar - India's largest inland saline lake, about 190 sq km, Ramsar since 23 March 1990; Pachpadra (Balotra) gives the purest salt at about 98% NaCl by the 'mora' method; Didwana yields sodium sulphate.

20. As of September 2026 Rajasthan has five Ramsar sites - Keoladeo Ghana 1981, Sambhar 1990, Menar 2025, Khichan (Phalodi) 2025 and Siliserh, Alwar 2025.

RG03

Climate of Rajasthan

Rajasthan Geography gives 11-15 questions every paper, and climate reliably contributes 1-3 of them. The favourites are the Koppen type of a named district, the highest and lowest rainfall district, the Phalodi record, and local winds matched to their meaning. Matching and one-liner formats dominate.

This chapter is about one simple fact and its consequences - Rajasthan is dry, and it gets drier as you move north-west. Everything RPSC asks here hangs off that gradient: the 50 cm isohyet, the four Koppen types, the rainfall extremes, the temperature records, the local winds. It is a small chapter with a very high strike rate because the facts are fixed numbers and fixed place names.

Climate of Rajasthan

Basic character

- Arid to semi-arid
- Average rain about 58 cm
- India average about 125 cm
- Arid tract about 61 per cent of state

Rainfall gradient

- Falls south-east to north-west
- 50 cm isohyet on Aravalli axis
- Jhalawar highest district
- Mount Abu wettest station
- Jaisalmer / Sam driest

Koppen types

- Aw - Vagad (Banswara, Dungarpur)
- BWhw - Jaisalmer, Bikaner, Churu
- BShw - Shekhawati, Nagaur, Luni basin
- Cwg - Jaipur, Alwar, Kota, Udaipur

Temperature

- Phalodi 51.0 C, 19 May 2016
- Churu - extreme continental
- Mount Abu coldest
- Fatehpur (Sikar) sub-zero on plains

Winds and systems

- Loo - May-June westerly
- Andhi - pre-monsoon dust storm
- Bhabulya - dust whirlwind
- Mavath - winter rain
- Western disturbances - Mediterranean

Monsoon

- Enters last week of June
- Entry via Banswara-Dungarpur
- Arabian Sea branch dominant
- Withdraws by end September
- About 90 per cent of annual rain

Hazards and policy

- Drought - Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner
- Chhappaniya Akal VS 1956
- Heat waves, cold waves, hailstorms
- SAPCC 2010 under NAPCC 2008

Start here - why Rajasthan is dry at all

Rajasthan sits in the path of the south-west monsoon. So why is half of it desert? Because three things go wrong at once. The monsoon current arrives here already spent, the one mountain range that could have wrung it out is

pointing the wrong way, and the state is a long way from the sea. Get this causal chain right before you memorise any number - RPSC asks it as an assertion-reason or a statement question almost as often as it asks the numbers.

- The Aravalli range runs south-west to north-east - roughly parallel to the monsoon current.
- Parallel means the winds travel along the range, not up it, so there is almost no orographic lifting.
- The Arabian Sea branch that crosses western Rajasthan is not forced to rise and so does not shed its moisture.
- The Bay of Bengal branch reaches eastern Rajasthan only after crossing the whole Gangetic plain, badly weakened.
- Continentality - distance from the sea - plus a bare sandy surface gives extreme heating and very low humidity.

TRAP

Do not write that the Aravallis 'block' the monsoon. They fail to block it. That failure is precisely the point - and the wrong option in the exam is always the one that says the western side gets more rain than the eastern side.

ASKED IN RAS

A standard RPSC framing: Assertion - western Rajasthan is arid though it lies in the monsoon path. Reason - the Aravallis are parallel to the monsoon current and do not obstruct it. Both true, and the reason correctly explains the assertion.

Rainfall - the most examined part of this chapter

Learn rainfall as a gradient, not as a list. Rain falls off steadily from the south-east corner to the north-west corner. Jhalawar at one end, Jaisalmer at the other, and everything in between sits on that line. If you can draw the diagonal, you can answer most rainfall questions without memorising district figures.

- State average annual rainfall - about 58 cm, against India's average of about 125 cm.
- About 90 per cent of it falls in the south-west monsoon season, late June to mid-September.
- The remaining tenth comes mainly from winter western disturbances.
- Only about 10 per cent of the state's area gets more than 80 cm, and that area lies in the south and south-east.
- Rainfall variability exceeds 60 per cent in the west and is lowest in the south-east - which is why drought is a western problem.

The five rainfall regions of Rajasthan

Region	Annual rainfall	Where it lies
Arid	Below 20 cm	Jaisalmer and the extreme western frontier
Semi-arid	20-40 cm	Bikaner, Churu, Barmer, parts of Jodhpur and Nagaur
Sub-humid	40-60 cm	Central belt along and just east of the Aravallis
Humid	60-80 cm	Eastern and south-eastern plain
Very humid	Above 80 cm	Jhalawar, Banswara, the Mount Abu tract

The 50 cm isohyet - one line, many questions

An isohyet is a line joining places of equal rainfall. The 50 cm isohyet is the one that matters in Rajasthan. It runs broadly along the Aravalli axis and splits

the state into two halves - arid western desert on one side, semi-humid eastern plain on the other. When a question asks what the 50 cm line separates, that is the answer: the arid west from the semi-humid east.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked repeatedly - which district of Rajasthan receives the highest average annual rainfall? Answer: Jhalawar. But the single wettest station is Mount Abu in Sirohi, lifted above 1,200 m on the Aravalli crest.

ASKED IN RAS

Its twin - which district receives the lowest rainfall? Answer: Jaisalmer, of the order of 10-20 cm a year. The driest tract within it is around Sam.

Keep district and station apart in your head. The highest-rainfall DISTRICT is Jhalawar. The wettest PLACE or STATION is Mount Abu. RPSC sets both options side by side in the same question and lets you pick the wrong one, so read whether the stem says district or place.

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho the diagonal - JHALAWAR, BANSWARA, KOTA, JAIPUR, NAGAUR, BIKANER, JAISALMER. Read it as one falling line from the south-east to the north-west, and every ordering question is solved.

Koppen classification of Rajasthan - four types, four regions

Koppen classified climates by letters. The first capital letter is the broad group, the small letters describe the rain and heat. Rajasthan has exactly four of his

types. That is a gift - four rows, learn them cold, because the district-to-type match is the single most reliable climate question in the paper.

Koppen types matched to the regions of Rajasthan

Koppen type	What it means	Districts and region
Aw	Tropical humid, savanna type with dry winter	Vagad - Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh and the adjoining south-east
BWhw	Hot desert, dry winter	Jaisalmer, Bikaner, Churu, Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, western Barmer, western Jodhpur
BShw	Semi-arid steppe, hot, dry winter	Luni basin, Nagaur, Shekhawati (Sikar-Jhunjhunu), Ghaggar plain, Jalore, Pali
Cwg	Sub-humid, dry-winter monsoon type	Jaipur, Alwar, Bharatpur, Ajmer, Bhilwara, Bundi, Chittorgarh, Udaipur, Kota

- B is the dry group. BW is true desert, BS is steppe - W for wüste (desert), S for steppe.
- The small h stands for hot, the small w for a dry winter, the g for the Gangetic type of temperature regime.
- The order Aw - Cwg - BShw - BWhw is also the order of falling rainfall, south-east to north-west.

- Trick to remember: A for the Adivasi belt - Aw = Banswara and Dungarpur.
- C for Capital - Cwg = Jaipur and the eastern plain.
- BS for the Shekhawati Steppe; BW for the Western desert.
- The second character of the code tells you the region every time.

TRAP

Two traps here. First - Bikaner is BWhw (hot desert), NOT BShw. Second - Am, the tropical monsoon type with a short dry season, does NOT occur in Rajasthan. Any option offering Am is the wrong one.

Temperature – the records, the ranges and the cold

Rajasthan holds India's hottest record and also produces sub-zero winter nights on the plains. Both come from the same cause. A bare sandy surface with no moisture and no cloud heats furiously by day and radiates all of it away by night. That gives the state among the highest diurnal and annual temperature ranges in India.

Temperature records you must be able to quote

Record	Place	Detail
Highest air temperature ever recorded in India	Phalodi	51.0 degrees C on 19 May 2016
Extreme continental station	Churu	Among the highest annual temperature ranges in India; crosses 50 C in summer, falls below freezing in winter
Coldest place in Rajasthan (normally)	Mount Abu, Sirohi	The state's only hill station
Coldest plains station	Fatehpur, Sikar	Most frequent sub-zero minima on the plains, with Churu

ASKED IN RAS

Asked directly – the highest air temperature ever recorded in India, 51.0 degrees C on 19 May 2016, was registered at Phalodi. Note the date; RPSC has used the year as a distractor.

- Phalodi was then a tehsil of Jodhpur district; since the 2023 reorganisation it is a district in its own right and was retained in the December 2024 review.
- Summer maxima above 45 C are routine across Barmer, Jaisalmer, Bikaner and Churu in May and June.

- The three causes of the extreme range - continentality, bare sandy surface, clear cloudless skies with low humidity.

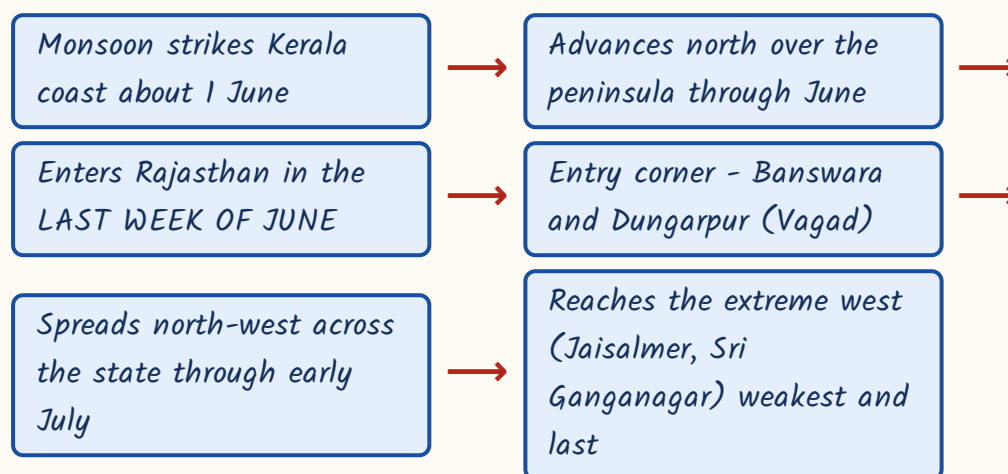
TRAP

Coldest PLACE in Rajasthan is Mount Abu. But if the question says 'on the plains' or 'excluding hill stations', the answer flips to Fatehpur (Sikar) or Churu. Read the qualifier.

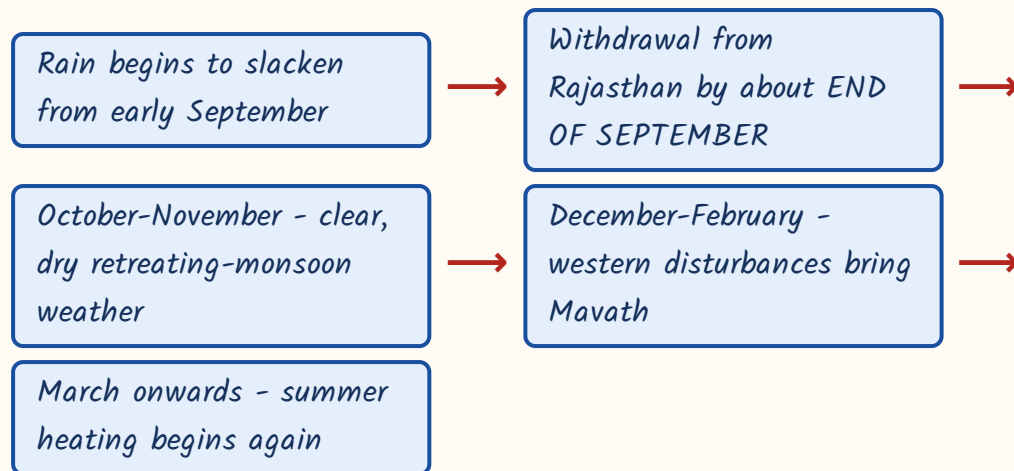
The monsoon over Rajasthan - onset to withdrawal

The monsoon reaches Rajasthan last and leaves it first. It enters through the humid south-east corner in the last week of June and is gone by about the end of September. Roughly three months of rain, and nine months of nothing but western disturbances. Learn the entry corner and the exit month - they are the two asked facts.

Onset of the south-west monsoon over Rajasthan



Withdrawal and the dry months



The two monsoon branches over Rajasthan

Arabian Sea branch	Bay of Bengal branch
Supplies most of western and southern Rajasthan	Supplies eastern Rajasthan
Travels roughly parallel to the Aravallis, so little lifting	Arrives after crossing the entire Gangetic plain
Moisture retained but not released - the cause of western aridity	Already much weakened and depleted by the time it arrives
Dominant branch for the state as a whole	Secondary branch, eastern districts only

- About 90 per cent of Rajasthan's annual rainfall comes in this single season.
- The Tropic of Cancer clips the extreme southern edge of Banswara district - almost the whole state is sub-tropical, not tropical.

Local winds and winter rain - a guaranteed matching question

Four local terms carry almost all the marks in this section. Loo and Andhi belong to the summer, Bhabulya to the arid west at any hot hour, and Mavath to winter. RPSC's favourite trick is to shift one of them into the wrong season.

Local winds and weather terms of Rajasthan

Term	What it is	Season and area
Loo	Hot, dry, dust-laden westerly wind; a major cause of heat-stroke deaths	May-June, western Rajasthan - Barmer, Jaisalmer, Bikaner
Andhi	Violent pre-monsoon dust storm that cuts visibility sharply	May-June, often just before the first monsoon showers
Bhabulya	Small, short-lived local dust whirlwind	Bikaner and the adjoining western tract
Mavath	Light winter rain brought by western disturbances	December-February, chiefly north and north-west Rajasthan

Mavath deserves a sentence of its own. It is only about a tenth of the year's rain, but it falls exactly when wheat, mustard and gram need it. That makes it disproportionately important to the rabi crop and to the state's food economy. Western disturbances themselves are extra-tropical systems - they form over the Mediterranean Sea, travel eastwards, and enter India from the north-west.

TRAP

Mavath is caused by WESTERN DISTURBANCES, not by the retreating or north-east monsoon. That single substitution is the standard 'NOT correctly matched' option.

- Sort them by season and the match writes itself - Loo and Andhi are hot, so summer.
- Mavath is meetha for the farmer - winter rain, rabi crop.
- Bhabulya is a bhanwar, a whirl - a local dust devil, any hot afternoon in the west.

Hazards, droughts and the great famines

Rajasthan's climate hazards follow the rainfall gradient too. Where rainfall is low and variability is high, drought is chronic. Where the surface is bare and hot, heat waves kill. Cold waves come with northerly incursions in winter, and hailstorms ride in on western disturbances. Note that last one carefully - hail is a winter and pre-monsoon phenomenon here, not a monsoon one.

- Drought frequency is highest in Jaisalmer, Barmer and Bikaner - the low-rain, high-variability west.
- High inter-annual rainfall variability, above 60 per cent in the west, is the principal cause of recurrent drought.
- Heat waves peak in May and June in the western districts.
- Cold waves follow the incursion of cold northerly winds in December and January.
- Hailstorms come with western disturbances in winter and the pre-monsoon months and are a major threat to the rabi crop.

The famine you must know by name is the Chhappaniya Akal - literally 'the famine of fifty-six', named for Vikram Samvat 1956, which corresponds to 1899-1900 CE. It is the most severe famine in Rajasthan's recorded history and passed into folk memory and folk song. The earlier Trikal famine of Vikram Samvat 1868 is the other landmark famine name.

- Chhappaniya Akal - VS 1956 = 1899-1900 CE. Convert by subtracting 57 from the Samvat year.
- Trikal - VS 1868, the earlier great famine.
- The Thar or Great Indian Desert is India's largest desert; the arid western tract covers about 61 per cent of Rajasthan's area.
- Eastward expansion of the arid tract is the long-run climate worry - it is why shelterbelts and the Aravalli Green Wall exist.

One last caution on drought. Jhalawar and Banswara are the wettest districts of the state. They can never be the answer to a most-drought-prone question, however plausible the option is made to look. Drought in Rajasthan is always a western answer - Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner.

Climate policy and the current file

The policy layer is thin but it is asked, usually as a one-liner about which national framework the state plan sits under. Every Indian state prepares a State Action Plan on Climate Change consistent with the National Action Plan on Climate Change of 2008 and its national missions. Rajasthan's first such plan was prepared in 2010.

- National Action Plan on Climate Change - 2008, the umbrella framework with its national missions.
- Rajasthan State Action Plan on Climate Change - first prepared in 2010, under that umbrella.
- Rajasthan also has a Climate Change Policy dated 2023 and district-level Heat Action Plans issued by the Disaster Management and Relief Department.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): heat is now a policy subject in Rajasthan, not just a weather fact. The state's Disaster Management and Relief Department issues district Heat Wave Action Plans each summer, and the pressure to treat heat waves as a notified disaster has been a live national debate since the 2024 heat season. Expect a current-affairs question phrased around heat action plans rather than around temperature records.

REVISION RECAP

1. Rajasthan average rainfall about 58 cm; India's about 125 cm; about 90 per cent falls in the south-west monsoon.
2. Rain falls off from the south-east to the north-west - the whole chapter is that one diagonal.
3. 50 cm isohyet runs along the Aravalli axis and divides the arid west from the semi-humid east.
4. Five rainfall regions: arid below 20, semi-arid 20-40, sub-humid 40-60, humid 60-80, very humid above 80 cm.
5. Highest rainfall district = Jhalawar. Wettest station = Mount Abu. Lowest = Jaisalmer, driest tract Sam.
6. Only about 10 per cent of the state's area gets over 80 cm; variability tops 60 per cent in the west.
7. Koppen: Aw = Banswara-Dungarpur; BWhw = Jaisalmer-Bikaner-Churu; BShw = Shekhawati-Nagaur-Luni; Cwg = Jaipur-Kota-Udaipur.
8. Am does not occur in Rajasthan; Bikaner is BWhw, not BShw.
9. Phalodi 51.0 degrees C on 19 May 2016 - India's highest ever. Churu is the extreme continental station.
10. Mount Abu coldest overall; Fatehpur (Sikar) and Churu coldest on the plains, often sub-zero.
11. Monsoon enters the last week of June through Banswara-Dungarpur and withdraws by about end September.
12. Arabian Sea branch feeds west and south; Bay of Bengal branch, weakened, feeds the east.
13. Aravallis lie parallel to the monsoon current - no orographic lifting, hence western aridity.
14. Loo and Andhi = May-June; Bhabulya = dust whirlwind of the Bikaner tract; Mavath = winter rain from western disturbances.
15. Western disturbances originate over the Mediterranean and enter India from the north-west; they give only about a tenth of the rain.
16. Hailstorms ride on western disturbances in winter and pre-monsoon - not on the monsoon.
17. Drought is worst in Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner; Chhappaniya Akal = VS 1956 = 1899-1900 CE; Trikal = VS 1868.
18. Thar is India's largest desert; the arid tract is about 61 per cent of Rajasthan's area.
19. Tropic of Cancer clips southern Banswara - nearly the whole state is sub-tropical.

20. *Rajasthan SAPCC first prepared 2010, under the National Action Plan on Climate Change, 2008.*

RG04

Natural Vegetation and Forests of Rajasthan

Two to three questions a paper within the 11-15 Rajasthan Geography block. State tree and state flower, Dhok as the commonest species, Amrita Devi and the 363, forest cover percentage, and sacred groves are the recurring items. Match-the-following is the dominant format.

Rajasthan is India's largest state and one of its least forested. That contradiction is the whole chapter. RPSC asks it in three ways - the ISFR numbers, the species-to-botanical-name match, and the Khejarli story. Learn the numbers with their report edition attached, because a figure without an edition is a wrong answer waiting to happen.

Forests of Rajasthan

The numbers (ISFR 2023)

- Forest cover 16,548.21 sq km
- 4.84 per cent of state area
- Forest + tree cover 8.00 per cent
- Open forest dominates
- India's figure 21.76 per cent

Legal classes

- Recorded forest area about 32,700 sq km
- Protected Forest about 56 per cent
- Reserved Forest about 38 per cent
- Unclassed about 6 per cent
- Rajasthan Forest Act, 1953

Forest types

- Group 5 Tropical Dry Deciduous about 57 pc
- Group 6 Tropical Thorn about 15 pc
- Northern Dry Mixed Deciduous - largest single type
- Sub-tropical evergreen only at Mount Abu
- Halophytes at Sambhar, Pachpadra, Didwana

Key species

- Dhok - most widespread
- Palash - second most numerous
- Khejri - state tree
- Rohida - state flower
- Teak, Salar, Khair, Bamboo
- Kair, Aak, Phog, Sewan

Districts

- Most forest by area - Udaipur
- Highest share - Udaipur, Pratapgarh
- Then Sirohi, Karauli, Baran
- Least - Jodhpur, Churu, Jaisalmer, Bikaner

Conservation tradition

- Khejarli 1730 - Amrita Devi, 363 Bishnois
- Bishnoi sect, Jambhoji 1485
- Orans and other sacred groves
- 11 September - Forest Martyrs Day

Policy and projects

- Forest Policy 2010, Forest Policy 2023
- 20 per cent green cover target
- Joint Forest Management - VFPMCs
- Aravalli Green Wall Project, March 2023
- CAZRI and AFRI, Jodhpur

The numbers - and always name the report edition

The Forest Survey of India publishes the India State of Forest Report every two years. Rajasthan's figures move each edition, so a number is only useful when you can say which report it came from. The set below is ISFR 2023, released in December 2024 - the edition your standard sources are built on. Quote these, and quote the edition with them.

- Forest cover of Rajasthan - 16,548.21 sq km, which is 4.84 per cent of its geographical area (ISFR 2023).
- Forest plus tree cover - 27,389.33 sq km, that is 8.00 per cent of the state (ISFR 2023).
- India's national forest cover in the same report is 21.76 per cent - Rajasthan is far below it.
- Rajasthan gained about 394 sq km of forest and tree cover over 2021 - the fourth-largest increase among Indian states; Chhattisgarh led with 684 sq km.

Canopy density classes in Rajasthan (ISFR 2023)

Class	Area (sq km)	Point to note
Very Dense Forest	223.20	Tiny - Rajasthan has almost no closed canopy
Moderately Dense Forest	4,237.41	The middle tier
Open Forest	12,087.60	Overwhelmingly dominant - about three-quarters of forest cover
Total forest cover	16,548.21	4.84 per cent of the state

TRAP

Forest COVER and RECORDED FOREST AREA are two different numbers. Forest cover is what satellites see - 16,548 sq km, 4.84 per cent. Recorded forest area is what is legally notified as forest - about 32,700 sq km, roughly 9.6 per cent. Almost double. RPSC swaps them.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the ISFR is biennial, so a newer edition may already be on the table by exam day. Treat 4.84 per cent as the ISFR 2023 figure and check the Rajasthan row of the latest FSI report before December 2026. In an exam, if the question names a report year, answer for that year's figure.

Recorded forest area and the legal classes

Legally, forests are of three classes. Reserved Forest is the strictest - everything is prohibited unless permitted. Protected Forest is the looser class - everything is permitted unless prohibited. Unclassed is the residue. Rajasthan is unusual in that Protected Forest, not Reserved, is its largest class.

Legal classes of Rajasthan's recorded forest area (about 32,700 sq km, roughly 9.6 per cent of the state)

Class	Share	Character
Protected Forest	About 56 per cent	Largest class in Rajasthan; rights allowed unless expressly barred
Reserved Forest	About 38 per cent	Strictest protection
Unclassed Forest	About 6 per cent	Residual category

- The governing state statute is the Rajasthan Forest Act, 1953.
- Joint Forest Management is an administrative and participatory arrangement layered on top of that Act - it does not replace it.

Forest types - Champion and Seth applied to Rajasthan

Champion and Seth classified Indian forests into sixteen groups. Rajasthan's forests fall almost entirely into two of them - Group 5, Tropical Dry Deciduous, and Group 6, Tropical Thorn. Group 5 dominates the Aravallis and the east; Group 6 takes over as you move west into the desert. Two more slivers exist: a sub-tropical evergreen patch on Mount Abu, and salt-tolerant vegetation around the saline basins.

Forest types matched to their districts

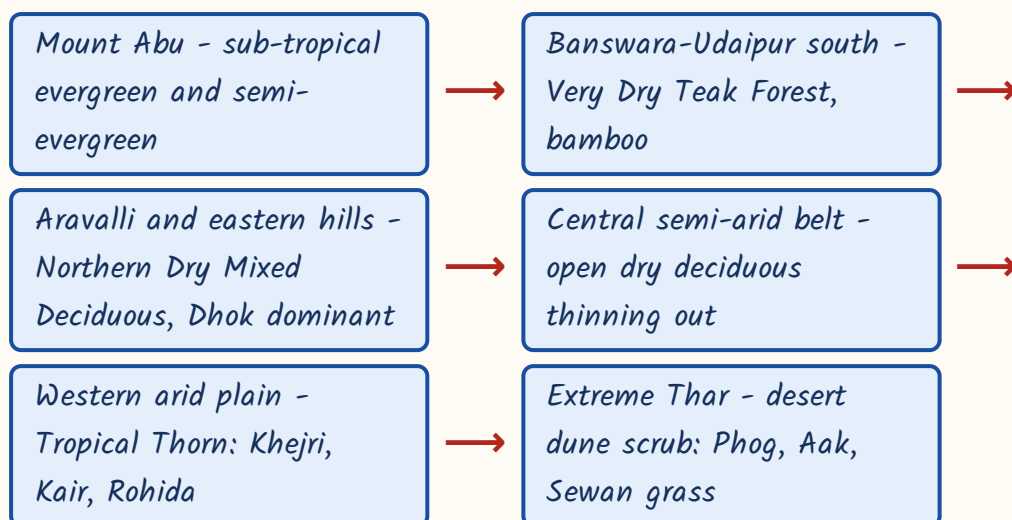
Type	Share / status	Where in Rajasthan
Group 5 - Tropical Dry Deciduous	About 57 per cent of forest area	Aravalli belt and eastern hills - Udaipur, Alwar, Chittorgarh, Bundi, Sawai Madhopur
Northern Dry Mixed Deciduous	Largest single type, about 40 per cent	Dhok-dominated Aravalli and eastern hill tracts
Very Dry Teak Forest	Sub-type of Group 5	Banswara, Udaipur, Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh, Dungarpur, Baran
Group 6 - Tropical Thorn	About 15 per cent of forest area	Arid west - Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner, Churu, Jodhpur, Nagaur
Sub-tropical evergreen / semi-evergreen	Only patch in the state	Mount Abu tract, Sirohi district
Salt-tolerant (halophytic) vegetation	Fringing type	Sambhar, Pachpadra and Didwana salt basins

- Thorn forest is dominated by Khejri, Kair, Rohida, Phog and Aak.
- Desert thorn forest and desert dune scrub are sub-types within Group 6.
- Teak and bamboo belong to the moister dry deciduous forests of the south - never to the thorn belt.

TRAP

Rajasthan has NO tropical wet evergreen forest. Its only evergreen element is the sub-tropical evergreen patch at Mount Abu. Any option offering wet evergreen forest for Rajasthan is the incorrect statement.

How the vegetation changes as you walk from the wettest corner to the driest



The species - this is where the matching marks are

Learn each tree with three tags: local name, botanical name, and the one thing it is famous for. RPSC's matching questions pair any two of the three. Dhok is the one to fix first - it is both the most widespread species and the most numerous by tree count.

Species of Rajasthan - local name, botanical name, what it is known for

Local name	Botanical name	Known for
Dhok	<i>Anogeissus pendula</i>	Most widespread and most numerous species; dominates the Aravalli and eastern hills
Palash / Dhak	<i>Butea monosperma</i>	'Flame of the Forest'; second most numerous species; lac culture, leaf plates, gum
Khejri	<i>Prosopis cineraria</i>	State tree; 'Kalp Vriksha of the desert'; also called Shami or Jandi

Local name	Botanical name	Known for
Rohida	<i>Tecomella undulata</i>	State flower; 'Marwar Teak' or 'Desert Teak'; prized timber of the arid west
Teak (Sagwan)	<i>Tectona grandis</i>	Very Dry Teak Forest of the humid south
Salar	<i>Boswellia serrata</i>	Dry rocky Aravalli slopes; yields Indian frankincense resin
Khair	<i>Acacia catechu</i>	Riverine and ravine tracts; yields katha (catechu) for paan and tanning
Bamboo (Bans)	<i>Dendrocalamus strictus</i>	Udaipur, Banswara, Dungarpur, Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh, Kota, Baran
Kair	<i>Capparis decidua</i>	Desert shrub; its berries make 'ker' in the ker-sangri dish
Aak	<i>Calotropis procera</i>	Common desert milkweed of waste and dune land
Phog	<i>Calligonum polygonoides</i>	Dune-binding shrub of the Thar
Sewan grass	<i>Lasiurus indicus</i>	Finest natural pasture grass of the Jaisalmer plains
Ber	<i>Ziziphus mauritiana</i>	Cultivated fruit; the wild bush Jharber is <i>Ziziphus nummularia</i>

ASKED IN RAS

Asked and re-asked - which is the most widespread tree species in the forests of Rajasthan? Answer: Dhok, *Anogeissus pendula*. The botanical name is asked as often as the common name.

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho the product pairs: Khair gives KATHA (both start with K-A), Salar gives resin (frankincense), Kair gives KER berries, Khejri gives SANGRI pods. Ker plus sangri is the dish - so Kair plus Khejri is the pair.

- *Palash* is valued for flowers, gum, leaf plates and lac culture - NOT for commercial sleeper timber; that is the standard wrong pairing.
- *Khejri* is a leguminous tree of the arid plains, never a conifer - another planted error.
- *Teak* and *bamboo* are southern species; pairing either with *Jaisalmer* or *Barmer* is always wrong.

State tree and state flower - a two-line certainty

Two questions in this chapter are as near to certain as anything in the paper. *Khejri* is the state tree. *Rohida* is the state flower. Both are trees of the arid west, which is exactly why RPSC pairs them with humid-south districts in the wrong options.

Khejri versus Rohida

<i>Khejri</i> (<i>Prosopis cineraria</i>)	<i>Rohida</i> (<i>Tecomella undulata</i>)
State TREE of Rajasthan	State FLOWER of Rajasthan
Called Kalp Vriksha of the desert	Called Marwar Teak or Desert Teak
Also known as Shami or Jandi	Valued chiefly for its durable timber
Pods = sangri (eaten as vegetable); dried leaves = loong (fodder)	Bright orange-red flowers of the arid west
Backbone of desert agro-forestry - grows in the field with the crop	A tree of the arid and semi-arid west, not of the humid south-east

ASKED IN RAS

Both halves asked separately in past papers - which tree is the State Tree of Rajasthan? *Khejri*. Which is the State Flower? *Rohida*. Learn the botanical names too; they appear as options.

- Khejri is a leguminous tree of the arid plains - never a conifer, whatever an option suggests.
- It is the mainstay of the desert agro-forestry system: fodder, fuel, shade, edible pods, nitrogen for the soil.
- Ker (Kair berries) plus sangri (Khejri pods) makes ker-sangri, Rajasthan's best-known dry-land dish.

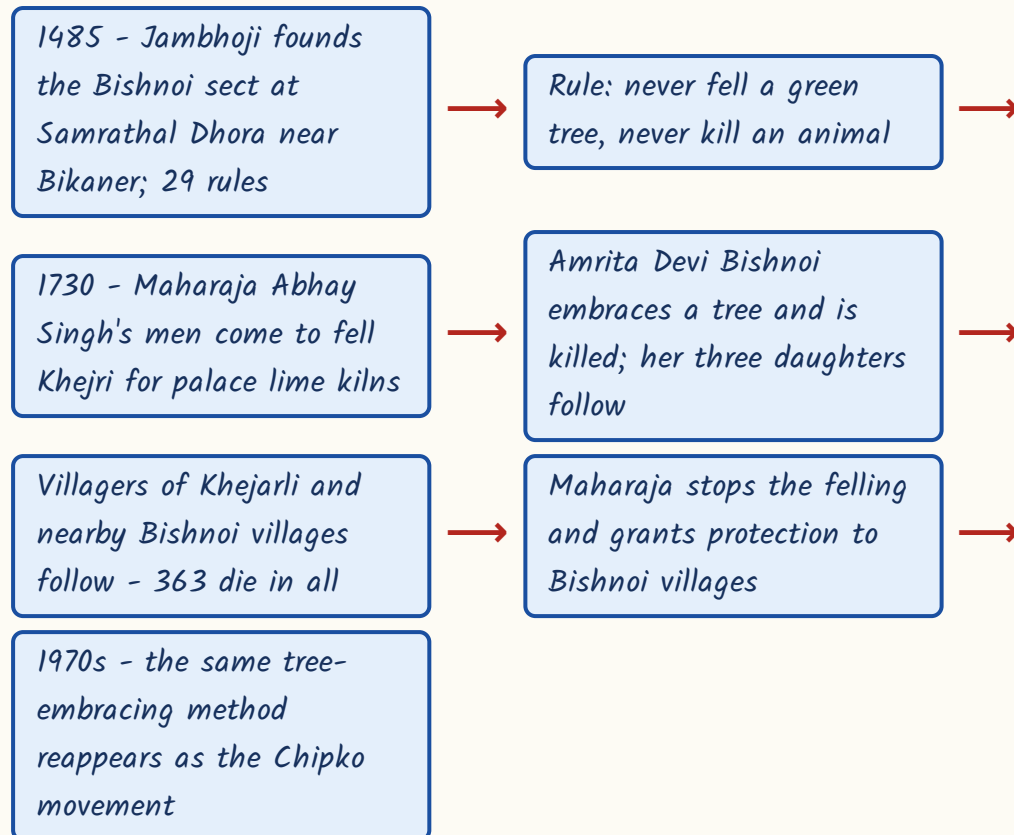
Khejarli, 1730 - learn this as a story, not a bullet

In 1730 the Maharaja of Marwar, Abhay Singh, needed lime for a new palace at Jodhpur. Lime is burnt in kilns, kilns need firewood, and the nearest firewood was the Khejri groves around the village of Khejarli. The king's men went out with axes. The village was Bishnoi - a sect whose religious code forbids the felling of a green tree.

A woman named Amrita Devi Bishnoi put her arms around a Khejri and told the axemen they would have to cut through her first. They did. Her three daughters followed her. Then the villagers of Khejarli and the surrounding Bishnoi villages came, one after another, and embraced the trees. When the killing stopped, 363 Bishnois were dead. The Maharaja, on hearing what had happened, halted the felling and issued an order protecting Bishnoi villages from tree-cutting and hunting.

Two reasons to know this properly rather than as a line. First, RPSC asks it almost every cycle - the leader, the number, the ruler, the year. Second, it is the acknowledged ancestor of the Chipko movement of the 1970s: the same method, the same idea, two and a half centuries earlier.

Khejarli - the sequence



ASKED IN RAS

Asked in multiple forms - who led the Khejarli sacrifice of 1730? Amrita Devi Bishnoi. How many Bishnois died? 363. Under which ruler? Maharaja Abhay Singh of Marwar (Jodhpur).

- 11 September is observed as National Forest Martyrs Day in memory of Khejarli and of all who died protecting forests.
- The Amrita Devi Bishnoi Wildlife Protection Award honours exemplary courage in protecting wildlife and forests.
- Bishnoi = 'bis' plus 'noi' = twenty-nine, the number of rules laid down by Guru Jambheshwar (Jambhoji) in 1485.
- Khejarli village lies in Jodhpur district.

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho: 29 rules, 1485 founding, 1730 sacrifice, 363 martyrs, 11 September remembrance. Five numbers, one story.

Orans and the sacred grove tradition

An oran is a patch of forest set aside in the name of a local deity and protected by the village itself. No felling, often no grazing, sometimes not even the removal of a dead branch. Orans have preserved biodiversity in the driest districts precisely where the Forest Department has almost no notified forest. They are the community half of Rajasthan's conservation story.

- The names for sacred groves in Rajasthan: Oran, Kankad bani, Deo bani, Rakhat bani, Malvan.
- Orans are common in the western and Aravalli districts and are usually attached to a temple or a folk deity.
- They often enclose the only surviving old-growth trees and the only reliable village water source.
- Many orans of Jaisalmer are critical habitat for the Great Indian Bustard.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): in December 2024 the Supreme Court directed that orans be treated as deemed forests, which brings forest-conservation protection to oran land. This is a fresh, dateable fact of exactly the kind RPSC lifts for a current-affairs question - remember the month, the year and the phrase 'deemed forest'.

TRAP

Khadin is NOT a sacred grove. It is a traditional runoff-farming and water-harvesting structure of Jaisalmer. In a list of grove names - Oran, Kankad bani, Deo bani, Rakhat bani - khadin is the odd one out.

Districts - which have the most forest and which the least

District-level forest data comes from the ISFR district tables, and the widely used set for Rajasthan is ISFR 2021. Note the edition when you quote a district figure. There are two separate rankings and you must not mix them - largest forest by AREA, and highest forest as a SHARE of district area.

Forest cover by district (ISFR 2021 - state the edition when you use these)

Ranking	Order	Note
Largest forest cover by area	Udaipur (about 2,753 sq km), then Alwar (about 1,196), Pratapgarh (about 1,034), Baran, Chittorgarh (about 990)	Udaipur leads on both counts
Highest forest cover as share of district area	Udaipur (about 23.5 per cent), Pratapgarh (about 23.2 per cent), then Sirohi, Karauli, Baran	Udaipur and Pratapgarh are nearly level
Lowest forest cover percentage	Jodhpur, Churu, Jaisalmer, Bikaner, Hanumangarh, Nagaur	All in the arid or canal-irrigated west and north

- Trick for the top five by area: U-A-P-B-C - Udaipur, Alwar, Pratapgarh, Baran, Chittorgarh.
- Alwar is the only northern district in that list; every other one is southern or south-eastern.
- Udaipur leads both rankings, by area and by share - so it is the safe answer when the stem is vague.

Watch for Churu. It is among the lowest forest-cover districts in the state, under one per cent of its area, and it is regularly planted into a highest-forest-cover option set to catch the careless. Jodhpur is the same kind of trap from the other direction - a very large district with very little forest.

- The district map changed in 2023 and again in December 2024; Rajasthan now has 41 districts and 7 divisions.
- ISFR district tables and the standard textbook lists still use the older district names - answer in the names the question uses.

Policy, JFM and greening the desert

The national forest policy target is 33 per cent of geographical area under forest and tree cover. Rajasthan, at 8 per cent, has openly accepted that 33 is out of reach and set itself a lower, honest target. That target number is asked.

- Rajasthan's forest policy target - about 20 per cent of geographical area under forest and tree cover.
- Rajasthan Forest Policy of 2010, restated in the Rajasthan Forest Policy 2023.
- Joint Forest Management in Rajasthan runs through Village Forest Protection and Management Committees.
- JFM provides for sharing of usufruct - fodder, fuel, minor forest produce - with the participating village.
- Social forestry raises trees outside notified forest - on roadsides, canal banks, village commons and farm bunds - to take pressure off the forests themselves.

Desert afforestation is a distinct technical programme, not ordinary plantation. The Thar's problem is moving sand, so the work is to fix the dune first and

plant afterwards. Shelterbelts are raised along the Indira Gandhi Nahar to stop dunes from marching into the canal and silting it up. The species used are the hardy natives - Khejri, Rohida, Phog, Sewan grass.

- Shelterbelt plantation along the Indira Gandhi Nahar - checks dune movement and canal silting.
- Sand-dune stabilisation using micro-windbreaks and hardy species.
- The Desert Development Programme operates in the arid western districts, not in the eastern plain.
- CAZRI (Central Arid Zone Research Institute) and AFRI (Arid Forest Research Institute), both at Jodhpur, are the lead research bodies.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the Aravalli Green Wall Project, launched in March 2023, aims to green a 5-km buffer along the Aravalli range across four states - Rajasthan, Haryana, Gujarat and Delhi. Its object is to check land degradation and the eastward creep of the Thar, and it forms part of India's wider land-restoration commitments. Remember the month and year of launch and the four states; that is the examinable core.

REVISION RECAP

1. ISFR 2023: Rajasthan forest cover 16,548.21 sq km = 4.84 per cent; forest plus tree cover 8.00 per cent; India 21.76 per cent.
2. Canopy split (ISFR 2023): VDF 223.20, MDF 4,237.41, Open Forest 12,087.60 sq km - open forest dominates.
3. Rajasthan gained about 394 sq km of forest and tree cover over 2021 - fourth-largest gain; Chhattisgarh first with 684.
4. Recorded forest area about 32,700 sq km (9.6 per cent) - Protected 56 pc, Reserved 38 pc, Unclassed 6 pc. Governing law: Rajasthan Forest Act, 1953.
5. Champion and Seth: Group 5 Tropical Dry Deciduous about 57 pc, Group 6 Tropical Thorn about 15 pc.

6. Northern Dry Mixed Deciduous is the single largest forest type, about 40 per cent of forest area.
7. Sub-tropical evergreen forest occurs only at Mount Abu; no tropical wet evergreen forest anywhere in the state.
8. Halophytic vegetation rings Sambhar, Pachpadra and Didwana.
9. Dhok (*Anogeissus pendula*) - most widespread and most numerous; Palash (*Butea monosperma*) - second, 'Flame of the Forest'.
10. Khejri (*Prosopis cineraria*) = state tree, Kalp Vriksha, Shami/Jandi, pods sangri, leaves loong.
11. Rohida (*Tecomella undulata*) = state flower, Marwar Teak, arid west.
12. Khair gives katha, Salar gives frankincense resin, Kair gives ker berries, Sewan (*Lasiurus sindicus*) is the Jaisalmer pasture grass, Phog (*Calligonum polygonoides*) binds dunes.
13. Bamboo is *Dendrocalamus strictus*, in Udaipur, Banswara, Dungarpur, Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh, Kota, Baran.
14. Khejarli 1730: Amrita Devi Bishnoi and 363 Bishnois killed resisting Maharaja Abhay Singh's men; ancestor of Chipko.
15. Bishnoi sect - Jambhoji, 1485, Samrathal Dhora near Bikaner, 29 rules; 11 September = National Forest Martyrs Day; the Amrita Devi Bishnoi award is for wildlife protection.
16. Sacred groves: Oran, Kankad bani, Deo bani, Rakhat bani, Malvan. Khadin is a water structure, not a grove.
17. December 2024 - Supreme Court directed that orans be treated as deemed forests.
18. Most forest by area: Udaipur, Alwar, Pratapgarh, Baran, Chittorgarh (ISFR 2021). Least: Jodhpur, Churu, Jaisalmer, Bikaner.
19. State forest policy target about 20 per cent green cover (national goal is 33 pc); JFM runs through Village Forest Protection and Management Committees.
20. Aravalli Green Wall Project - March 2023, 5-km buffer, four states. CAZRI and AFRI at Jodhpur lead arid-zone research.

RG05

Soils of Rajasthan

One to two questions a paper, and the agro-climatic zones are the more reliable of the two halves - RPSC has asked how many zones there are, and which zone a named group of districts belongs to. Soil questions come as soil-to-district or soil-to-order matching.

Soil in Rajasthan is really a map question. Each soil type belongs to a block of districts, and that block is decided by rock, rainfall and river. Attached to it is the other half of the chapter - the ten agro-climatic zones, which RPSC has asked by number, by name and by district. Learn the two tables in this chapter and you have the whole thing.

Soils and Agro-climatic Zones of Rajasthan

Soil types

- Desert / arid sandy - largest area
- Brown (non-calcic) - Luni basin
- Red-yellow - Aravalli granite belt
- Red loamy - humid south
- Mixed red-black
- Black / medium black - Hadoti
- Alluvial - eastern plain
- Saline-alkaline (Reh, Kallar, Usar)
- Lithosols and regosols - Aravalli slopes

USDA / ICAR orders

- Entisol - largest, western Rajasthan
- Aridisol - true desert core
- Inceptisol - southern Aravalli, Mewar, Vagad
- Vertisol - Hadoti black cotton soil
- Alfisol - eastern plain

Soil problems

- Wind erosion and dune movement - west
- Ravine and gully erosion - Chambal tract
- Waterlogging - IGNP command
- Secondary salinity and alkalinity
- Largest degraded area of any Indian state

Reclamation

- Gypsum for alkaline soil
- Sub-surface drainage for waterlogging
- Shelterbelts and dune stabilisation
- Contour bunding and check dams

Agro-climatic zones

- Ten zones in five regions I to V
- I-A, I-B, I-C - arid west
- II-A, II-B - transitional plains
- III-A, III-B - eastern plains
- IV-A, IV-B - southern plains
- V - Hadoti, most productive

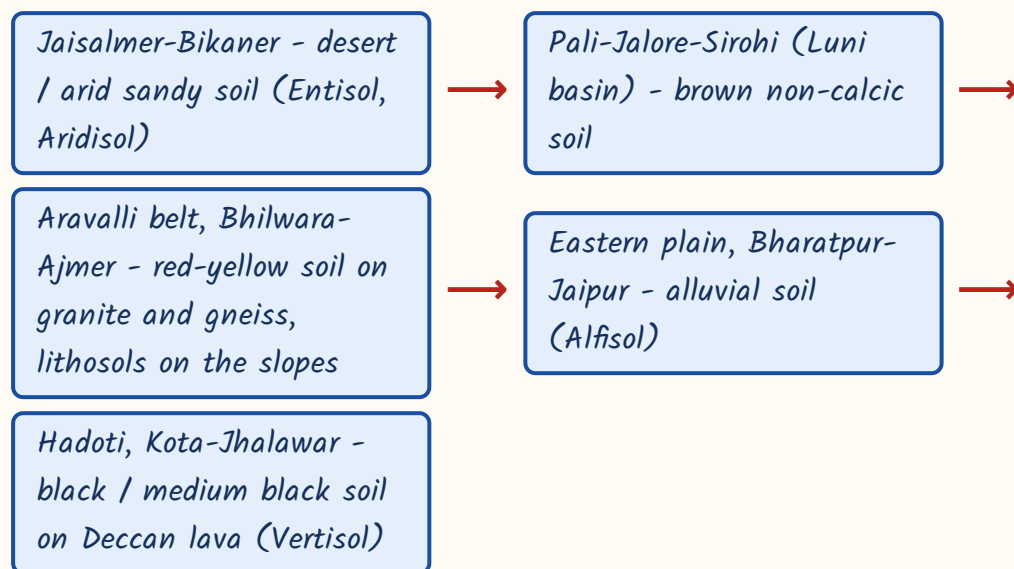
Why Rajasthan's soils are what they are

Soil is weathered rock plus organic matter plus water. In Rajasthan the rock is granite and gneiss in the Aravallis, Deccan basalt in Hadoti, and Vindhyan sandstone in the south-east; the water is scarce; and the organic matter is scarcer still because there is not enough vegetation to make it. That is why the state's soils are, as a rule, poor in humus and nitrogen. Move west and the wind

takes over as the depositing agent, so you get sand. Move east and rivers take over, so you get alluvium.

- Parent material decides colour and texture - basalt gives black, granite and gneiss give red-yellow, wind-blown sand gives desert soil, river deposition gives alluvium.
- Rainfall decides depth and leaching - shallow, calcareous and unleached in the west; deeper and more developed in the east and south.
- Almost every soil group in Rajasthan is deficient in nitrogen and organic matter; phosphorus is often deficient too.
- Only alluvial and black soils are naturally productive without heavy input.

Soil transect - walk from Jaisalmer to Jhalawar



The soil types with their districts - the master table

This is the table that answers the matching question. Read it as blocks of the map, not as isolated names: sand in the west, brown along the Luni, red in the Aravallis and the south, alluvium in the east, black in Hadoti, salt around the canal command and the salt lakes.

Soil types of Rajasthan and their districts

Soil type	Districts	Character
Desert / arid sandy	Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner, Jodhpur, Churu, Nagaur	Largest area in the state; low humus and nitrogen; calcareous; highly porous
Brown (non-calcic brown)	Luni basin - Pali, Jalore, Sirohi, Ajmer, parts of Sikar and Jhunjhunu	Comparatively rich in phosphate
Red-yellow	Sawai Madhopur, Bhilwara, Udaipur, Rajsamand, Ajmer, Tonk	From granite and gneiss; deficient in nitrogen and calcium
Red loamy	Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh, Udaipur, Chittorgarh	Humid south; iron oxides give the colour
Mixed red and black	Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh, Bhilwara, Banswara, Jhalawar	Where Aravalli metamorphics meet Deccan lava; potash sufficient, N and P deficient
Black / medium black	Hadoti - Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar	From Deccan lava; high clay, strong moisture retention
Alluvial	Bharatpur, Dholpur, Alwar, Jaipur, Dausa, Tonk, Karauli, Sawai Madhopur, Ganganagar canal tract	The most fertile group in the state
Saline-alkaline (Reh, Kallar, Usar)	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Barmer, Jalore, Pali, Sambhar-Pachpadra belt	From capillary rise of salts and over-irrigation
Lithosols and regosols	Aravalli slopes	Thin skeletal soils, almost no profile development, very low agricultural value

Points that turn up as statement questions

- Desert soils are highly porous with low water-holding capacity, poor in humus and nitrogen, but calcareous and often carrying a kankar or gypsum layer.
- Black soils crack deeply in summer and are self-mulching - the crack lets air in and closes when wet.

- Alluvial soils of the eastern plain are laid down by the Banganga, Gambhir, Chambal and Banas systems.
- Red-yellow soil comes from granite and gneiss weathering, black from Deccan basalt, desert soil from wind-blown sand, alluvium from river deposition.

TRAP

Two set traps. Churu is arid Thar - it carries DESERT SANDY soil, never red loam. And black soil belongs to HADOTI, not to Shekhawati; Shekhawati carries sandy and brown soils.

The soil orders - USDA and ICAR taxonomy

The modern classification names soils by order rather than by colour. Rajasthan has five orders. Map each order onto the colour-name soil you already know and you never have to learn the districts twice. Entisol is the youngest soil with no horizon development; Aridisol is the true desert order; Vertisol is the swelling black clay; Alfisol is the moderately leached soil with a clay-enriched subsoil; Inceptisol is the young but slightly developed soil in between.

Soil orders of Rajasthan mapped to regions

Order	What it is	Districts / region
Entisol	Youngest order, almost no horizon development - LARGEST extent in the state	Western Rajasthan generally
Aridisol	The true desert order	Jaisalmer, Bikaner, Churu, Jhunjhunu
Inceptisol	Young soils with the beginnings of horizon development	Udaipur, Rajsamand, Chittorgarh, Banswara, Dungarpur

Order	What it is	Districts / region
Vertisol	Deep swelling clays, self-mulching, crack widely when dry - the black cotton soil	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar (Hadoti)
Alfisol	Moderately leached, clay-enriched subsoil	Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli

The two orders RPSC contrasts most - Entisol versus Vertisol

Entisol	Vertisol
Largest extent in Rajasthan	Confined to the Hadoti plateau
Western arid plain	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar
Youngest order - no horizon development	Deep, mature swelling-clay profile
Sandy, porous, very low moisture retention	Heavy clay, excellent moisture retention
Corresponds to the desert sandy soil	Corresponds to the black cotton soil

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho by the name's meaning - ENTisol from 'recent', so youngest and biggest here; ARIDisol for the arid core; VERTisol from 'vertere', to turn, because the cracking clay churns itself; ALFisol has Aluminium and iron (Al-Fe) in a clay-rich B horizon; INCEPTisol is at the inception of development.

TRAP

Oxisols do NOT occur in Rajasthan. They are the deeply weathered soils of the humid equatorial tropics. Rajasthan's five are Entisol, Aridisol, Inceptisol, Vertisol and Alfisol.

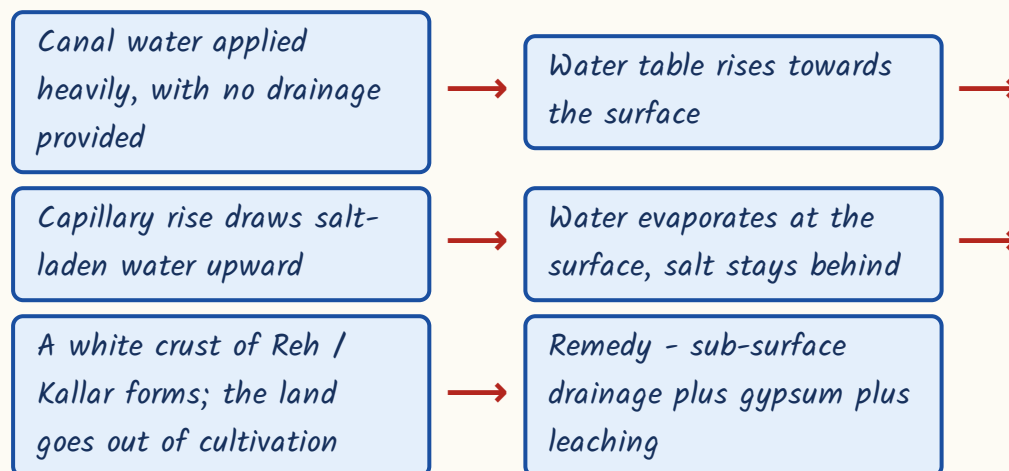
Soil problems - each one belongs to a region

Every soil problem in Rajasthan has an address. Wind erosion belongs to the Thar, ravines to the Chambal tract, waterlogging to the canal command, salinity to the canal command and the salt-lake belt. If you can name the region, you can answer the question - and this is exactly how the matching question is set.

Soil problem matched to the area affected

Problem	Area chiefly affected	Cause
Wind erosion and dune movement	Western Rajasthan - Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner, Jodhpur	High wind velocity, loose sand, sparse vegetation
Sheet, rill and gully erosion (ravines)	Chambal tract - Dholpur, Karauli, Sawai Madhopur	Steep gradients and torrential runoff on soft alluvium
Waterlogging	Indira Gandhi Nahar command - Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh	Over-irrigation with inadequate drainage
Secondary salinity and alkalinity	IGNP command; also Sambhar and Pachpadra surroundings	Rising water table bringing salts to the surface

How a canal command turns saline - the sequence RPSC likes



- The Chambal ravines of Dholpur, Karauli and Sawai Madhopur are among India's most severely gullied badlands.
- Rajasthan has the largest area under land degradation and desertification of any Indian state, as mapped in ISRO's Desertification and Land Degradation Atlas.

- Wind erosion is the principal process of land degradation in the state.
- Reh, Kallar and Usar are the local names for salt-affected land.

Reclamation – the fix for each problem

Match the cure to the disease. Gypsum for alkalinity, drainage for waterlogging, plantation for wind, engineering for water erosion. RPSC has asked which amendment reclaims an alkaline soil – the answer is gypsum, and lime is the distractor.

- Gypsum for alkaline soils – the calcium in gypsum displaces sodium from the soil complex, and the sodium salts are then leached out.
- Sub-surface drainage for waterlogging in the IGNP command.
- Shelterbelt plantation and sand-dune stabilisation against wind erosion.
- Contour bunding, check dams and gully plugging against water erosion in the ravine tract.

Do not confuse the two amendments. Gypsum is for alkaline soil, which is Rajasthan's problem. Lime is for acidic soil, which is not a Rajasthan problem at all. If an option offers lime for reclaiming a Rajasthan soil, it is wrong – that single swap is the whole question.

The ten agro-climatic zones – a classic RPSC target

Rajasthan is divided into ten agro-climatic zones. They were delineated under the National Agricultural Research Project on the basis of rainfall, soil, temperature and topography, and they are grouped into five broad regions numbered I to V. The numbering runs from the arid north-west to the humid south-east, so the zone number and the rainfall rise together. Learn the table;

then learn the shape of the numbering, which is what lets you reconstruct it under pressure.

The ten agro-climatic zones of Rajasthan

Zone	Name	Core districts
I-A	Arid Western Plain	Barmer and part of Jodhpur; rainfall about 200-370 mm; sandy soil
I-B	Irrigated North-Western Plain	Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh - the only fully canal-irrigated zone; wheat, cotton, mustard
I-C	Hyper Arid Partial Irrigated Zone	Bikaner, Churu and Jaisalmer - the driest zone of the state
II-A	Transitional Plain of Inland Drainage	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Nagaur and part of Churu - the Shekhawati tract
II-B	Transitional Plain of Luni Basin	Jalore, Pali and parts of Sirohi and Jodhpur
III-A	Semi-Arid Eastern Plain	Jaipur, Ajmer, Dausa and Tonk; rainfall roughly 500-600 mm
III-B	Flood Prone Eastern Plain	Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli and Sawai Madhopur
IV-A	Sub-Humid Southern Plain	Udaipur, Chittorgarh, Rajsamand, Bhilwara and part of Pratapgarh
IV-B	Humid Southern Plain	Dungarpur and Banswara - among the highest-rainfall zones
V	Humid South-Eastern Plain (Hadoti)	Kota, Bundi, Baran and Jhalawar - deep black soils, the most productive farmland of the state

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho the shape 3-2-2-2-1. Region I has THREE zones (the arid west: Arid, Irrigated, Hyper-arid), II has TWO (both Transitional - Inland Drainage and Luni Basin), III has TWO (both Eastern - Semi-Arid and Flood Prone), IV has TWO (both Southern - Sub-Humid and Humid), and V stands ALONE (Hadoti). $3+2+2+2+1 = 10$. Recite the shape first, then fill in the districts.

- A second aid - the numbers climb with the rain: Region I is driest, Region V is wettest.
- The sequence runs north-west to south-east, the same diagonal as the rainfall chapter.
- So if you know the rainfall map, you already know the order of the zones.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked directly by RPSC - into how many agro-climatic zones has Rajasthan been divided? Answer: ten, grouped into five broad regions numbered I to V.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked - Bikaner, Churu and Jaisalmer fall in which agro-climatic zone?

Answer: Zone I-C, the Hyper Arid Partial Irrigated Zone, the driest zone of the state.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked - Jaipur, Ajmer, Dausa and Tonk fall in which zone? Answer: Zone III-A, the Semi-Arid Eastern Plain. Its companion, Zone III-B Flood Prone Eastern Plain, covers Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli and Sawai Madhopur.

TRAP

The most common wrong pairing is putting Bikaner and Churu into Zone IV-A. Zone IV-A is the Sub-Humid SOUTHERN Plain - Udaipur, Chittorgarh, Rajsamand, Bhilwara. Bikaner and Churu are hyper-arid Zone I-C. Also do not slide Alwar-Bharatpur-Dholpur into II-B; II-B is the Luni basin.

- Zone I-B has low natural rainfall - its prosperity rests entirely on canal irrigation, which is why the name says 'Irrigated'.
- Ascending rainfall order across zones: I-C, then II-A, then III-A, then IV-B.
- Zones I-A, I-B and I-C together make up the arid western plain region; IV-A, IV-B and V cover the humid south and south-east.
- Zone V is the state's most productive farmland - deep black Vertisols with strong moisture retention.

One caution about district names. The zones were framed on the older district map. Rajasthan reorganised its districts in 2023 and revised that again in December 2024, and the state now has 41 districts and 7 divisions. Newer districts sit inside their old parents - Balotra inside the Barmer tract of Zone I-A, Phalodi inside the Jodhpur tract, Beawar and Kekri's area inside the Ajmer tract of Zone III-A, Didwana-Kuchaman inside the Nagaur tract of Zone II-A, Deeg and Khairthal-Tijara inside the Bharatpur and Alwar tracts of Zone III-B, Salumbar inside the Udaipur tract of Zone IV-A. RPSC still sets these questions in the old district names - answer in the names the question uses.

Soil health infrastructure and the current file

The administrative half of this chapter is short and easy marks. The state Department of Agriculture runs soil testing laboratories, static and mobile, in

the districts, and issues Soil Health Cards to farmers with the nutrient status of their own field and a fertiliser recommendation.

- Soil Health Card scheme - the card carries the field's nutrient status and a crop-wise fertiliser recommendation.
- Soil testing laboratories, both static and mobile, operate at district level under the state Department of Agriculture.
- The purpose is to correct Rajasthan's chronic nitrogen and organic-matter deficiency without over-applying urea.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): the Soil Health Card scheme completed a decade in 2025 and is now folded into the wider soil-health component of central agriculture schemes. On the degradation side, ISRO's Desertification and Land Degradation Atlas continues to place Rajasthan first among Indian states for degraded area - that ranking is the fact most likely to appear in a current-affairs or environment question.

Rapid linkages - be able to recite these both ways

Before the exam, test yourself in both directions. Given the district, name the soil, the order and the zone. Given the zone, name the districts. These three-way links are what the matching questions test.

District block - soil - order - zone, in one line each

District block	Soil and order	Agro-climatic zone
Jaisalmer, Bikaner, Churu	Desert sandy; Aridisol / Entisol	I-C Hyper Arid Partial Irrigated
Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh	Alluvial but salt-affected; Entisol	I-B Irrigated North-Western Plain

District block	Soil and order	Agro-climatic zone
Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Nagaur	Sandy and brown; Entisol / Aridisol	II-A Transitional Plain of Inland Drainage
Pali, Jalore, Sirohi	Brown non-calci; Entisol	II-B Transitional Plain of Luni Basin
Jaipur, Ajmer, Dausa, Tonk	Red-yellow and alluvial; Alfisol	III-A Semi-Arid Eastern Plain
Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli	Alluvial; Alfisol	III-B Flood Prone Eastern Plain
Udaipur, Chittorgarh, Rajsamand, Bhilwara	Red-yellow and mixed red-black; Inceptisol	IV-A Sub-Humid Southern Plain
Dungarpur, Banswara	Red loamy; Inceptisol	IV-B Humid Southern Plain
Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar	Black / medium black; Vertisol	V Humid South-Eastern Plain (Hadoti)

- The soil order and the zone move together across the map - that is the shortcut.
- Aridisol with Zone I; Entisol with Zones I and II; Alfisol with Zone III.
- Inceptisol with Zone IV; Vertisol with Zone V.
- One diagonal, three labels - district, soil order, agro-climatic zone.

REVISION RECAP

1. Desert / arid sandy soil covers the largest area - Jaisalmer, Barmer, Bikaner, Jodhpur, Churu, Nagaur; porous, calcareous, poor in humus and nitrogen.
2. Brown non-calci soil = Luni basin (Pali, Jalore, Sirohi, Ajmer), comparatively rich in phosphate.
3. Red-yellow soil = Sawai Madhopur, Bhilwara, Udaipur, Rajsamand, Ajmer, Tonk, on granite and gneiss.
4. Red loamy = Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh, Udaipur, Chittorgarh; mixed red-black = Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh, Bhilwara, Banswara, Jhalawar.
5. Black / medium black = Hadoti (Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar), from Deccan lava, high clay, strong moisture retention.

6. Alluvial soil of the eastern plain is the most fertile group; saline-alkaline (Reh, Kallar, Usar) afflicts Sri Ganganagar-Hanumangarh and the Sambhar-Pachpadra belt.
7. Lithosols and regosols are the thin skeletal soils of the Aravalli slopes.
8. Orders: Entisol largest (west), Aridisol (Jaisalmer, Bikaner, Churu, Jhunjhunu), Inceptisol (Udaipur-Vagad), Vertisol (Hadoti), Alfisol (eastern plain). No Oxisols in Rajasthan.
9. Vertisol = black cotton soil, self-mulching, deep summer cracks; Entisol = youngest, no horizons.
10. Wind erosion and dunes = the west; ravines and gullies = the Chambal tract of Dholpur, Karauli, Sawai Madhopur.
11. Waterlogging and secondary salinity = the Indira Gandhi Nahar command in Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh.
12. Rajasthan has the largest degraded and desertified area of any Indian state (ISRO Desertification and Land Degradation Atlas).
13. Reclamation: gypsum for alkalinity, sub-surface drainage for waterlogging, shelterbelts and dune stabilisation for wind, contour bunding and check dams for water erosion. Lime is for acidic soil, not here.
14. Rajasthan has TEN agro-climatic zones grouped into five regions I to V, delineated under the National Agricultural Research Project.
15. Shape of the grouping: 3-2-2-2-1 across regions I to V; zone number and rainfall rise together from north-west to south-east.
16. I-A Arid Western Plain (Barmer, part Jodhpur); I-B Irrigated North-Western Plain (Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh); I-C Hyper Arid (Bikaner, Churu, Jaisalmer).
17. II-A Inland Drainage (Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Nagaur); II-B Luni Basin (Jalore, Pali, part Sirohi and Jodhpur).
18. III-A Semi-Arid Eastern Plain (Jaipur, Ajmer, Dausa, Tonk); III-B Flood Prone Eastern Plain (Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur, Karauli, Sawai Madhopur).
19. IV-A Sub-Humid Southern Plain (Udaipur, Chittorgarh, Rajsamand, Bhilwara); IV-B Humid Southern Plain (Dungarpur, Banswara); V Hadoti (Kota, Bundi, Baran, Jhalawar), the most productive.
20. The zones were framed on the pre-2023 district map; Rajasthan now has 41 districts and 7 divisions after the December 2024 revision.

RG06

Biodiversity Conservation: Parks, Sanctuaries, Reserves

Rajasthan Geography gives 11-15 questions every paper, and protected areas alone contribute 2-4 of them. Sanctuary-to-district matching was asked in 2016, 2021, 2023 and 2024; tiger reserve count and the newest reserve came in 2023 and 2024; Ramsar sites in 2016 and 2023. Format is match-the-following, NOT-correctly-matched and statement-based.

This is the biggest matching chapter in Rajasthan Geography. RPSC almost never asks you to explain conservation - it asks you which district a sanctuary is in, which animal it is famous for, and in which year a tiger reserve was notified. So the whole chapter is really four tables plus a species section, and it must be learnt cold.

Protected Areas of Rajasthan

National parks (5)

- Ranthambore - Sawai Madhopur
- Keoladeo Ghana - Bharatpur
- Sariska - Alwar
- Desert NP - Jaisalmer, Barmer
- Mukundra Hills - Kota belt

Tiger reserves (5 notified)

- Ranthambore 1973
- Sariska 1978
- Mukundra Hills 2013
- Ramgarh Vishdhari 2022
- Dholpur-Karauli 2023
- Kumbhalgarh - proposed 6th

Star sanctuaries

- Tal Chhapar - blackbuck
- Sitamata - flying squirrel
- National Chambal - gharial
- Kumbhalgarh - Indian wolf
- Mount Abu - evergreen patches

Conservation reserves

- Bisalpur, Tonk - first, 2008
- Jodbeed Gadhwala - vultures
- Jawai Bandh - leopard
- Sundha Mata - Jalore, Sirohi
- Sorsan - lesser florican

Ramsar sites (5)

- Keoladeo Ghana 1981
- Sambhar Lake 1990
- Khichan 2025
- Menar 2025
- Siliserh, Alwar 2025

Species projects

- Godawan - Project GIB 2013
- Chinkara - state animal
- Jhalana - first leopard reserve
- Sariska - first tiger relocation
- Khichan - demoiselle cranes

State symbols

- Bird - Godawan (1981)
- Animal wild - chinkara (1981)
- Animal domestic - camel (2014)
- Tree - khejri
- Flower - rohida

People and institutions

- Kailash Sankhala - Tiger Man
- Amrita Devi Bishnoi - Khejarli 1730
- Jaipur Zoo 1876
- Wildlife Week 2-8 October

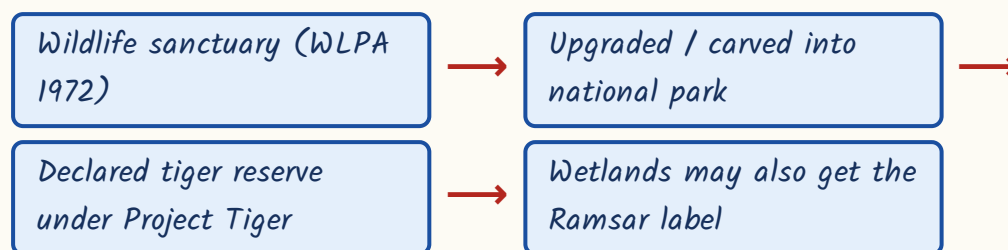
Start here - the legal ladder of protection

Before any table, get the categories straight. All protection in India runs on the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972. That Act gives four kinds of protected area - national park, wildlife sanctuary, conservation reserve and community reserve.

The last two were added by the 2002 amendment, which is why every conservation reserve in Rajasthan is from 2008 onwards.

A tiger reserve is not a fifth category. It is a management layer placed on top of existing parks and sanctuaries under Project Tiger, launched in 1973, and administered by the NTCA. That is why Ranthambore is a national park AND a tiger reserve at the same time, and why Kailadevi and Sawai Man Singh sanctuaries sit inside the Ranthambore Tiger Reserve as buffer. A Ramsar site is different again - it is an international wetland label under the Ramsar Convention of 1971, not an Indian legal category.

How the layers stack in Rajasthan



National park vs wildlife sanctuary - the difference RPSC tests indirectly

National park	Wildlife sanctuary
Highest degree of protection	Slightly lower degree of protection
No grazing or human rights allowed	Certain rights may be permitted
Boundary altered only by state legislature resolution	Easier to alter
Rajasthan has five	Rajasthan has roughly two dozen

TRAP

Do not memorise a single number for sanctuaries and conservation reserves. Sources differ (about 25-27 sanctuaries, and conservation reserves keep being added) because notifications keep coming. The numbers that are fixed and asked are: national parks 5, notified tiger reserves 5, Ramsar sites 5.

The five national parks - learn the district before anything else

Five national parks, and every one of them has a district that gets asked directly. Two of them - Ranthambore and Sariska - are also tiger reserves. One, Keoladeo, is a wetland with no big cat at all. Desert National Park is the giant by area; Keoladeo is the pocket-sized one.

National parks of Rajasthan

National park	District(s)	Known for
Ranthambore	Sawai Madhopur	Tiger; Padam Talab, Raj Bagh, Jogi Mahal, Trinetra Ganesh temple
Keoladeo Ghana	Bharatpur	Birds; smallest NP (28.73 sq km); UNESCO site
Sariska	Alwar	Tiger; site of the world's first tiger relocation
Desert National Park	Jaisalmer and Barmer	Largest NP, about 3,162 sq km; Great Indian Bustard
Mukundra Hills	Kota, Bundi, Jhalawar, Chittorgarh	Carved out of Darrah, Jawahar Sagar and Chambal sanctuaries

- Largest national park - Desert National Park, about 3,162 sq km.
- Smallest national park - Keoladeo Ghana, 28.73 sq km.
- Ranthambore was one of the nine original Project Tiger reserves of 1973; national park in 1980.
- Sariska - tiger reserve 1978, national park 1982.
- Desert NP is the principal surviving refuge of the godawan.
- Kumbhalgarh is a sanctuary and a proposed tiger reserve - NOT a national park; Sitamata is a sanctuary, not a tiger reserve.

Keoladeo Ghana - the most asked single site in this chapter

Keoladeo was a duck-shooting preserve of the Bharatpur rulers. It grew around the Ajan Bandh, built by Maharaja Suraj Mal, and is fed by the Gambhir and Banganga rivers. Learn its four dates in order, because they are asked as an ordering question: bird sanctuary 1956, Ramsar site 1981, national park 1982, UNESCO World Heritage Site 1985. The Siberian crane, its old star visitor, was last recorded there in 2002.

RPSC's favourite negative framing in this section is 'which of the following is NOT a national park' or 'NOT a tiger reserve'. The stock wrong options are Kumbhalgarh and Sitamata. Both are sanctuaries.

Tiger reserves – the notification years ARE the question

Rajasthan has five notified tiger reserves as of September 2026. A sixth, Kumbhalgarh-Todgarh Raoli, has only in-principle approval. Say that carefully in the exam – papers have been set on both the count and on which one is newest, and the state is often reported loosely in the press as 'getting its sixth reserve'.

Tiger reserves of Rajasthan with notification years

Tiger reserve	District(s)	Notified
Ranthambore	Sawai Madhopur	1973 – one of the original nine Project Tiger reserves
Sariska	Alwar	1978
Mukundra Hills	Kota, Bundi, Jhalawar, Chittorgarh	2013
Ramgarh Vishdhari	Bundi	2022
Dholpur-Karauli	Dholpur and Karauli	2023 – India's 54th, Rajasthan's newest
Kumbhalgarh-Todgarh Raoli	Rajsamand, Udaipur, Pali, Ajmer, Sirohi	In-principle approval August 2023; proposed sixth, not yet notified (as of Sept 2026)

Chronology - this exact order was asked as an ordering question



YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho the years as a story: 73-78 (the Indira era), then a 35-year gap, then 13-22-23 in a rush. Two in the 1970s, three since 2013. Ramgarh Vishdhari sits in Bundi - remember 'Vishdhari is in Bundi, and the Mej river runs through it'.

Sariska is the reserve with a story attached, and the story is examinable.

Sariska lost all its tigers by 2004-05. In June 2008 tiger ST-1 was airlifted from Ranthambore to Sariska - the world's first relocation of a wild tiger by air. Kailash Sankhala of Jodhpur, the 'Tiger Man of India', was the first director of Project Tiger in 1973; Fateh Singh Rathore is the name associated with Ranthambore.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - which is the fifth and newest notified tiger reserve of Rajasthan? Answer: Dholpur-Karauli, notified 2023, India's 54th tiger reserve. RAS Pre 2023 asked the same table in statement form - five notified reserves, Ramgarh Vishdhari in Bundi, Mukundra Hills 2013, all correct.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: Kumbhalgarh still awaits final notification. NTCA cleared it in principle in August 2023 and the Union environment ministry followed, but the state has to submit the core-buffer and eco-sensitive zone proposal first. Until that notification appears, the correct exam answer to 'how many tiger reserves' remains FIVE.

Sanctuaries matched to districts - the single biggest table in the chapter

This is where the marks are. RPSC asked sanctuary-to-district matching in 2016, 2021, 2023 and 2024. Do not try to learn areas or notification years for all of them - learn district, and for the famous ones, the animal. Read the table twice a week till December.

Sanctuary to district - part I

Wildlife sanctuary	District(s)	Note
Tal Chhapar	Churu	Flat saline grassland; blackbuck, wintering harriers
Sitamata	Pratapgarh (extends to Chittorgarh, Udaipur)	Flying squirrel, chausingha
Kumbhalgarh	Rajsamand, Udaipur, Pali	Indian wolf; proposed tiger reserve
Mount Abu	Sirohi	1960; only sub-tropical evergreen patches of the state
National Chambal	Kota, Bundi, Sawai Madhopur, Dholpur, Karauli	1979; gharial, dolphin, skimmer
Todgarh-Raoli	Ajmer, Pali, Rajsamand	Aravalli sanctuary; part of the Kumbhalgarh proposal

Wildlife sanctuary	District(s)	Note
Jawahar Sagar	Kota, Bundi, Chittorgarh	On the Chambal; feeds Mukundra Hills
Darrah (Rajiv Gandhi)	Kota	Merged into the Mukundra Hills landscape
Sajjangarh	Udaipur	Smallest sanctuary of Rajasthan; around the Monsoon Palace
Phulwari ki Naal	Udaipur	Dense southern Aravalli forest
Jaisamand	Udaipur	Around the Jaisamand lake
Bassi	Chittorgarh	Also has a conservation reserve of the same name
Bhainsrodgarh	Chittorgarh	On the Chambal gorge
Shergarh	Baran	1983; on the Parvan river

Sanctuary to district - part 2

Wildlife sanctuary	District(s)	Note
Kailadevi	Karauli (extends to Sawai Madhopur)	1983; buffer of Ranthambore Tiger Reserve
Sawai Man Singh	Sawai Madhopur	Buffer of Ranthambore Tiger Reserve
Ramgarh Vishdhari	Bundi	Now the core of the 2022 tiger reserve
Bandh Baretha	Bharatpur	Wetland-linked bird habitat
Kesarbagh	Dholpur	Chinkara country
Van Vihar	Dholpur	Old shooting preserve of the Dholpur rulers
Ram Sagar	Dholpur	Waterbirds
Gajner	Bikaner	Imperial sandgrouse, blackbuck; around Gajner lake and palace
Dhawa (Doli)	Jodhpur	Blackbuck and chinkara
Jamwa Ramgarh	Jaipur	Around the old Ramgarh lake

Wildlife sanctuary	District(s)	Note
Nahargarh	Jaipur	Biological park attached
Jhalana	Jaipur	India's first leopard reserve, 2017
Sariska-A	Alwar	Extension block of the Sariska landscape

- Sanctuaries spread over three districts - Kumbhalgarh, Todgarh-Raoli, Jawahar Sagar, Sitamata.
- Dholpur alone holds three sanctuaries - Kesarbagh, Van Vihar and Ram Sagar.
- Kailadevi and Sawai Man Singh are the two sanctuaries inside the Ranthambore Tiger Reserve.
- Smallest sanctuary of the state - Sajjangarh, Udaipur.

TRAP

Two traps in one. First: Todgarh-Raoli is Ajmer-Pali-Rajsamand, NOT Bharatpur - this exact wrong pair has been printed. Second: after the December 2024 reorganisation Rajasthan is back to 41 districts and 7 divisions, so some books show older or newer district names. Khichan is now placed in Phalodi district. For a sanctuary, answer with the classical district (Udaipur, Jodhpur, Barmer) unless the option list clearly uses new districts.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and again in 2024 as a match - Bandh Baretha = Bharatpur, Kesarbagh = Dholpur, Sajjangarh = Udaipur, Sawai Man Singh = Sawai Madhopur. In RAS Pre 2024 the set was Bassi = Chittorgarh, Phulwari ki Naal = Udaipur, Jamwa Ramgarh = Jaipur, Gajner = Bikaner.

Sanctuary to famous species - the second matching set

The other way RPSC frames the same table is species-to-place. Each of these pairs is fixed and none of them overlaps, which is exactly why they make clean options. One warning before you start: godawan is never matched with Keoladeo. Keoladeo is a wetland bird park in Bharatpur; the bustard is a dry-grassland bird of Jaisalmer. 'Great Indian Bustard - Keoladeo' is a standard planted distractor.

Species to protected area

Species	Where you say
Blackbuck	Tal Chhapar (Churu); also Dhawa-Doli, Gajner
Indian giant flying squirrel (uran gilheri)	Sitamata (Pratapgarh)
Chausingha (four-horned antelope)	Sitamata; also Kumbhalgarh
Gharial, Gangetic dolphin, Indian skimmer	National Chambal Sanctuary
Indian wolf	Kumbhalgarh
Leopard	Jhalana and Amagarh (Jaipur), Jawai Bandh (Pali)
Great Indian Bustard (godawan)	Desert National Park (Jaisalmer, Barmer)
Lesser florican (kharmor)	Sorsan (Baran), Shokaliya (Ajmer)
Demoiselle crane (kurja)	Khichan (Phalodi)
Migratory vultures	Jodbeed Gadhwal (Bikaner)
Imperial sandgrouse	Gajner (Bikaner)
Flamingo and other waterbirds	Sambhar Lake in a good monsoon year

YAAD RAKHO

Trick for the four southern sanctuaries: Si-Ku-Ph-Sa - Sitamata (squirrel), Kumbhalgarh (wolf), Phulwari ki Naal (forest), Sajjanganarh (smallest). All four sit in the southern Aravalli belt around Udaipur.

Conservation reserves - newer, smaller, and heavily asked

Conservation reserves were made possible only by the 2002 amendment to the Wildlife Act. They cover land that is often community-owned or revenue land next to an existing protected area. Rajasthan's first three came in 2008, and the state has kept adding them - so the count moves, but the individual name-to-district pairs do not.

Conservation reserve to district

Conservation reserve	District(s)	Note
Bisalpur	Tonk	2008 - first conservation reserve of Rajasthan
Jodbeed Gadhwala	Bikaner	2008 - migratory vultures, including Eurasian griffon
Sundha Mata	Jalore and Sirohi	2008
Jawai Bandh	Pali	2013 - leopard, granite hills
Gudha Vishnoi	Jodhpur	Bishnoi-protected blackbuck country
Rotu	Nagaur	Khejri woodland
Gogelav	Nagaur	Grassland and blackbuck
Beed Jhunjhunu	Jhunjhunu	Old grazing beed
Mansa Mata	Jhunjhunu	Aravalli hill forest
Shakambhari	Sikar and Jhunjhunu	Northern Aravalli
Ummedganj Pakshi Vihar	Kota	Wetland birds
Baghdarrah (Waghdar) crocodile	Udaipur	Mugger crocodile
Sorsan	Baran	Lesser florican grassland
Shahbad	Baran	Dry deciduous forest

- Bassi and Hamirgarh conservation reserves - Chittorgarh and Bhilwara respectively.
- Kharmor Conservation Reserve is in Ajmer, named after the lesser florican.
- Khichan Conservation Reserve, Phalodi - the demoiselle crane village, now also a Ramsar site.
- First conservation reserve = Bisalpur (Tonk, 2008). Remember it with Bisalpur dam, Tonk.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 as a match - Jawai Bandh leopard reserve = Pali, Gudha Vishnoi = Jodhpur, Rotu = Nagaur, Ummedganj = Kota. Learn these four as a block; they have already earned their mark once.

TRAP

Beed Jhunjhunu is in Jhunjhunu, not Barmer - the fake pair 'Beed Jhunjhunu - Barmer' has appeared. Also keep Bassi sanctuary (Chittorgarh) apart from Bassi conservation reserve, and Sorsan conservation reserve (Baran) apart from Shokaliya grassland (Ajmer).

Species conservation - godawan, chinkara, leopard, gharial, cranes

Now the species side. Four or five programmes matter, and each has one number or one place attached to it. Learn the attachment, not the biology.

Great Indian Bustard - godawan

- Adopted as Rajasthan's state bird in 1981; local name godawan.
- Project Great Indian Bustard was launched by the state on 5 June 2013 - World Environment Day.

- Conservation breeding centres are at Sam-Sudasari and Ramdevra, both in Jaisalmer.
- Main wild habitat - Desert National Park; overhead power lines are its chief threat.
- Do not confuse the godawan with the kharmor (lesser florican) of Sorsan and Shokaliya.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the captive population raised at the Sudasari and Ramdevra centres in Jaisalmer crossed 80 birds by April 2026, built up through egg collection, natural breeding and artificial insemination. This is the best-publicised conservation success story in the state and is prime current-affairs material for December 2026.

- Big cats - Jhalana, Jaipur (2017) is India's first leopard reserve.
- Amargarh, also in Jaipur - Rajasthan's second leopard reserve.
- Jawai Bandh (Pali) - a conservation reserve famous for leopard density among granite hills.
- Tiger: Sariska received relocated tigers from Ranthambore from June 2008 onwards.
- Chinkara (Indian gazelle) - state animal, wild category, 1981; camel is the domestic-category state animal, 2014.

River, wetland and grassland species

- Gharial - National Chambal Sanctuary, 1979; the Chambal is India's best gharial river.
- Demoiselle cranes (kurja) winter at Khichan in Phalodi, fed by the local Jain community.
- Menar in Udaipur is the community-conserved 'bird village' of Rajasthan.

- Flamingos and other waterbirds appear at Sambhar, India's largest inland saline lake.
- Vultures congregate at Jodbeed Gadhwala near Bikaner's carcass dumping ground.

Ramsar sites – five, and three of them are brand new

For thirty-five years Rajasthan had only two Ramsar sites. Then 2025 added three at once. This is the highest-probability current-affairs fact in the whole chapter, so learn all five with their years and districts.

Ramsar sites of Rajasthan

Ramsar site	District	Designated
Keoladeo Ghana	Bharatpur	1981
Sambhar Lake	Jaipur, Nagaur, Ajmer	1990
Khichan	Phalodi	5 June 2025
Menar	Udaipur	5 June 2025
Siliserh Lake	Alwar	2025

- Ramsar Convention on Wetlands, 1971, signed at Ramsar in Iran.
- Keoladeo is both a Ramsar site (1981) and a UNESCO World Heritage Site (1985).
- Pushkar Lake is NOT a Ramsar site – a standard distractor.
- Khichan is famous for demoiselle cranes; Menar is the community-run bird village.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 - Sambhar Lake was designated a Ramsar site in 1990. Asked again in RAS Pre 2023 in count form - as of now Rajasthan has FIVE Ramsar sites. Both questions come from the same five-row table.

State symbols, people, institutions - the easy marks

Small section, quick marks. State symbols are asked as a straight one-liner or as a three-statement set. The people and institutions block is the Rajasthan-flavour part that separates a prepared candidate from a general reader.

State symbols of Rajasthan

Symbol	Name	Since
State bird	Godawan / Great Indian Bustard	1981
State animal (wild)	Chinkara	1981
State animal (domestic)	Camel	2014
State tree	Khejri (<i>Prosopis cineraria</i>)	-
State flower	Rohida (<i>Tecomella undulata</i>)	-

- Khejri is called the kalpavriksha of the desert; rohida is the 'Marwar teak' or desert teak.
- The Camel Act (prohibition of slaughter and regulation of export) followed in 2015.
- Khejarli, Jodhpur, 1730 - Amrita Devi Bishnoi and 362 Bishnois died defending khejri trees.
- The Amrita Devi Bishnoi Award is Rajasthan's highest wildlife honour.
- Kailash Sankhala of Jodhpur - 'Tiger Man of India', first director of Project Tiger.

- Biological parks - Nahargarh (Jaipur), Sajjangarh (Udaipur), Machia (Jodhpur), Abheda (Kota).
- Jaipur Zoo, 1876, is the oldest zoo of the state.
- Akal Wood Fossil Park near Jaisalmer - 180-million-year-old Jurassic fossilised tree trunks.
- Wildlife Week is observed from 2 to 8 October every year.
- The Rajasthan State Biodiversity Board works under the Biological Diversity Act, 2002, with Biodiversity Management Committees at panchayat level.

REVISION RECAP

1. Five national parks: Ranthambore (Sawai Madhopur), Keoladeo (Bharatpur), Sariska (Alwar), Desert (Jaisalmer-Barmer), Mukundra Hills (Kota belt).
2. Desert NP largest, about 3,162 sq km; Keoladeo smallest, 28.73 sq km.
3. Keoladeo dates in order - 1956 sanctuary, 1981 Ramsar, 1982 national park, 1985 UNESCO.
4. Ajan Bandh by Maharaja Suraj Mal; Gambhir and Banganga feed Keoladeo; Siberian crane last seen 2002.
5. Tiger reserves and years: Ranthambore 1973, Sariska 1978, Mukundra Hills 2013, Ramgarh Vishdhari 2022, Dholpur-Karauli 2023.
6. Dholpur-Karauli is India's 54th tiger reserve; Kumbhalgarh has only in-principle approval as the proposed sixth (September 2026).
7. World's first tiger airlift relocation - Ranthambore to Sariska, June 2008, tiger ST-1.
8. Tal Chhapar = Churu = blackbuck; Sitamata = Pratapgarh = flying squirrel; Mount Abu = Sirohi; Shergarh = Baran.
9. Kumbhalgarh sanctuary spans Rajsamand-Udaipur-Pali and is known for the Indian wolf.
10. Todgarh-Raoli = Ajmer, Pali, Rajsamand. Never Bharatpur.
11. Dholpur has three sanctuaries - Kesarbagh, Van Vihar, Ram Sagar; Sajjangarh (Udaipur) is the smallest.
12. Kailadevi (Karauli) and Sawai Man Singh (Sawai Madhopur) form the Ranthambore buffer.
13. First conservation reserve - Bisalpur, Tonk, 2008; Jodbeed Gadhwal (Bikaner) for vultures.

14. Jawai Bandh (Pali) leopard, Gudha Vishnoi (Jodhpur), Rotu and Gogelav (Nagaur), Ummedganj (Kota).
15. Five Ramsar sites - Keoladeo 1981, Sambhar 1990, Khichan and Menar June 2025, Siliserh (Alwar) 2025.
16. State symbols - godawan 1981, chinkara 1981, camel 2014, khejri, rohida.
17. Project GIB launched 5 June 2013; breeding centres Sam-Sudasari and Ramdevra, Jaisalmer.
18. Jhalana (Jaipur, 2017) India's first leopard reserve; Amagarh the second.
19. Khejarli 1730 - Amrita Devi Bishnoi, 362 martyrs; the state's top wildlife award carries her name.
20. Kailash Sankhala - Tiger Man of India, first Project Tiger director; Wildlife Week 2-8 October; Jaipur Zoo 1876.

RG07

Agriculture and Crops of Rajasthan

Rajasthan Geography gives 11-15 questions every paper and agriculture reliably takes 2-3. The documented repeats are the National Research Centres (2016, 2018, 2023), Walra shifting cultivation (2013, 2018), hybrid varieties Mahi Kanchan and RCB 911 (2023, 2024), and crop-to-leading-district matching. Match-the-following and NOT-correctly-matched dominate.

Rajasthan farms the driest land in the country, and that single fact writes the whole chapter - coarse millets and pulses in the west, canal wheat and cotton in the north-west, soybean and oranges in the humid south-east. RPSC does not ask you about farming practice. It asks crop-to-district, crop-to-national-rank, variety-to-crop, and institution-to-city. Those four tables are the chapter.

Agriculture of Rajasthan

Seasons

- Kharif - bajra, jowar, maize, moth, guar, groundnut, cotton, til, soybean
- Rabi - wheat, barley, gram, mustard, taramira, isabgol, coriander
- Zaid - summer vegetables and fodder

First in India

- Bajra
- Rapeseed-mustard
- Guar
- Moth bean
- Isabgol
- Henna
- Cumin - largest AREA

Other ranks

- Groundnut 2nd
- Soybean 3rd
- Jowar 3rd
- Total pulses 3rd

Seed spice belt

- Cumin - Jodhpur, Barmer, Jalore, Nagaur
- Coriander - Baran, Kota, Jhalawar
- Fenugreek - Nagaur
- Isabgol - Jalore
- Ramganj Mandi - Asia's largest dhanian market

Horticulture

- Kinnow - Sriganganagar
- Orange - Jhalawar
- Mathania chilli - Jodhpur
- Sojat henna - Pali, GI tag
- Olive refinery - Bassi, Jaipur
- Date palm CoE - Sagra-Bhojka, Jaisalmer

Varieties

- Maize - Mahi Kanchan, Mahi Dhawal, Pratap Makka
- Bajra - RCB 911, RHB series, HHB 67 Improved

Research centres

- NRC Seed Spices - Tabiji, Ajmer, 2000
- NRC Camel - Bikaner
- CIAH - Bikaner
- CAZRI - Jodhpur, 1959
- CSWRI - Avikanagar, Tonk, 1962
- DRMR - Sear, Bharatpur

Universities and policy

- SKRAU Bikaner 1987 - first
- MPUAT Udaipur 1999
- SKNAU Jobner
- AU Jodhpur, AU Kota 2013
- First separate agriculture budget - Feb 2022
- 10 agro-climatic zones

Traditional systems

- Walra - Bhil shifting cultivation
- Chimata - plains and lower slopes
- Dajiya - hill slopes
- Dry-land farming, khadin

The shape of Rajasthan's agriculture - understand this and the tables make sense

Rajasthan is India's largest state by area but most of it is arid or semi-arid, and the bulk of its cropland is rain-fed. Two consequences follow, and both are examinable. First, the state specialises in crops that survive on little water - bajra, moth, guar, mustard, cumin, isabgol, henna. That is exactly why Rajasthan tops India in those crops and not in rice or sugarcane. Second, wherever canal water arrives - Sriganganagar and Hanumangarh on the Indira Gandhi Canal - the cropping pattern flips to wheat, cotton and kinnow.

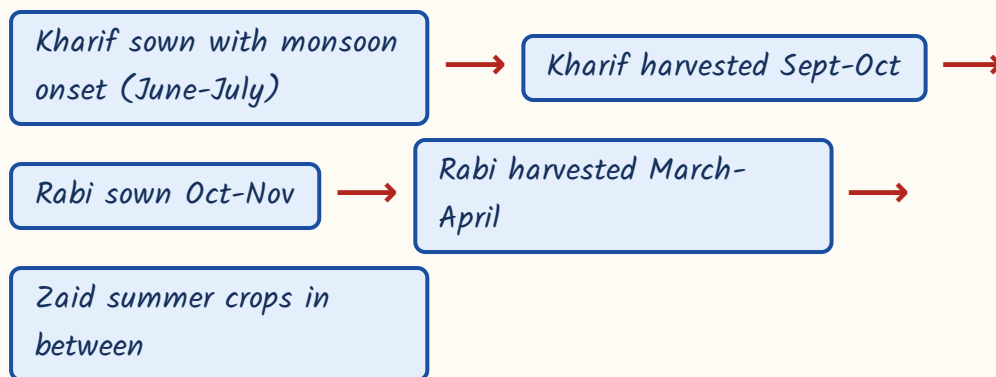
The south-east, the Hadoti plateau of Kota, Bundi, Baran and Jhalawar, is the wettest corner with black soil. That is Rajasthan's soybean, coriander and orange country. Keep this three-way division in your head - arid west, canal north-west, humid south-east - and you can reconstruct half the crop-district table without memorising it.

- Rajasthan is divided into 10 agro-climatic zones, out of 126 identified for India by ICAR.
- Zone names you should recognise - Arid Western Plain, Irrigated North Western Plain, Transitional Plain of Luni Basin, Humid South Eastern Plain.
- Kharif is the bigger season in Rajasthan by area; rabi is the bigger season by value where irrigation exists.
- Sugarcane is marginal - confined to Bundi, Sriganganagar, Chittorgarh and Udaipur; Keshoraipatan (Bundi) has the best-known cooperative sugar mill.

Kharif vs rabi in Rajasthan

Kharif (monsoon crop)	Rabi (winter crop)
Sown June-July with the monsoon, harvested Sept-Oct	Sown Oct-Nov, harvested March-April
Bajra, jowar, maize, moth, guar, groundnut, cotton, sesame, soybean	Wheat, barley, gram, mustard, taramira, isabgol, coriander
Mostly rain-fed, arid and southern districts	Mostly irrigated, canal and well districts
Bajra is the leading crop	Mustard and wheat are the leading crops

The crop calendar - a favourite statement-based trap



TRAP

Season confusion is the standard planted error. Moth bean is KHARIF, not rabi. Barley is RABI, not kharif. Bajra is kharif. Guar and sesame are kharif; taramira and isabgol are rabi. RPSC has used exactly these swaps in 'which is NOT a rabi crop' questions.

Kharif crops - bajra is the king

Bajra is the crop of the Rajasthan monsoon. It tolerates sandy soil and low rain, so it spreads across the whole western half. Rajasthan is India's largest producer. Learn the split that RPSC loves: Alwar leads in PRODUCTION because it has better rain and yield, while Barmer has the largest AREA under the crop because it has more land and less of everything else.

Kharif crops and their leading districts

Crop	Leading district(s)	Note
Bajra	Alwar (production); Barmer (area)	Rajasthan is 1st in India
Guar (cluster bean)	Hanumangarh, then Bikaner	Rajasthan is 1st; guar gum is a major export
Moth bean	Arid western districts	Rajasthan is 1st in India
Groundnut	Bikaner	Rajasthan is 2nd in India

Crop	Leading district(s)	Note
Soybean	Jhalawar, then Baran	Rajasthan is 3rd, after MP and Maharashtra
Jowar	Ajmer	Rajasthan is 3rd in India
Maize	Southern belt - Udaipur, Banswara, Dungarpur, Chittorgarh	Tribal staple; Mahi and Pratap varieties
Cotton	Hanumangarh, Sriganganagar	Canal-irrigated north-west
Sesame (til)	Southern and south-eastern districts	Oilseed of the kharif season

- Guar gum is used as a fracturing agent by the petroleum industry - that is why guar prices swing with global oil drilling.
- Rajasthan accounts for the bulk of India's guar and guar-gum output.
- Moth, guar and bajra together define the arid-west cropping pattern.
- Rajasthan ranks 3rd in India in total pulses; Nagaur leads the state.
- Learn this four-pair set as a block - guar Hanumangarh, soybean Jhalawar, isabgol Jalore, groundnut Bikaner.

Rabi crops - mustard first, then wheat and barley

Rabi in Rajasthan means mustard above everything else. Rajasthan is India's largest producer of rapeseed-mustard, and the belt runs across the eastern plains - Sriganganagar, Alwar and Bharatpur. The research backing is examinable too: the ICAR Directorate of Rapeseed-Mustard Research sits at Sewar in Bharatpur, right inside the belt.

Rabi crops and their leading districts

Crop	Leading district(s)	Note
Rapeseed-mustard	Sriganganagar, Alwar, Bharatpur	Rajasthan is 1st in India; DRMR at Sewar, Bharatpur

Crop	Leading district(s)	Note
Wheat	Sriganganagar, Hanumangarh	Canal-irrigated north-west
Barley	Jaipur	Rabi cereal of the semi-arid plains
Gram (chana)	Bikaner	Chief rabi pulse
Taramira	Arid western districts	Hardy oilseed of poor soils
Isabgol (psyllium)	Jalore	Rajasthan is 1st in India
Coriander	Baran, Kota, Jhalawar, Bundi	Ramganj Mandi is Asia's largest market

- Mustard is sown in October-November and harvested in the spring.
- Wheat and cotton share the same home - the canal tract of Sriganganagar and Hanumangarh.
- Cotton is NOT an Udaipur crop; that wrong pair has been used as a distractor.
- Rajasthan's rabi output depends heavily on the Indira Gandhi Canal and on winter mawath rain.

Where Rajasthan ranks in India - assert only what is solid

Ranks are the most dangerous part of this chapter, because coaching material repeats old figures and actual ranks shift with the season. So separate them into two groups. Group one - the ranks that are structural and safe to state. Group two - the ranks that move, where you should recognise the crop but not bet on a number.

Solid national ranks - state these with confidence

Crop	Rajasthan's rank	Leading district in the state
Bajra	1st	Alwar (production), Barmer (area)

Crop	Rajasthan's rank	Leading district in the state
Rapeseed-mustard	1st	Sriganganagar, Alwar, Bharatpur
Guar (cluster bean)	1st	Hanumangarh
Moth bean	1st	Arid west
Isabgol	1st	Jalore
Henna (mehndi)	1st	Sojat, Pali
Cumin	1st in AREA	Jodhpur, Barmer, Jalore, Nagaur, Pali
Groundnut	2nd	Bikaner
Soybean	3rd	Jhalawar
Jowar	3rd	Ajmer
Total pulses	3rd	Nagaur

TRAP

Two rank traps. One - Rajasthan is NOT first in soybean; it is third, behind Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra. RPSC has used 'Rajasthan is the largest producer of all EXCEPT' with soybean as the answer. Two - for cumin, Rajasthan leads in AREA; Gujarat is the other big cumin state and production leadership between the two moves year to year. Ranks for coriander, fenugreek, opium, barley and orange are quoted differently by different sources - recognise the crop, do not defend a number.

The standard framing is 'Rajasthan is the largest producer in India of all the following EXCEPT'. The answer is almost always soybean, because it sits with bajra, guar and moth bean in the option list and is the only one where Rajasthan is third.

The seed spice belt - Rajasthan's speciality

Seed spices are the crops whose seed is the product - cumin, coriander, fenugreek, fennel, ajwain, dill, isabgol. They need a dry ripening period, which is exactly what western and central Rajasthan offers. This is why the ICAR National Research Centre on Seed Spices was placed at Tabiji in Ajmer in 2000, and why RPSC keeps coming back to this belt.

Seed spices - crop to district

Spice	Belt	Marker fact
Cumin (jeera)	Jodhpur, Barmer, Jalore, Nagaur, Pali	Rajasthan has India's largest area under cumin
Coriander (dhanian)	Baran, Kota, Jhalawar, Bundi	Ramganj Mandi (Kota) - Asia's largest coriander market
Fenugreek (methi)	Nagaur	Nagaur is the fenugreek name to remember
Isabgol	Jalore	Rajasthan is India's largest producer
Henna (mehndi)	Sojat, Pali	GI tag; Rajasthan supplies almost all of India's henna

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho with initials - Ja-Na-Ko-So: JAlore isabgol, NAgaur methi, KOrta-Ramganj Mandi dhanian, SOjat mehndi. Four names, four districts, and they cover most of what gets asked from the spice belt.

- Ramganj Mandi is in Kota district and is described as Asia's largest coriander market.
- Sojat mehndi carries a Geographical Indication tag.
- The NRC on Seed Spices is at Tabiji, Ajmer - established 2000, NOT at Jaipur or Jodhpur.
- Cumin's other big state is Gujarat; coriander's other big states are MP and Gujarat.

Horticulture, plantation and licensed crops

Rajasthan's horticulture is a story of matching a fruit to a micro-climate. Citrus needs irrigation, so kinnow went to the canal north-west and orange to the humid Hadoti. Arid fruits - ber, aonla, date palm - suit the west. Olive was a deliberate state experiment, and it produced a fact RPSC likes: India's first olive oil refinery.

Horticultural and commercial products to places

Product	Place	Note
Kinnow	Sriganganagar, Hanumangarh	Canal-irrigated citrus
Orange (santra)	Jhalawar	Rajasthan's orange belt in Hadoti
Red chilli	Mathania, Jodhpur	The chilli of laal maas
Henna	Sojat, Pali	GI tag
Olive and olive oil	Bassi, Jaipur	India's first olive oil refinery; Rajasthan Olive Cultivation Ltd
Date palm	Sagra-Bhojka, Jaisalmer	Centre of Excellence for date palm
Ber and aonla	Arid western districts	Backed by CIAH, Bikaner
Opium poppy	Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh, Bhilwara, Jhalawar	Licensed; regulated by the Central Bureau of Narcotics

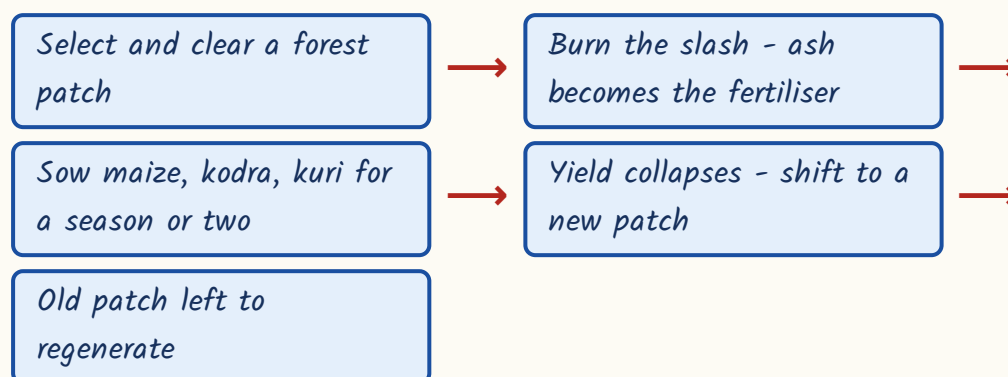
- Opium in Rajasthan is grown only under licence; the adjoining belt in Madhya Pradesh is Mandsaur-Neemuch.
- Olive cultivation is promoted through Rajasthan Olive Cultivation Ltd, a state venture.
- The Central Institute for Arid Horticulture at Bikaner works on ber, aonla, date palm and pomegranate.
- Sugarcane survives only in Bundi, Sriganganagar, Chittorgarh and Udaipur.

The four pairs that make a clean matching question out of this section are Ramganj Mandi (Kota) with coriander, Bassi (Jaipur) with the first olive oil refinery, Chittorgarh with licensed opium, and Sagra-Bhojka (Jaisalmer) with the date palm Centre of Excellence.

Walra, dry-land farming and the traditional systems

Walra is the one traditional practice RPSC has asked twice, in 2013 and 2018. It is the slash-and-burn shifting cultivation of the Bhils of southern Rajasthan - Udaipur, Dungarpur, Banswara and Sirohi. A forest patch is cleared and burnt, the ash fertilises the soil, a crop or two is taken, and then the family shifts. It has two named forms and both are asked.

The Walra cycle



The two forms of Walra

Chimata	Dajiya
Practised on plains and lower slopes	Practised on hill slopes
Larger, flatter clearings	Steeper, smaller patches
Both are forms of the same Bhil slash-and-burn system	Both are found in Udaipur, Dungarpur, Banswara, Sirohi

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 and again in 2018 - 'Walra' refers to shifting cultivation practised by the Bhils, and its two forms are Chimata (plains and lower slopes) and Dajiya (hill slopes). Two papers, one fact. Learn it word for word.

- Dry-land farming is the norm across western Rajasthan - moisture conservation, drought-hardy varieties, wide spacing.
- Khadin, the runoff-farming system of Jaisalmer, uses an earthen bund to trap runoff and grow a rabi crop on stored soil moisture.
- Contract farming and organic farming are promoted through state policy - the Rajasthan Organic Farming Policy came in 2017.
- Sprinkler and drip irrigation carry heavy state subsidy because of the groundwater situation.

Hybrid varieties and the National Research Centres - a

documented repeat

This section has earned marks in 2016, 2018, 2023 and 2024. Two small tables - variety-to-crop, and institution-to-city - and you can bank them. The variety question is always a NOT-correctly-matched: they attach a maize variety to bajra, or vice versa.

Hybrid and improved varieties

Crop	Varieties	Marker
Maize	Mahi Kanchan, Mahi Dhawal, Pratap Makka series	'Mahi' and 'Pratap' = maize, southern Rajasthan
Bajra	RCB 911, RHB series (Rajasthan Hybrid Bajra), HHB 67 Improved	Letter codes = bajra

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - 'Mahi Kanchan' is an improved variety of maize.
 Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - 'RCB 911' is a hybrid of bajra, and the NOT-matched version planted 'Mahi Kanchan - Bajra' as the wrong pair. Two consecutive papers on the same two names.

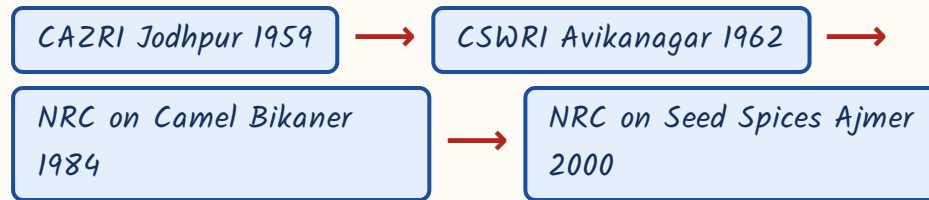
YAAD RAKHO

Trick to remember: names go with MAIZE, codes go with BAJRA. Mahi Kanchan, Mahi Dhawal, Pratap Makka - all maize. RCB 911, RHB, HHB 67 - all bajra. If the option carries a number, think bajra.

National research centres and institutes in Rajasthan

Institute	Place	Year / focus
ICAR-National Research Centre on Seed Spices	Tabiji, Ajmer	2000; cumin, coriander, fenugreek, fennel
ICAR-National Research Centre on Camel	Bikaner	1984
ICAR-Central Institute for Arid Horticulture (CIAH)	Bikaner	Ber, aonla, date palm, pomegranate
Central Arid Zone Research Institute (CAZRI)	Jodhpur	1959; desertification, arid farming, dune stabilisation
Arid Forest Research Institute (AFRI)	Jodhpur	Arid forestry
Central Sheep and Wool Research Institute (CSWRI)	Avikanagar, Malpura, Tonk	1962
ICAR-Directorate of Rapeseed-Mustard Research (DRMR)	Sewar, Bharatpur	Mustard belt

Chronology of the institutes - asked as an ordering question



ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - the National Research Centre on Seed Spices is at Ajmer. Asked in RAS Pre 2016 - NRC on Camel is at Bikaner, and the NOT-matched version planted 'Seed Spices - Jaipur'. Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - the Central Institute for Arid Horticulture is at Bikaner.

TRAP

Bikaner holds THREE of these - NRC on Camel, CIAH and the veterinary university RAJUVAS. Jodhpur holds CAZRI and AFRI. Ajmer holds only Seed Spices. The planted errors are 'Seed Spices - Jaipur' and 'CAZRI - Bikaner'.

Universities, policy, marketing and the current file

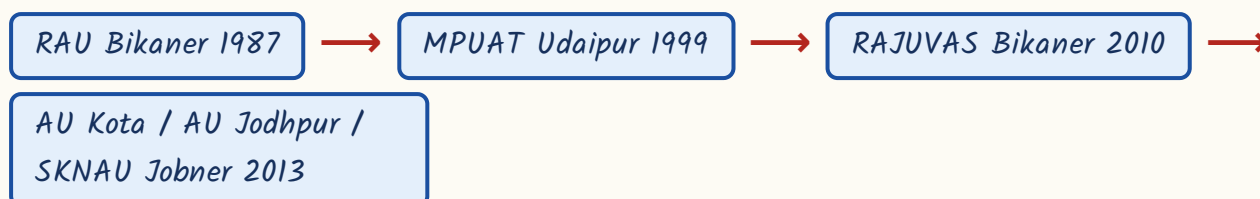
Finally the administrative layer. Rajasthan splits agricultural education by region, so each university has a headquarters town that is directly askable, plus a founding year that shows up in ordering questions. Note that the veterinary university is separate from the agriculture universities.

Agricultural universities of Rajasthan

University	Place	Year
Rajasthan Agricultural University, now SKRAU	Bikaner	1987 - the state's first
Maharana Pratap University of Agriculture and Technology (MPUAT)	Udaipur	1999

University	Place	Year
Rajasthan University of Veterinary and Animal Sciences (RAJUVAS)	Bikaner	2010
Sri Karan Narendra Agriculture University (SKNAU)	Jobner, Jaipur district	2013
Agriculture University	Jodhpur	2013
Agriculture University	Kota	2013

University chronology - an ordering favourite



- Rajasthan became the first Indian state to present a separate agriculture budget, in February 2022.
- Raj Kisan Saathi is the state portal delivering farmer services online.
- Crop insurance runs through the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY).
- The Rajasthan State Agricultural Marketing Board, 1974, runs the krishi upaj mandis.
- GRAM - Global Rajasthan Agritech Meet - was first held at Jaipur in 2016.
- Rajasthan Organic Farming Policy was announced in 2017.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: Rajasthan has continued the separate agriculture budget every year since the first one in February 2022, and the 2026-27 agriculture budget again ran as a stand-alone document with a 'Developed Rajasthan 2047' crop-target roadmap and heavy sprinkler and micro-irrigation subsidy. For the exam, the fact that carries the mark is the precedent itself - first state in India, February 2022.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a match - Seed Spices with Ajmer, Camel with Bikaner, CAZRI with Jodhpur, Rapeseed-Mustard Directorate with Sewar-Bharatpur. This is the single most reliable four-pair set in the whole chapter.

REVISION RECAP

1. Rajasthan is 1st in India in bajra, rapeseed-mustard, guar, moth bean, isabgol and henna; 2nd in groundnut; 3rd in soybean, jowar and total pulses.
2. Bajra - Alwar leads production, Barmer has the largest area.
3. Guar - Hanumangarh then Bikaner; guar gum is a petroleum-industry fracturing agent and a top export.
4. Mustard - Sriganganagar, Alwar, Bharatpur; DRMR at Sewar, Bharatpur.
5. Soybean - Jhalawar; groundnut - Bikaner; gram - Bikaner; barley - Jaipur; jowar - Ajmer; pulses - Nagaur.
6. Wheat and cotton belong to the canal north-west: Sriganganagar and Hanumangarh. Cotton is never Udaipur.
7. Cumin - largest AREA in India, western districts; Gujarat is the rival state, so do not over-claim production.
8. Coriander - Baran, Kota, Jhalawar; Ramganj Mandi in Kota is Asia's largest dhania market.
9. Fenugreek Nagaur, isabgol Jalore, henna Sojat (Pali) with a GI tag.
10. Kinnow Sriganganagar, orange Jhalawar, Mathania red chilli Jodhpur.
11. India's first olive oil refinery - Bassi, Jaipur; date palm Centre of Excellence - Sagra-Bhojka, Jaisalmer.
12. Opium is licensed in Chittorgarh, Pratapgarh, Bhilwara and Jhalawar under the Central Bureau of Narcotics.
13. Walra = Bhil slash-and-burn of southern Rajasthan; Chimata on plains and lower slopes, Dajiya on hill slopes.
14. Maize varieties Mahi Kanchan, Mahi Dhawal, Pratap Makka; bajra hybrids RCB 911, RHB series, HHB 67 Improved.
15. NRC Seed Spices - Tabiji, Ajmer, 2000. NRC Camel and CIAH - Bikaner. CAZRI and AFRI - Jodhpur. CSWRI - Avikanagar, Tonk.
16. Institute chronology: CAZRI 1959, CSWRI 1962, NRC Camel 1984, NRC Seed Spices 2000.

17. Universities: SKRAU Bikaner 1987 first, MPUAT Udaipur 1999, RAJUVAS Bikaner 2010, SKNAU Jobner / AU Jodhpur / AU Kota 2013.
18. Rajasthan has 10 agro-climatic zones out of India's 126.
19. First state in India with a separate agriculture budget - February 2022; Raj Kisan Saathi portal; PMFBY for insurance.
20. Sugarcane only in Bundi, Sriganganagar, Chittorgarh, Udaipur; Keshoraipatan (Bundi) cooperative sugar mill.

RG08

Livestock, Dairy and Fisheries of Rajasthan

Rajasthan Geography carries 11-15 questions a paper and animal husbandry supplies 1-2 of them, with more coming through the Economy and Science sections (research institutes, schemes). Breed matching is the single most likely format. Census ranks and the research centres at Bikaner, Jodhpur and Avikanagar are the repeat facts.

Rajasthan keeps more animals than almost any state in India, and RPSC turns that into the cleanest matching questions in the paper - breed to home district, breed to speciality, institution to city. There is nothing to understand here that a careful hour cannot fix; the whole chapter is recall, and the recall is worth 1-2 marks every single paper.

Livestock of Rajasthan

20th Census 2019

- 568 lakh animals - 2nd in India
- About 10.6% of national herd
- Goat 36.7% > cattle 24.5% > buffalo 24.1% > sheep 13.9%
- 1st in goat, camel, donkey
- Density about 166 per sq km

Cattle

- Rathi - Kamdhenu of Rajasthan
- Tharparkar - dual purpose, Thari
- Nagauri - draught
- Kankrej - sawai chaal
- Gir, Mewati, Malvi, Haryana

Sheep and wool

- Chokla - Jewel of Rajasthan
- Magra, Marwari, Nali, Pugal
- Jaisalmeri, Malpura, Sonadi
- 48% of India's wool (47.85%)
- Bikaner - Asia's largest wool market

Goat and camel

- Sirohi - meat; Jakhrana - milk
- Marwari, Barbari, Jamunapari
- Camel state animal 30 June 2014
- Bikaneri draught, Nachna riding
- Mewari - best camel milker

Dairy and institutions

- RCDF 1977, Jaipur, brand SARAS
- Three-tier Anand pattern
- RAJUVAS Bikaner 2010
- NRC on Camel, Jorbeed Bikaner
- CSWRI Avikanagar, Tonk

How big the herd is - and where Rajasthan stands

Start with what the state actually is. Rajasthan is dry, its cropping is risky, and for a large part of the population the animal is the insurance policy. When the monsoon fails the crop dies but the goat and the sheep survive, because they eat what the desert gives. That is why livestock here is not a side business - it is a second agriculture. The exam does not ask you to appreciate this. It asks you for numbers and ranks, so fix the numbers first.

- All livestock figures in the exam come from the 20th Livestock Census (2019). Name that census in your head every time.
- Rajasthan had about 568 lakh livestock - second in India after Uttar Pradesh.
- That is roughly 10.6 per cent of the national herd.
- Livestock density is about 166 animals per sq km.
- Species share: goat 36.7% > cattle 24.5% > buffalo 24.1% > sheep 13.9%.
- Rajasthan is India's largest wool producer - about 48% of national output (47.85%, Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2025); Jammu and Kashmir is a distant second.
- In milk Rajasthan is second after Uttar Pradesh (about 14.8% of national output, BAHS 2025), and first in goat milk.

Rajasthan's all-India ranks - 20th Livestock Census (2019)

Rank in India	Rajasthan is	Remember it as
1st	Goat, camel, donkey	The desert trio
2nd	Total livestock, buffalo	Always behind Uttar Pradesh
4th	Sheep	Not first - wool is first, sheep is fourth
6th	Cattle	Surprisingly low
17th	Poultry	The weakest sector of the state

Species share, largest to smallest (20th Census)



TRAP

This is where marks are lost. Rajasthan is **FIRST** in goat, camel, donkey and wool - but only **SECOND** in total livestock, buffalo and milk, **FOURTH** in sheep, **SIXTH** in cattle and **SEVENTEENTH** in poultry. Note the split personality: first in wool but fourth in sheep. The Rajasthani sheep gives a lot of wool per head, that is all. Also, cattle and buffalo shares are almost identical (24.5 and 24.1) - if an ordering question comes, cattle sits above buffalo.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the 21st Livestock Census was enumerated between October 2024 and February 2025, covering 16 species and 219 registered indigenous breeds. Its full state tables are not yet the standard reference, so answer every census question from the 20th Census (2019) unless the question itself names the 21st.

Cattle breeds - the biggest matching set in the chapter

Eight cattle breeds are examinable. Sort them in your head by purpose, not alphabetically. Milch breeds give milk, draught breeds pull the plough, dual-purpose breeds do both. Rajasthan's star milch breed is the *Rathi*; its star draught breed is the *Nagauri*. Everything else hangs between those two poles.

Cattle breed to home tract to speciality

Breed	Home tract in Rajasthan	Speciality / other name
Rathi	Bikaner, Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Jaisalmer	Best milch breed - 'Kamdheni of Rajasthan'; named after the Rath community
Tharparkar	Jodhpur, Jaisalmer, Barmer	Dual purpose; also Thari, Malani, White Sindhi

Breed	Home tract in Rajasthan	Speciality / other name
Nagauri	Nagaur	Premier draught breed; poor milker
Kankrej	Barmer, Jalore, Sirohi	Dual purpose; called Wadad / Waged / Wadhia; famous 'sawai chaal' gait
Gir	Ajmer, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh (origin Gir forests, Saurashtra)	Also Renderi or Ajmeri
Mewati	Alwar, Bharatpur	Also called Kosi, of the Mewat tract
Malvi	Jhalawar, Kota, Baran	The Hadoti / Malwa plateau breed
Haryana	Sikar, Jhunjhunu, Alwar	Haryana-origin breed of the north-east

Rathi vs Tharparkar - the two the exam sets against each other

Rathi	Tharparkar
Best MILCH breed of Rajasthan	DUAL purpose - milk and draught
Bikaner, Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Jaisalmer	Jodhpur, Jaisalmer, Barmer
Called the 'Kamdhenu of Rajasthan'	Called Thari, Malani or White Sindhi
Named after the Rath community	Named after the Thar / Tharparkar tract

- Purpose grouping: milch = Rathi; draught = Nagauri, Malvi; dual = Tharparkar, Kankrej, Haryana, Mewati.
- Gir and Kankrej are Gujarat-origin breeds that Rajasthan has adopted - both are asked as 'origin outside the state'.
- Kankrej's walking style, the 'sawai chaal', is a one-word giveaway in an option.
- Mewati = Kosi. If you see 'Kosi' in a list, it is the Alwar-Bharatpur cattle breed.

YAAD RAKHO

Trick for the four heavyweight cattle breeds and their districts: RA-TH-NA-KA. RAthi = Bikaner belt. THarparkar = Thar, so Jodhpur-Jaisalmer-Barmer. NAgauri = Nagaur, the name is the district. KAnkrej = Kankrej walks with 'sawai chaal' in Barmer-Jalore-Sirohi. Two of the four name their own home tract, which is half the work done.

TRAP

Do not put Gir in the north-west. Gir in Rajasthan means Ajmer, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh and the Hadoti side - never Hanumangarh or Bikaner. Second trap: Malvi (cattle, Hadoti) and Malpura (sheep, Tonk) are different animals with similar-looking names.

Buffalo - remember one negative fact

Buffalo is where a single sentence wins the question. Rajasthan has NO indigenous buffalo breed of its own. Every buffalo you see in a Rajasthani list came from somewhere else - Haryana, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh. Yet the state is second in India in buffalo population, because farmers here rear other people's breeds in large numbers.

Buffalo breeds reared in Rajasthan

Breed	Reared in Rajasthan mainly in	Speciality
Murrah	Alwar, Bharatpur, Shekhawati belt	Highest milk yield in India - 'black gold'; Haryana origin
Surti	Udaipur, Banswara	Gujarat origin, medium milker
Bhadawari	Eastern Rajasthan - Dholpur, Karauli side	Highest fat in milk, up to about 13%

Breed	Reared in Rajasthan mainly in	Speciality
Jafarabadi	Kept in small numbers	India's heaviest buffalo; origin Gir region, Saurashtra, Gujarat

- Rajasthan is 2nd in India in buffalo population despite owning no native buffalo breed.
- Buffaloes are about 24.1% of the state's livestock - just below cattle.
- Murrah = quantity of milk. Bhadawari = quality (fat) of milk. That single contrast is the whole buffalo question.

Sheep and wool - the section Rajasthan leads India in

Eight sheep breeds, and each one is famous for exactly one thing. Learn the superlative attached to the name and the district follows. Chokla for fineness, Nali for fleece weight, Jaisalmeri for body size, Marwari for sheer numbers, Magra for lustre. RPSC does not ask you about sheep husbandry; it asks 'which breed is called the Jewel of Rajasthan' and moves on.

Sheep breed to home tract to speciality

Breed	Home tract	Speciality
Chokla	Churu, Jhunjhunu, Sikar (Shekhawati)	Finest carpet wool in India; 'Jewel of Rajasthan', 'Indian Merino'
Magra (Bikaneri)	Bikaner, Nagaur, Jaisalmer, Churu	Only lustrous white carpet-wool breed of the region
Marwari	Jodhpur, Pali, Barmer, Jalore, Nagaur	Black face, small tubular ears; most numerous sheep of the state
Nali	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Churu, Jhunjhunu	Densest and heaviest fleece of the state's breeds
Pugal	Bikaner-Jaisalmer border	Black face with brown stripes above the eyes

Breed	Home tract	Speciality
Jaisalmeri	Jaisalmer, Barmer, Jodhpur	Largest-bodied sheep; Roman nose, long drooping ears
Malpura	Jaipur, Tonk, Sawai Madhopur	Home tract of CSWRI Avikanagar
Sonadi (Chanothar)	Udaipur, Dungarpur, Chittorgarh	Large drooping ears; also milked

Chokla vs Magra - the two the paper loves to swap

Chokla	Magra
Shekhawati: Churu, Jhunjhunu, Sikar	Bikaner core, spreading to Nagaur, Jaisalmer, Churu
FINEST carpet wool in India	Most LUSTROUS white wool of the region
'Jewel of Rajasthan', 'Indian Merino'	Also simply called 'Bikaneri'
Light, reddish-brown face, polled	White fleece prized by carpet weavers

YAAD RAKHO

The five sheep superlatives in one line - Chokla is finest, Nali is heaviest fleece, Jaisalmeri is biggest body, Marwari is most numerous, Magra is most lustrous. Say it as: FINE-HEAVY-BIG-MANY-SHINY = Chokla, Nali, Jaisalmeri, Marwari, Magra.

Wool - Rajasthan's number one

- Rajasthan produces about 48% of India's wool (47.85%, Basic Animal Husbandry Statistics 2025) - rank 1, with Jammu and Kashmir second.
- Bikaner has Asia's largest wool market.
- Bikaner and Jodhpur are the state's main wool-scouring and pressing centres.
- The Central Wool Development Board, under the Union Ministry of Textiles, has its headquarters at Jodhpur.
- Rajasthan's wool is mostly coarse carpet wool, not apparel wool - that is why the state feeds the carpet industry, not the suiting industry.

- Avika Kavach is the sheep insurance scheme; the Central Sheep and Wool Research Institute at Avikanagar is the research arm.

Goats – the state's largest single species

More than a third of Rajasthan's animals are goats, and Rajasthan has the largest goat population of any Indian state. The goat is the poor household's animal – it needs no pasture, eats thorn scrub, and can be sold in a bad month. Two names carry the whole examinable weight: Sirohi for meat, Jakhrana for milk.

Goat breed to tract to speciality

Breed	Home tract	Speciality
Sirohi	Sirohi, Pali, Ajmer, adjoining Udaipur	Leading MEAT breed; brown with white patches; used to upgrade goats across India
Jakhrana	Jakhrana village near Behror, Alwar	Highest MILK-yielding goat of Rajasthan; black with white spots on ears and muzzle
Marwari	Jodhpur, Barmer, Jaisalmer, Pali	Black, long-haired desert goat
Barbari	Alwar, Bharatpur, Dholpur	Small, stall-fed goat of the eastern districts
Jamunapari	Chambal ravines of Dholpur-Karauli	Tallest Indian goat breed

- Goats are about 36.7% of Rajasthan's livestock – the single largest species group.
- Rajasthan is 1st in India in goat population and 1st in goat milk.
- Lohi is a red-brown breed of the Pali-Sirohi-Jalore tract; state lists count it among Rajasthan's goats, so if an option pairs Lohi with that tract, take it.

- Sirohi = mutton, Jakhrana = milk, Jamunapari = height, Barbari = small and stall-fed. Four words, four breeds.

TRAP

Jakhrana is a GOAT, not a sheep. RPSC has used it as the odd one out in a list of sheep breeds. Equally, Magra is a SHEEP but is also called 'Bikaneri', while 'Bikaneri' in a camel list is the heavy draught camel. Read which animal the question is about before you match the district.

The camel - state animal, and a species in decline

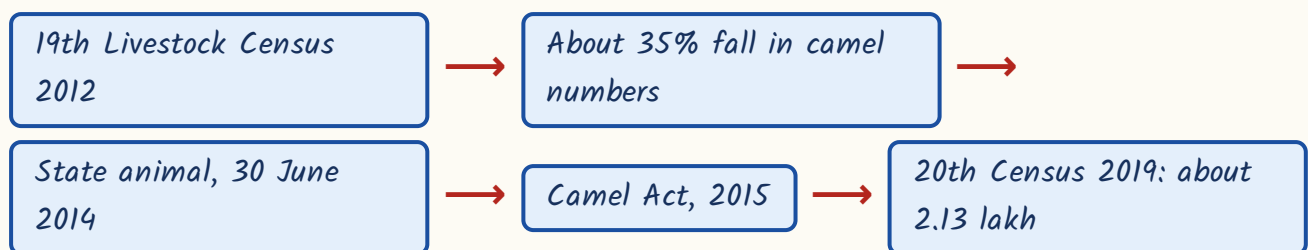
The camel is the one animal in this chapter with a story, and RPSC likes the story. Rajasthan holds roughly 85 per cent of India's camels, yet the population is collapsing - it fell by about 35 per cent between the 19th Census (2012) and the 20th (2019), down to about 2.13 lakh. Tractors replaced camel carts, grazing land shrank, and the animal lost its economic use. The state's response was legal protection: state animal status, then a slaughter-and-export law.

- Camel declared the state animal of Rajasthan on 30 June 2014 - replacing the older animal symbols in state usage.
- The Rajasthan Camel (Prohibition of Slaughter and Regulation of Temporary Migration or Export) Act, 2015 gives it legal protection.
- Rajasthan is 1st in India in camel population - about 2.13 lakh in the 20th Census, roughly 85% of the country's camels.
- The fall from the 19th (2012) to the 20th (2019) Census was about 35%.
- The National Research Centre on Camel, set up in 1984, is at Jorbeed in Bikaner.
- The Pushkar fair in Ajmer is the state's famous camel fair.

Camel breed to tract to use

Breed	Principal tract	Use / speciality
Bikaneri	Bikaner	Heavy draught - load carrying
Jaisalmeri	Jaisalmer	Fast riding breed
Nachna	Nachna area, Jaisalmer	Swift riding breed
Gomat	Jaisalmer-Jodhpur	Riding type of the Gomat tract
Mewari	Udaipur, Rajsamand	Hill camel; the best milker among camels
Kachchhi	Barmer, Jalore	Kutch-origin breed of the south-west

Why the camel got legal cover - the sequence to remember



Horses, poultry and the institutions that get asked

Horses are a small sector but a reliable one-mark question, because the Marwari horse has a physical marking nobody forgets - its ear tips curve inward and touch. Poultry, by contrast, is Rajasthan's weakest livestock sector: rank 17 in India. Do not expect a poultry question beyond that rank.

- Marwari horse - inward-curving ear tips that meet at the top; the signature Rajasthan horse.
- Malani horse - the Barmer strain, closely related to the Marwari.
- Kathiawari horse - reared in the Jalore-Barmer belt; Gujarat origin.
- The Equine Production Campus of the National Research Centre on Equines is at Bikaner.
- The Mallinath fair at Tilwara in Barmer is the state's famous horse fair.

- Poultry: Rajasthan ranks only 17th in India – the weak spot in an otherwise strong livestock profile.

The institutions – learn the city, that is all that is asked

Livestock and dairy institutions of Rajasthan

Institution	Location	Set up
RAJUVAS – Rajasthan University of Veterinary and Animal Sciences	Bikaner	2010
National Research Centre on Camel	Jorbeed, Bikaner	1984
Central Sheep and Wool Research Institute (CSWRI)	Avikanagar, Malpura tehsil, Tonk district	1962
Central Wool Development Board (Ministry of Textiles)	Jodhpur	-
Equine Production Campus, NRC on Equines	Bikaner	-
Rajasthan Co-operative Dairy Federation (RCDF)	Jaipur	1977

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016, 2018 and 2023 – the National Research Centre on Camel is at BIKANER. Three papers, the same fact. Bikaner also carries RAJUVAS and the Central Institute for Arid Horticulture, so 'Bikaner' is the safest answer in any Rajasthan animal-research question.

ASKED IN RAS

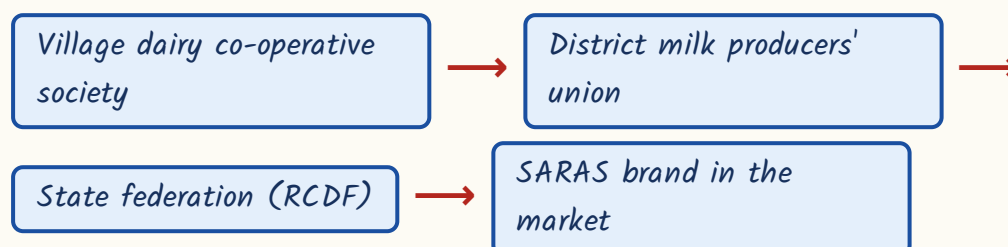
Asked as a match in RAS Pre 2018 and again in 2023 – research institute to location: NRC on Seed Spices = Ajmer, Central Institute for Arid Horticulture = Bikaner, CAZRI = Jodhpur (1959), NRC on Camel = Bikaner. Add CSWRI = Avikanagar (Tonk) and Central Wool Development Board = Jodhpur, and you have covered every version of this question.

Dairy - RCDF and the Saras brand

Rajasthan's dairy sector runs on the co-operative model copied from Amul. Milk is collected at the village, pooled at the district, processed and sold by the state federation. The federation is RCDF and the brand you see on the packet is SARAS. Learn the year, the headquarters and the brand - that trio is the question.

- Rajasthan Co-operative Dairy Federation (RCDF) was set up in 1977, headquarters Jaipur.
- It markets milk and milk products under the brand SARAS.
- It follows the three-tier Anand pattern: village dairy co-operative society, district milk producers' union, state federation.
- The parent model is NDDB Anand and Operation Flood, led by Verghese Kurien - the Amul pattern.
- Rajasthan is India's 2nd largest milk producer after Uttar Pradesh (about 14.8% of national output, BAHS 2025) and 1st in goat milk.

The three-tier Anand pattern that RCDF follows



- Do not confuse the tiers with a government department - all three tiers are co-operatives, not offices.
- Amul is Gujarat's federation (GCMMF); RCDF is Rajasthan's equivalent, not a branch of Amul.

Fisheries, schemes and the livestock fairs

Rajasthan has no coastline, so there is no marine fishery here - only inland fishery in reservoirs and tanks. That single sentence answers most fisheries questions. The productive waters are the Chambal-basin reservoirs, Mahi Bajaj Sagar and Jaisamand, which is why fisheries and irrigation are studied together.

- Rajasthan is landlocked - inland fisheries only, based on reservoirs, tanks and ponds.
- Main fishery waters: Rana Pratap Sagar, Jawahar Sagar and Kota Barrage on the Chambal, plus Mahi Bajaj Sagar and Jaisamand.
- Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY), launched 2020, is the central umbrella scheme for fisheries.

Schemes you should be able to name

- Bhamashah Pashu Bima Yojana - state livestock insurance.
- Avika Kavach - insurance cover for sheep.
- Mukhyamantri Mangla Pashu Bima Yojana - announced in the 2024-25 state budget, free livestock insurance.
- Gopal Credit Card - 2024-25, credit for livestock rearers on the Kisan Credit Card pattern.
- Rashtriya Gokul Mission (central, 2014) - conservation and development of indigenous cattle breeds.
- National Livestock Mission - central scheme for breed improvement, feed and fodder.

Livestock fairs - fair to place to animal

Fair	Place (district)	Known for
Pushkar fair	Pushkar, Ajmer	Camels

Fair	Place (district)	Known for
Mallinath fair	Tilwara, Barmer	Horses
Ramdeoiji cattle fair	Nagaur	Cattle
Baldev pashu mela	Merta, Nagaur	Cattle
Gogamedi fair	Gogamedi, Hanumangarh	Cattle and the Gogaji shrine
Tejaji cattle fair	Parbatsar, Nagaur	Cattle; held in Bhadrapad
Chandrabhaga fair	Jhalrapatan, Jhalawar	Cattle; on Kartik Purnima

ASKED IN RAS

Cattle fairs are asked from the culture side too. RAS Pre 2013 asked where the Tejaji cattle fair is held - PARBATSAR in Nagaur (Tejaji was born at Kharnal in the same district). RAS Pre 2016 asked where the Chandrabhaga cattle fair is held - JHALRAPATAN in Jhalawar. Two districts, Nagaur and Jhalawar, cover both.

REVISION RECAP

- 20th Livestock Census 2019: about 568 lakh animals, 2nd in India, 10.6% of the national herd, density about 166 per sq km.
- Species order: goat 36.7 > cattle 24.5 > buffalo 24.1 > sheep 13.9 per cent.
- Rank 1 in goat, camel, donkey and wool; 2nd in total livestock, buffalo and milk; 4th sheep, 6th cattle, 17th poultry.
- Wool about 48% of India's output (47.85%, BAHS 2025); Bikaner has Asia's largest wool market; Central Wool Development Board at Jodhpur.
- Rathi = best milch cattle, Kamdhenu of Rajasthan, Bikaner-Ganganagar belt.
- Tharparkar = dual purpose, Thari or Malani or White Sindhi, Jodhpur-Jaisalmer-Barmer.
- Nagauri = draught. Kankrej = Wadad/Wadhiar, sawai chaal, Barmer-Jalore-Sirohi.
- Mewati = Kosi (Alwar-Bharatpur); Malvi = Hadoti; Gir = Ajmer-Bhilwara-Chittorgarh; Hariana = Sikar-Jhunjhunu-Alwar.
- No indigenous buffalo breed in Rajasthan. Murrah = most milk ('black gold'), Bhadawari = most fat, Jafarabadi = heaviest.
- Chokla = finest carpet wool, Jewel of Rajasthan, Indian Merino, Shekhawati tract.
- Nali = heaviest fleece; Jaisalmeri = largest body; Marwari = most numerous, black face; Magra = lustrous, Bikaner.

12. Pugal = brown stripes above the eyes; Malpura = Tonk-Jaipur; Sonadi = Chanothar, southern districts, also milked.
13. Sirohi = leading meat goat; Jakhrana (Alwar) = highest milk goat; Jamunapari = tallest; Barbari = small, stall-fed.
14. Camel: state animal 30 June 2014, Camel Act 2015, about 2.13 lakh, roughly 85% of India's camels, fell about 35% since 2012.
15. Camel breeds: Bikaneri draught, Jaisalmeri and Nachna riding, Gomat, Mewari best milker, Kachchhi in Barmer-Jalore.
16. Marwari horse = inward-curving ear tips; Mallinath fair at Tilwara, Barmer is the horse fair.
17. Institutions: RAJUVAS Bikaner 2010, NRC Camel Jorbeed Bikaner 1984, CSWRI Avikanagar (Tonk) 1962, CWDB Jodhpur, RCDF Jaipur 1977.
18. RCDF 1977, Jaipur, brand SARAS, three-tier Anand pattern from NDDB and Operation Flood.
19. Fisheries are inland only - Chambal reservoirs, Mahi Bajaj Sagar, Jaisamand; PMMSY since 2020.
20. Schemes: Bhamashah Pashu Bima, Avika Kavach, Mangla Pashu Bima (2024-25), Gopal Credit Card, Rashtriya Gokul Mission, National Livestock Mission.

RG09

Irrigation Projects and Canal Systems of Rajasthan

Irrigation projects matched to beneficiary districts have been asked in effectively every recent paper - 2013, 2016, 2018, 2021, 2023 and 2024. Budget 2-3 questions. IGNP alone can give one; traditional water harvesting gave two full questions in 2024.

This is the every-paper chapter of Rajasthan Geography. A dry state with one perennial river has had to import water from four directions, and every one of those schemes has a name, a river and a list of beneficiary districts that RPSC matches against each other. If you learn nothing else in Rajasthan Geography, learn the Indira Gandhi canal system and the project-river-district table.

Irrigation of Rajasthan

IGNP

- Kanwar Sen 1948, renamed 1984
- Harike Barrage, Sutlej-Beas
- Rajasthan Feeder 204 km + Main 445 km
- Stage-I 189 km, Stage-II 256 km to Mohangarh
- 7 lift canals, all on the left bank

Big dams

- Bisalpur - Banas, Tonk, drinking water
- Jawai - lifeline of Marwar, Pali
- Mahi Bajaj Sagar - longest, Banswara
- Parwan - Jhalawar, Baran, Kota
- Jakham - highest, Pratapgarh

Northern canals

- Gang Canal 1927 - oldest
- Bhakra-Nangal, Gobind Sagar
- Sidhmukh-Nohar (Ravi-Beas)
- Yamuna share, 1994 MoU

Traditional harvesting

- Khadin, tanka, kund, nadi, toba
- Kui, paar, jhalara, baori
- Johad - Alwar, Rajendra Singh
- Chauka - Lajoriya, Jaipur
- MJSA 2016, Jal Jeevan Mission 2019

Chambal chain

- Gandhi Sagar (Mandsaur, MP)
- Rana Pratap Sagar (Rawatbhata)
- Jawahar Sagar (Kota)
- Kota Barrage - no power
- 50:50 Rajasthan-MP

New link

- ERCP - PKC-ERCP - Ram Jal Setu
- MoU 28 January 2024
- Renamed 22 January 2025
- 17 eastern districts

Why Rajasthan is an irrigation problem before it is an irrigation chapter

Understand the geography first and the projects will make sense. Rajasthan has about a tenth of India's area but a tiny share of its surface water. The Chambal is the state's only perennial river, and it flows through the south-east corner, far from the desert that needs it. Every other river is seasonal. So Rajasthan has solved its water problem by importing it: Sutlej and Beas water from Punjab in the north-west, Chambal water in the south-east, Mahi and Narmada water from Gujarat in the south, and now Chambal-basin water piped east under the Ram Jal Setu link.

- Wells and tube-wells irrigate the largest share of Rajasthan's net irrigated area - groundwater, not canals, is the state's main source.
- Canals come second and are concentrated in the Sri Ganganagar-Hanumangarh belt in the north-west.
- The Chambal is Rajasthan's only perennial river.
- The desert districts have no perennial river at all - which is exactly why the Indira Gandhi canal was built.
- Tanks and ponds matter in the south and south-east, where the land is uneven and rainfall is higher.

Which source dominates where

Source	Where it dominates	Why
Wells and tube-wells	Most of the state - largest share overall	Only reliable source where no canal reaches
Canals	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Bikaner, Kota belt	IGNP, Gang Canal, Bhakra, Chambal canals

Source	Where it dominates	Why
Tanks and ponds	Southern and south-eastern districts	Broken relief holds run-off; higher rainfall

Indira Gandhi Nahar Pariyojana - the spine of the chapter

This is the biggest canal project of its kind in the world by command area, and the single most examinable object in Rajasthan Geography. The idea belongs to one man. Kanwar Sen, then Chief Engineer of Bikaner state, proposed on 29 October 1948 that Punjab's surplus water be carried into the Bikaner desert. It was first called the Rajasthan Canal Project. The foundation stone was laid on 31 March 1958 by Union Home Minister Govind Ballabh Pant, and in 1984 the project was renamed after Indira Gandhi.

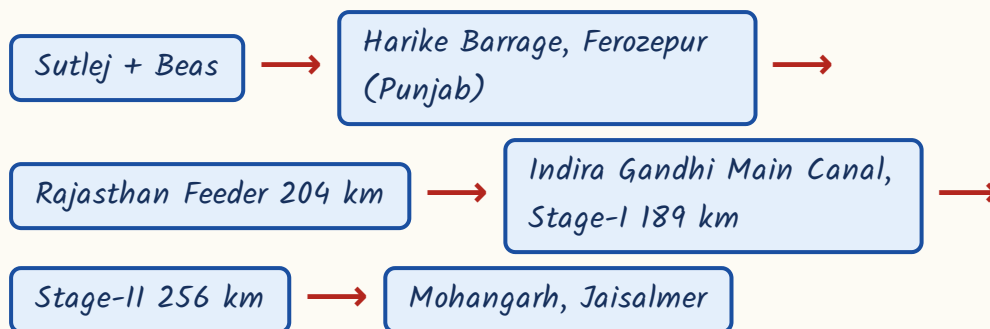
- *Conceived by Kanwar Sen, Chief Engineer of Bikaner, on 29 October 1948.*
- *Original name: Rajasthan Canal Project. Renamed Indira Gandhi Nahar Pariyojana in 1984.*
- *Foundation stone laid 31 March 1958 by Govind Ballabh Pant, Union Home Minister.*
- *Water source: Harike Barrage, at the Sutlej-Beas confluence in Ferozepur district, Punjab.*
- *Gravity branches leave the RIGHT bank - the Rawatsar branch is the single left-bank exception.*
- *All seven lift canals take off from the LEFT bank.*

The lengths - learn these four numbers cold

Component	Length	Note
Rajasthan Feeder	204 km	About 170 km in Punjab-Haryana, about 35 km in Rajasthan

Component	Length	Note
Indira Gandhi Main Canal	445 km	Entirely within Rajasthan
Total main course	About 649 km	204 + 445
Stage-I main canal	189 km	First stretch, from the Rajasthan border
Stage-II main canal	256 km	Remaining stretch, ends at Mohangarh, Jaisalmer

The path of the water, source to tail



Stage-I vs Stage-II - the district split that gets matched

Stage-I	Stage-II
Main canal 189 km	Main canal 256 km
Command: Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, northern Bikaner	Command: Bikaner, Jodhpur, Jaisalmer, Barmer, Churu, Nagaur
Older, fully developed; this is where waterlogging appeared	Newer, drier, ends at Mohangarh in Jaisalmer
Nearer the Punjab border	Runs deep into the Thar

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 - from where does the Indira Gandhi Canal take off? Answer: the HARIKE BARRAGE, at the confluence of the Sutlej and the Beas in Ferozepur district of Punjab. Do not write Bhakra or Ferozepur headworks; Ferozepur (Hussainiwala) headworks belongs to the Gang Canal.

YAAD RAKHO

Four numbers, one sentence: 204 feeder, 445 main, 649 total, and the main splits $189 + 256$. Notice $189 + 256 = 445$, so if you remember any two of the three you can rebuild the third. And the tail is Mohangarh - MO for MOhangarh, the MOst distant point.

The seven lift canals - old name, new name, districts

The Indira Gandhi canal runs along a ridge, so land lying above the canal cannot be irrigated by gravity. For that land, water is pumped up. Those pumping channels are the lift canals - all seven leave the left bank. Every one was later renamed after a person, and RPSC's favourite format is a match between the old name and the new one, or between the lift canal and its districts. Learn the table in both directions.

IGNP lift canals - present name, former name, districts benefited

Present name	Former name	Districts benefited
Kanwar Sen Lift Canal (head at Gharsana)	Lunkaransar Lift	Sri Ganganagar, Bikaner
Pannalal Barupal Lift Canal	Gajner Lift	Bikaner, Nagaur
Veer Tejaji Lift Canal	Bangarsar Lift	Bikaner
Chaudhary Kumbha Ram Lift Canal	Gandheli-Sahwa Lift	Hanumangarh, Churu, Jhunjhunu, Bikaner
Dr. Karni Singh Lift Canal	Kolayat Lift	Bikaner, Jodhpur
Guru Jambheshwar Lift Canal	Phalodi Lift	Jodhpur, Jaisalmer, Bikaner
Jai Narayan Vyas Lift Canal	Pokaran Lift	Jaisalmer, Jodhpur

- The Kanwar Sen Lift Canal is named after IGNP's originator and has its head at Gharsana.

- The Chaudhary Kumbha Ram Lift Canal is the drinking-water lifeline of the Churu-Jhunjhunu belt - the driest districts of the Shekhawati.
- The Rajiv Gandhi Lift Canal is separate from the seven: it was built to carry IGNP water to Jodhpur city for drinking supply.
- Bikaner appears in five of the seven lift canals - when in doubt in a match, Bikaner is usually one of the districts.
- Gravity branches = right bank (Rawatsar branch excepted). Lift canals = left bank. That one line answers a statement question.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - the Chaudhary Kumbha Ram Lift Canal, earlier the Gandheli-Sahwa Lift Canal, mainly supplies drinking water to CHURU and JHUNJHUNU. This is the single most asked lift canal.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked as a match in RAS Pre 2021 - present name to former name of the lift canals: Kanwar Sen = Lunkaransar, Pannalal Barupal = Gajner, Dr. Karni Singh = Kolayat, Chaudhary Kumbha Ram = Gandheli-Sahwa. Memorise those four pairs at minimum; add Veer Tejaji = Bangarsar, Guru Jambheshwar = Phalodi, Jai Narayan Vyas = Pokaran for safety.

What IGNP achieved - and the criticism you must be able to state

The canal turned parts of the Thar green. Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh became wheat, mustard and cotton districts; dunes were fixed by afforestation along the canal; drinking water reached towns that had lived on tankas. But the same success created the problem. The desert soil is sandy above and impermeable below, and unlined canals plus flood irrigation pushed the water table up. The result is 'sem' - waterlogging and salinity - in the old Stage-I

command. Every statement-based question on IGNP is built on this pair of facts.

- Benefits: irrigation across the north-western districts, drinking water to Bikaner, Churu, Jhunjhunu, Jodhpur and Barmer towns.
 - Benefits: dune stabilisation and afforestation belts along the canal; new settlement in Ganganagar-Hanumangarh; industry and dairying followed.
 - Criticism: waterlogging and salinity ('sem') in the Stage-I command of Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh - IGNP's best-known ecological cost.
 - Criticism: heavy seepage from unlined stretches, flood irrigation instead of sprinkler, and rising water tables.
 - Criticism: loss of traditional grazing tracts and change in the desert ecology; spread of water-borne disease in newly irrigated tracts.
 - The command lies in the desert basin drained by no perennial river - never place IGNP in the Chambal basin.
-
- Wrong-statement drill 1: 'the entire IGNP command lies in the Chambal basin' - false; the Chambal is in the south-east and has its own project.
 - Wrong-statement drill 2: 'the Kanwar Sen Lift Canal serves Banswara' - false; Banswara is in the Mahi basin, far outside the IGNP command.
 - Rule of thumb: if any southern or south-eastern district is paired with an IGNP component, that pairing is wrong.

The northern canals - Gang Canal, Bhakra, Sidhmukh-Nohar,

Yamuna

Before Indira Gandhi's canal there was Ganga Singh's. The Chhappaniya famine of 1899-1900 devastated Bikaner state, and Maharaja Ganga Singh negotiated Sutlej water from Punjab to protect his territory. The Gang Canal opened on 26

October 1927 and is Rajasthan's oldest canal irrigation project. Sri Ganganagar - the district named after him - owes its agricultural prosperity to it.

- Gang Canal: opened 26 October 1927, Rajasthan's oldest canal; built by Maharaja Ganga Singh of Bikaner after the Chhappaniya famine.
- It draws Sutlej water at the Ferozepur (Hussainiwala) headworks and irrigates Sri Ganganagar district.
- Total length about 129 km, of which only about 17 km lies inside Rajasthan - the rest is in Punjab.
- Bhakra-Nangal: on the Sutlej at Bhakra in Bilaspur district, Himachal Pradesh; its reservoir is Gobind Sagar.
- Bhakra is a joint Punjab-Haryana-Rajasthan project; Rajasthan's share is about 15.2%, used in Hanumangarh and Sri Ganganagar.
- Sidhmukh-Nohar project: uses Ravi-Beas water; serves Nohar and Bhadra in Hanumangarh and Sidhmukh and Taranagar in Churu; assisted by the European Union and later NABARD.
- Yamuna water: the 1994 MoU among Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh and Delhi fixes Rajasthan's share.
- The Gurgaon Canal carries Yamuna water to Bharatpur; a 2024 Haryana-Rajasthan MoU covers Yamuna water for Churu, Sikar and Jhunjhunu.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 - the oldest canal irrigation project of Rajasthan is the GANG CANAL. If the paper gives a year, it is 1927; if it gives a ruler, it is Maharaja Ganga Singh; if it gives a district, it is Sri Ganganagar.

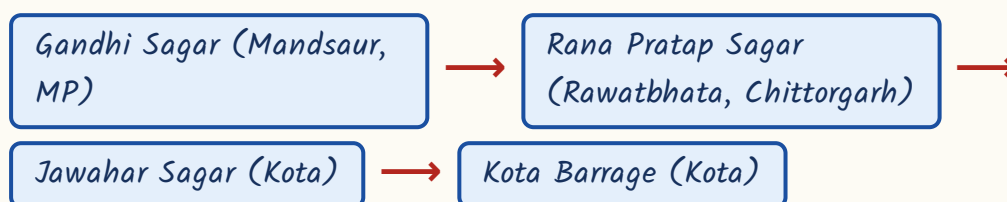
TRAP

Three headworks, three canals, and students mix them. HARIKE Barrage (Sutlej-Beas confluence) feeds the INDIRA GANDHI canal. FEROZEPUR / Hussainiwala headworks feeds the GANG CANAL. BHAKRA dam on the Sutlej in Himachal impounds GOBIND SAGAR and feeds the Bhakra system. All three are Sutlej-family, all three serve Sri Ganganagar-Hanumangarh, and all three are different structures.

The Chambal Valley Project - one river, four structures, in order

The Chambal is Rajasthan's only perennial river and it is shared with Madhya Pradesh on a strict fifty-fifty basis. Four structures were built on it, and the exam's favourite format is to give them jumbled and ask for the upstream-to-downstream order. Learn the sequence once and it never goes: Gandhi Sagar, Rana Pratap Sagar, Jawahar Sagar, Kota Barrage.

Chambal Valley Project - upstream to downstream



The four structures

Structure	Location	Point to remember
Gandhi Sagar	Mandsaur district, Madhya Pradesh	First and largest reservoir of the chain - lies in MP, not Rajasthan
Rana Pratap Sagar	Rawatbhata, Chittorgarh	Rajasthan Atomic Power Station stands at the same site
Jawahar Sagar	Kota	The pick-up dam between Rana Pratap Sagar and Kota Barrage

Structure	Location	Point to remember
Kota Barrage	Kota	No power house - it only diverts water into the canals

- Chambal Valley Project is a 50:50 joint venture of Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh.
- Kota Barrage feeds the Right Main Canal and the Left Main Canal.
- Those canals irrigate Kota, Bundi, Baran, Sawai Madhopur and Tonk.
- Bisalpur is NOT part of this project - it is an independent scheme on the Banas in Tonk.

TRAP

Kota Barrage generates NO hydro power. The other three structures do. A statement question is built on exactly this. Second point: Gandhi Sagar is in Madhya Pradesh - if a question says all four dams of the Chambal project are in Rajasthan, it is false.

Project to river to districts - the table the exam matches from

This is the table that has been asked in one form or another in every recent paper. Three columns, and RPSC can hide any one of them and ask for it. Read it across, then cover the third column and test yourself. The trick is that most projects are named after their river or their site, so the middle column is often free.

Major irrigation projects - project, river or source, benefiting districts

Project	River / source	Benefiting districts
Indira Gandhi Nahar Pariyojana	Sutlej-Beas at Harike Barrage	Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh, Bikaner, Churu, Nagaur, Jodhpur, Jaisalmer, Barmer

Project	River / source	Benefiting districts
Gang Canal (1927, oldest)	Sutlej at Ferozepur headworks	Sri Ganganagar
Bhakra-Nangal	Sutlej (Gobind Sagar)	Hanumangarh, Sri Ganganagar
Sidhmukh-Nohar	Ravi-Beas	Hanumangarh, Churu
Chambal canals (Kota Barrage)	Chambal	Kota, Bundi, Baran, Sawai Madhopur, Tonk
Bisalpur	Banas (at Bisalpur, Todaraisingh tehsil, Tonk)	Jaipur, Ajmer, Tonk, Beawar, Kishangarh, Nasirabad - drinking water
Jawai ('lifeline of Marwar')	Jawai, a tributary of the Luni (at Sumerpur)	Pali, Jalore
Mahi Bajaj Sagar	Mahi (at Borkheda, Banswara)	Banswara, Dungarpur
Parwan Vrihad Pariyojana	Parwan, a tributary of the Kali Sindh (Jhalawar)	Jhalawar, Baran, Kota
Narmada Canal	Narmada, via Sardar Sarovar	Jalore, Barmer
Som-Kamla-Amba	Som	Dungarpur, Udaipur

- Bisalpur is the state's biggest drinking-water project, not primarily an irrigation dam.
- Jawai is the largest dam of western Rajasthan; begun by Maharaja Umaid Singh in 1946, completed 1957.
- Mahi Bajaj Sagar is a joint Rajasthan-Gujarat project and the longest dam of Rajasthan, about 3.1 km; the Kagdi pick-up weir downstream feeds its canals.
- Narmada Canal: Rajasthan is the tail-end beneficiary; 74 km of the canal lies in Rajasthan (532 km with the Gujarat stretch); it enters near Sanchole in Jalore.
- The Narmada command in Rajasthan is India's first canal command with 100% compulsory sprinkler and drip irrigation.

ASKED IN RAS

Two single-fact repeats. RAS Pre 2021 asked which river carries the Bisalpur dam - the BANAS, in Tonk district (not Sawai Madhopur). RAS Pre 2016 asked which district holds the Jawai dam, the 'lifeline of Marwar' - PALI.

ASKED IN RAS

Two more. RAS Pre 2023 asked which state joins Rajasthan in the Mahi Bajaj Sagar project - GUJARAT. RAS Pre 2024 asked which districts the Parwan Vrihad Pariyojana benefits - JHALAWAR, BARAN and KOTA. RAS Pre 2024 also ran the full project-to-district match: Jawai = Pali and Jalore, Parwan = Jhalawar-Baran-Kota, Narmada = Jalore and Barmer, Som-Kamla-Amba = Dungarpur and Udaipur.

The superlatives - dam to district

Other dams worth a line each

Dam	District / river	Why it is asked
Jakham	Pratapgarh, on the Jakham (a Som tributary)	Highest dam of Rajasthan, about 81 m
Panchana	Karauli	Biggest earthen dam; built at the confluence of five rivers
Mahi Bajaj Sagar	Banswara, on the Mahi	Longest dam of Rajasthan, about 3.1 km
Meja	Bhilwara, on the Kothari	Standard match-the-river item
Gudha	Bundi, on the Mej	Standard match-the-district item
Morel	Sawai Madhopur	Do not confuse with Bisalpur, also on the Banas system
Chhapi	Jhalawar	Hadoti group
Orai	Chittorgarh, on the Orai	Named after its own river
Sardar Samand	Pali	Marwar group with Jawai

Dam	District / river	Why it is asked
Bandh Baretha	Bharatpur, on the Kakund	Eastern Rajasthan
Isarda	Tonk-Sawai Madhopur boundary, on the Banas	Under construction; to supply Dausa and Sawai Madhopur

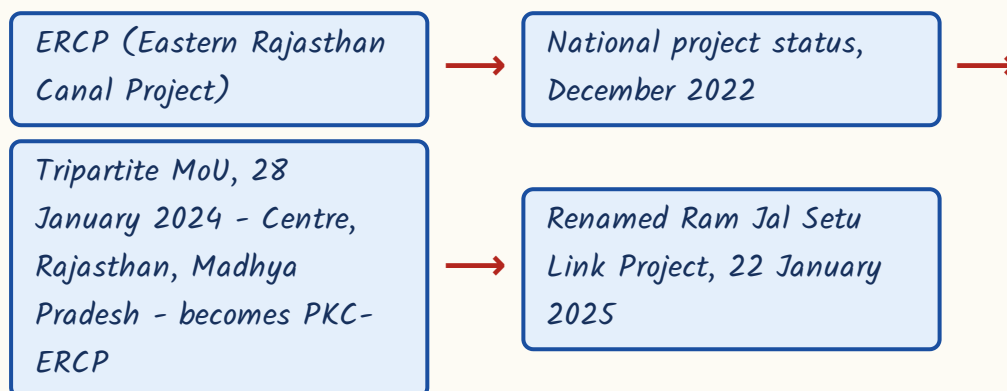
YAAD RAKHO

Three superlatives, three different dams - do not merge them. **HIGHEST** is Jakham (Pratapgarh). **LONGEST** is Mahi Bajaj Sagar (Banswara). **BIGGEST EARTHEN** is Panchana (Karauli). J-M-P: Jakham high, Mahi long, Panchana earthen.

Ram Jal Setu Link Project - the ERCP under its new name

Eastern Rajasthan has the people but not the water; the Chambal basin has the water but the terrain to lift it was expensive. The Eastern Rajasthan Canal Project was designed to move surplus monsoon flows of the Chambal and its tributaries into the deficit basins of the east. It has changed names twice, and the exam will test the names before it tests the engineering. Learn the chronology.

The naming chronology - this is the likely question



- Full form of PKC: Parvati-Kali Sindh-Chambal link, integrated with ERCP under the National Perspective Plan for river interlinking.
- Donor rivers: the Chambal and its tributaries Parvati, Kali Sindh, Mej and Chakan.
- Recipient (deficit) basins: Banas, Banganga, Gambhiri and Parbati.
- It serves 17 eastern districts and about 40% of Rajasthan's population - drinking water plus irrigation.
- It was given national-project status in December 2022; the tripartite MoU with Madhya Pradesh and the Centre was signed on 28 January 2024.
- The Rajasthan government renamed it the Ram Jal Setu Link Project on 22 January 2025.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the project is under implementation as the Ram Jal Setu Link Project, serving 17 eastern districts. The foundation stone was laid by the Prime Minister on 17 December 2024 and work on the Chambal aqueduct between Kota and Bundi began in 2025. Because district boundaries in Rajasthan were themselves redrawn in 2023-24 and again reviewed in December 2024, the exact list of 17 districts can be phrased differently in different official releases - answer '17 eastern districts' and 'about 40% of the population' rather than reciting a district list.

Traditional water harvesting - two full questions came from here in 2024

Before any canal existed, Rajasthan survived on structures that catch rain where it falls. This is not folklore for the exam - RPSC asked it as a straight match and as a statement set in 2024, and it is the kind of topic that repeats. The logic is simple: in the desert you either store rain under a roof (tanka, kund),

spread it on a field (khadin, chauka), pond it in a depression (nadi, toba), or tap what has already soaked into the sand (kui, paar, jhalara). Group them that way and the table writes itself.

Traditional water harvesting structures - region and how each works

Structure	Region	How it works
Khadin (dhora)	Jaisalmer - developed by Paliwal Brahmins, 15th century	Earthen bund across the lower slope of a rocky catchment; crop is grown on the residual moisture
Tanka	Bikaner, Barmer, Jaisalmer, Churu	Covered underground tank in a house courtyard storing rainwater for drinking
Kund / Kundi	Western desert districts	Circular covered underground well; its saucer-shaped catchment is called the agor
Nadi	Desert villages generally	Village pond in a natural depression collecting run-off for people and animals
Toba	Thar - Jaisalmer, Barmer	Natural depression with its own catchment; holds water longer than a nadi
Kui / Beri	Beside a paar or a tank	Narrow, deep pit that taps water seeping through the sand
Paar	Western Rajasthan	The percolation area itself, where run-off soaks into sand and is drawn out through kuis
Jhalara	Jodhpur, Udaipur	Rectangular stepped tank fed by seepage from an upstream tank; community bathing and religious use
Baori	Bundi (city of stepwells), Abhaneri in Dausa (Chand Baori)	Stepwell - steps descend to the water table
Johad	Alwar and the eastern hills	Earthen check dam across a slope; stores run-off and recharges groundwater
Bandha	Alwar-Bharatpur	Earthen embankment across a drainage line to hold run-off
Chauka	Laporiya village, Dudu, Jaipur	Square bunded plots hold a shallow sheet of water on pasture; recharges and grows grass

- Johads were revived by Rajendra Singh and the Tarun Bharat Sangh, which brought the Arvari river back to life in Alwar.
- Naada and Saza Kuva are structures of southern Rajasthan - a Naada is a small check bund, a Saza Kuva a shared open well.
- Mukhyamantri Jal Swavlamban Abhiyan was launched on 27 January 2016 at Nimbi Jodha in Nagaur.
- Jal Jeevan Mission - the central tap-water-to-every-rural-household mission - began on 15 August 2019.
- Zing is a Ladakh meltwater tank, not Rajasthani - it has been used as the odd one out.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - who developed the khadin system? The PALIWAL BRAHMINS of Jaisalmer, in the 15th century. The same paper ran a statement set on tanka, kund and jhalara, all three correct, and a match linking khadin, kui/beri, toba and johad to their descriptions. Traditional harvesting was worth more than one question in 2024 alone.

YAAD RAKHO

Sort them by what they do and you cannot be tricked. UNDER A ROOF: tanka, kund. ON A FIELD: khadin, chauka. IN A HOLLOW: nadi, toba. FROM THE SAND: kui, paar, jhalara. ACROSS A SLOPE: johad, bandha. STEPS DOWN: baori.

REVISION RECAP

1. Chambal is Rajasthan's only perennial river; wells and tube-wells irrigate the largest share of the net irrigated area, canals second.
2. IGNP: conceived by Kanwar Sen on 29 October 1948 as the Rajasthan Canal Project; renamed in 1984.
3. Foundation stone 31 March 1958 by Govind Ballabh Pant; water from Harike Barrage at the Sutlej-Beas confluence, Ferozepur, Punjab.

4. Lengths: Rajasthan Feeder 204 km + Indira Gandhi Main Canal 445 km = about 649 km; Stage-I 189 km, Stage-II 256 km to Mohangarh.
5. Stage-I commands Sri Ganganagar, Hanumangarh and northern Bikaner; Stage-II commands Bikaner, Jodhpur, Jaisalmer, Barmer, Churu, Nagaur.
6. Gravity branches on the right bank (Rawatsar the exception); all seven lift canals on the left bank.
7. Lift canals: Kanwar Sen = Lunkaransar (head Gharsana); Pannalal Barupal = Gajner; Veer Tejaji = Bangarsar.
8. Chaudhary Kumbha Ram = Gandheli-Sahwa, drinking water for Churu and Jhunjhunu; Dr. Karni Singh = Kolayat; Guru Jambheshwar = Phalodi; Jai Narayan Vyas = Pokaran.
9. Rajiv Gandhi Lift Canal carries IGNP water to Jodhpur city; waterlogging and salinity ('sem') in Stage-I is IGNP's main criticism.
10. Gang Canal: oldest, opened 26 October 1927, Maharaja Ganga Singh, Ferozepur headworks, about 129 km with only 17 km in Rajasthan, irrigates Sri Ganganagar.
11. Bhakra on the Sutlej in Bilaspur (HP), reservoir Gobind Sagar, Rajasthan's share about 15.2%; Sidhmukh-Nohar uses Ravi-Beas water for Hanumangarh and Churu.
12. Chambal Valley Project is 50:50 Rajasthan-MP; order Gandhi Sagar (MP) - Rana Pratap Sagar (Rawatbhata) - Jawahar Sagar - Kota Barrage, which alone has no power house.
13. Kota Barrage's Right and Left Main Canals irrigate Kota, Bundi, Baran, Sawai Madhopur and Tonk.
14. Bisalpur is on the Banas in Todaraisingh tehsil, Tonk - the state's biggest drinking-water project, supplying Jaipur, Ajmer and Tonk.
15. Jawai (Pali, on a Luni tributary) is the 'lifeline of Marwar' and western Rajasthan's largest dam; 1946-1957.
16. Mahi Bajaj Sagar is a Rajasthan-Gujarat joint project at Borkheda, Banswara - longest dam of the state, with the Kagdi pick-up weir.
17. Parwan serves Jhalawar, Baran and Kota; the Narmada Canal serves Jalore and Barmer and is India's first 100% sprinkler-drip command. Superlatives: Jakham (Pratapgarh) highest, Mahi Bajaj Sagar longest, Panchana (Karauli) biggest earthen dam.
18. ERCP - PKC-ERCP after the 28 January 2024 tripartite MoU - Ram Jal Setu Link Project from 22 January 2025; 17 eastern districts, about 40% of the population.
19. Khadin = Paliwal Brahmins of Jaisalmer; tanka and kund store drinking water; kui, paar and jhalara tap seepage; chauka is Laporiya, Dudu, Jaipur.
20. Johad = Alwar, revived by Rajendra Singh; MJSA launched 27 January 2016 at Nimbi Jodha, Nagaur; Jal Jeevan Mission from 15 August 2019.

RG10

Population, Urbanisation and Tribes of Rajasthan

Rajasthan Geography is 11-15 questions in every paper and this chapter supplies 2-3 of them. Census indicators by district were asked in 2016, 2018, 2021, 2023 and 2024 - every recent paper. ST population by district was asked in 2013, 2016, 2018 and 2021. Learn the highest-lowest tables cold; that alone covers most of what is asked.

Everything in the first half of this chapter comes from one document - the Census of India 2011. RPSC does not ask you to interpret it. It asks which district is highest, which is lowest, and which tribe lives where. So this is a memorising chapter, and memorising chapters are the cheapest marks in the paper. The tribes half pays twice, because it overlaps with Rajasthan Art and Culture.

Rajasthan Population, Urbanisation & Tribes (Census 2011)

Headline figures

- 6,85,48,437 = 5.66% of India
- 8th in population, 1st in area
- Growth 21.31% (India 17.70%)
- Density 200 (India 382)
- Sex ratio 928 (India 943)
- Literacy 66.11% (India 74.04%)

Highest districts

- Jaipur - population & density
- Kota - literacy & urbanisation
- Dungarpur - sex ratio 994
- Banswara - child sex ratio & ST share
- Barmer - decadal growth 32.5%
- Jhunjhunu - male literacy 86.9%

Lowest districts

- Jaisalmer - density 17, population 6.69 lakh
- Jalore - literacy 54.86%
- Dholpur - sex ratio 846, smallest area
- Jhunjhunu - child sex ratio 837
- Dungarpur - urbanisation 6.4%
- Sri Ganganagar - decadal growth

Urbanisation

- Urban 24.89%, rural 75.11%
- India urban 31.16% - Rajasthan lags
- Million-plus: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota
- 41 districts, 7 divisions (Dec 2024)

SC & ST

- SC 17.83% (1.22 crore)
- ST 13.48% (92.38 lakh)
- ST belt - Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh, Udaipur
- SC share highest Sri Ganganagar

Major tribes

- Meena - largest ST, eastern plains
- Bhil - second, southern hills
- Garasia - third, Sirohi-Udaipur-Pali
- Sahariya - only PVTG, Baran

Smaller communities

- Damor - Dungarpur, head 'Mukhi'
- Kathodi - Udaipur, makes katha
- Rabari/Raika - camel herders
- Gadia Lohar, Kanjar, Sansi

Tribal administration

- TAD headquarters - Udaipur
- Tribal Sub-Plan - Fifth Plan, 1974-75
- MADA for scattered pockets
- State Population Policy 2000

First, fix the base year - why 2011 still rules the paper

Every population number RPSC asks about Rajasthan comes from the Census of India 2011. The 2021 Census was postponed, so 2011 is still the official base. That is good news for you - the numbers have not moved for fifteen years, and

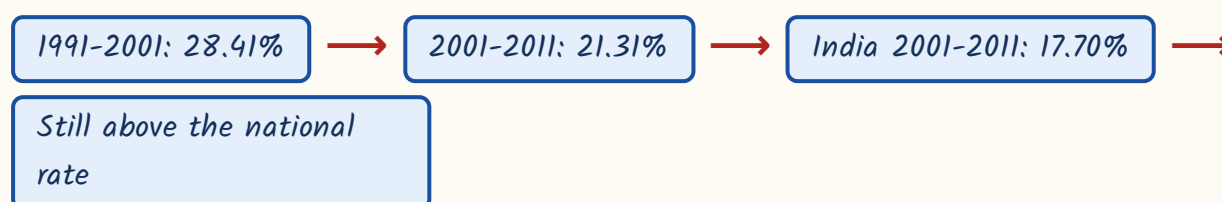
the same figures keep coming back. Whenever you write or recall a population figure, attach the words 'Census 2011' to it in your head. If a question gives you a number without a year, it is a Census 2011 number.

- Census 2011: Rajasthan's population = 6,85,48,437 (about 6.85 crore).
- That is 5.66% of India's population.
- Rank: 8th most populous state of India (Census 2011).
- But Rajasthan is 1st in area - 3,42,239 sq km, 10.41% of India.
- Decadal growth 2001-2011 = 21.31%, against India's 17.70%.
- Rajasthan grew faster than India, but slower than it grew in the previous decade.

TRAP

The single most exploited confusion in this chapter: Rajasthan is **FIRST** in area and **EIGHTH** in population. RPSC frames it as 'which of the following is NOT correct' and slips in 'first in population'. Area first, population eighth. Say it aloud.

Rajasthan's growth rate is decelerating - the trend RPSC likes



CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the Government of India has notified the next Census for 2027 - reference date 1 March 2027, with 1 October 2026 for snow-bound areas - and it will include caste enumeration. Until its data is published, every Rajasthan population figure in the paper remains a Census 2011 figure. Expect a general-awareness question on the census schedule itself rather than on new numbers.

The six headline indicators - Rajasthan set against India

Learn these six side by side with the all-India figure. RPSC's favourite trick is a statement question where the Rajasthan number is right but the comparison with India is flipped. Rajasthan is below India on density, sex ratio, child sex ratio, literacy and urbanisation. It is above India only on growth rate. That one asymmetry answers half the statement questions in this chapter.

Census 2011 - Rajasthan vs India, the numbers that get asked

Indicator	Rajasthan 2011	India 2011
Population	6,85,48,437 (5.66% of India)	121.09 crore
Decadal growth 2001-11	21.31% (higher)	17.70%
Density (persons/sq km)	200 (was 165 in 2001)	382
Sex ratio (F per 1000 M)	928	943
Child sex ratio (0-6)	888	919
Literacy - overall	66.11%	74.04%
Literacy - male	79.19%	82.14%
Literacy - female	52.12%	65.46%
Urban share	24.89%	31.16%

Look hard at the literacy line. Male 79.19 and female 52.12 leaves a gender gap of about 27 percentage points - the widest among the major states of India. That gap is itself an examinable fact, not just an arithmetic by-product. And note that Rajasthan's literacy in 2001 was 60.41%, so the decade added roughly six points. Carry the four-number string in your head - 200, 928, 888, 66.11 - density, sex ratio, child sex ratio, literacy, in that order, and notice that the child sex ratio is LOWER than the overall sex ratio.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - Rajasthan's sex ratio as per Census 2011? Answer: 928 females per 1000 males, against the all-India 943. Asked in RAS Pre 2016 - Rajasthan's literacy rate? Answer: 66.11%.

Highest and lowest districts - the matching set RPSC loves most

This is the heart of the chapter. Almost every census question in RAS is a highest-lowest question or a four-pair matching question built from the two tables below. Do not read them once. Write them out from memory until they come without effort. Note the district names are as they stood in Census 2011, before the 2023 reorganisation.

HIGHEST district for each indicator - Census 2011

Indicator	Highest district	Figure
Population	Jaipur	66.26 lakh
Density	Jaipur	595 per sq km
Area	Jaisalmer	38,401 sq km
Decadal growth	Barmer	about 32.5%
Sex ratio	Dungarpur	994
Child sex ratio	Banswara	934
Literacy (overall)	Kota	76.56%
Male literacy	Jhunjhunu	about 86.9%
Female literacy	Kota	about 65.9%
Urbanisation	Kota	about 60.3%
ST share of population	Banswara	highest in state
SC share of population	Sri Ganganagar	highest in state

LOWEST district for each indicator - Census 2011

Indicator	Lowest district	Figure
Population	Jaisalmer	6.69 lakh
Density	Jaisalmer	17 per sq km
Area	Dholpur	about 3,034 sq km
Decadal growth	Sri Ganganagar	about 10%
Sex ratio	Dholpur	846
Child sex ratio	Jhunjhunu	837
Literacy (overall)	Jalore	54.86%
Male literacy	Pratapgarh	lowest in state
Female literacy	Jalore	about 38.5%
Urbanisation	Dungarpur	about 6.4%
ST share of population	Nagaur	about 0.2%
SC share of population	Dungarpur	lowest in state

Two ordering facts sit just below the top of these lists, and RPSC has asked them as sequence questions. Sex ratio order at the top: Dungarpur (994), then Rajsamand (990), then Pali (987). Population order at the top: Jaipur (66.26 lakh), Jodhpur (36.87 lakh), Alwar (36.74 lakh), Nagaur (about 33.07 lakh). Jodhpur and Alwar are separated by barely thirteen thousand people, so their order is a favourite trap.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and again in 2023 - which district has the highest sex ratio in Rajasthan? Answer: Dungarpur (994). Asked in RAS Pre 2016 as an ordering question - Dungarpur > Rajsamand > Pali, with Dholpur (846) at the bottom. Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - highest literacy district: Kota (76.56%).

TRAP

Three districts wear two hats and RPSC uses it. Jhunjhunu has the **HIGHEST** male literacy and the **LOWEST** child sex ratio - prosperity did not fix the sex ratio there. Dungarpur has the **HIGHEST** sex ratio and the **LOWEST** urbanisation. Jaisalmer is the **LARGEST** district by area and the **SMALLEST** by population, with the lowest density. Do not assume the lowest density is Barmer - it is Jaisalmer. Barmer's claim is the highest decadal growth.

Rural, urban and the towns of Rajasthan

Rajasthan is a rural state. Three out of four Rajasthanis lived in villages in 2011. The urban share of 24.89% - roughly 1.70 crore people - is well below the national 31.16%. The reason is geography plus economy: a large desert district like Jaisalmer or Barmer has almost no urban base, and the southern tribal districts are the least urbanised of all.

- Urban population 24.89% (about 1.70 crore); rural 75.11%.
- India's urban share in 2011 was 31.16% - Rajasthan is below it.
- Most urbanised districts: Kota (about 60.3%), Jaipur (52.4%), Ajmer (40.1%).
- Least urbanised: Dungarpur (about 6.4%), then Banswara and Pratapgarh.
- Million-plus cities in Census 2011 - exactly three: Jaipur, Jodhpur and Kota.
- Jaipur is the only Rajasthan city above 30 lakh; it is the state's only metropolitan-scale city.
- Do not confuse district urbanisation with city size - RPSC mixes them deliberately.
- Only **THREE** million-plus cities in Census 2011: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota.

- Ajmer is NOT a million-plus city, even though Ajmer district is the third most urbanised.
- Class of towns: Rajasthan's urban system is dominated by small and medium towns; Jaipur alone is of metropolitan scale.

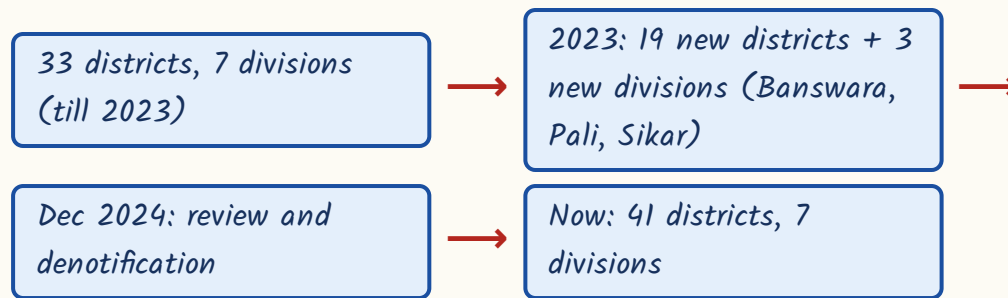
One more contrast worth carrying. Kota is the most urbanised district AND the most literate district. That is not a coincidence - it is the coaching-and-industry town of the state. Dungarpur is the least urbanised AND has the best sex ratio. Urbanisation and sex ratio in Rajasthan run in opposite directions, which is the reverse of the usual textbook assumption.

- Religion, Census 2011: Hindu 88.49%, Muslim 9.07%, Sikh 1.27%, Jain 0.91%, Christian 0.14%.
- Sikhs are concentrated in Sri Ganganagar and Hanumangarh - the canal-colony districts.
- Work participation rate of Rajasthan in 2011 was ABOVE the all-India average.
- Female work participation is unusually high in the western districts - women do the livestock and field work.
- Rajasthan is a net OUT-migration state; the flow goes to Gujarat, Maharashtra and Delhi.

The administrative map as it stands now - 41 districts, 7 divisions

This part is not census data at all - it is current affairs, and it changed twice in two years. In 2023 the state created nineteen new districts and three new divisions. In December 2024 the government reviewed that decision and denotified several of them. Learn the position as it stands now, and learn the divisions by name, because divisions are a short and therefore very askable list.

How the district map moved - keep the sequence



- Present position (as of 2026): 41 districts in 7 divisions.
- The seven divisions: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer, Kota, Bikaner, Bharatpur, Udaipur.
- The three divisions created in 2023 - Banswara, Pali and Sikar - were abolished in December 2024.
- Eight of the districts created in 2023 were retained in the December 2024 rationalisation.
- Census 2011 district data still uses the OLD 33-district map - never mix the two.
- Phalodi, Balotra, Didwana-Kuchaman, Deeg and Kotputli-Behror did not exist in 2011.
- If a question says 'as per Census 2011', the answer must be one of the 33 old districts.

Two other administrative facts that ride along with this chapter. Rajasthan announced its State Population Policy in the year 2000 - the year is the whole question. And the Tribal Sub-Plan strategy, which shapes the tribal districts' budgets, began in the Fifth Five Year Plan, 1974-75.

Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes - shares and where they live

Two numbers, and then the geography. SCs are 17.83% of Rajasthan's population - about 1.22 crore. STs are 13.48% - about 92.38 lakh. The SC population is spread fairly evenly across the state; the ST population is not. Tribal Rajasthan is a compact block in the south and south-east, plus the Meena belt in the eastern plains.

SC and ST - the four distribution facts RPSC matches

Question asked	Answer	Watch out
Highest ST share (%)	Banswara, then Dungarpur	Then Pratapgarh, Udaipur
Highest ST number (absolute)	Udaipur district	NOT Banswara - Udaipur is bigger
Lowest ST share	Nagaur (about 0.2%), then Bikaner	The desert north has almost no ST
Highest SC share (%)	Sri Ganganagar	Canal colony district
Highest SC number (absolute)	Jaipur district	Biggest district overall
Lowest SC share	Dungarpur	Because it is overwhelmingly ST

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - the ST share of Rajasthan's population as per Census 2011? Answer: 13.48% (about 92.38 lakh). Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and 2021 - the district with the highest proportion of Scheduled Tribes? Answer: Banswara.

TRAP

Share versus number. Banswara has the highest ST PROPORTION; Udaipur has the largest ST POPULATION in absolute terms. Same trap on the SC side: Sri Ganganagar has the highest SC proportion, Jaipur has the largest SC population. Read whether the question says 'percentage' or 'number'.

Why the pattern? The southern districts - Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh, Udaipur - are the Bhil hill country, forested and difficult, so the tribal population was never displaced. The eastern plains around Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur, Dausa and Karauli are Meena country, agricultural and settled. Nagaur and Bikaner in the arid north-west never had a tribal base at all. Understand this map and the district answers stop being arbitrary.

The tribes of Rajasthan - the master table

Rajasthan has twelve notified Scheduled Tribes. You need four of them in detail and the rest by one identifying feature each. The order by population is the first thing asked: Meena is the largest, Bhil second, Garasia third, Sahariya the smallest of the significant ones but the most vulnerable.

The four major tribes - district, feature, keyword

Tribe	Where they live	Distinctive fact
Meena (Mina)	Eastern plains - Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur, Dausa, Karauli	LARGEST tribe of Rajasthan; settled cultivators
Bhil	Southern hills - Banswara, Dungarpur, Udaipur, Pratapgarh	Second largest; hamlet called 'palli' or 'phala'; Gavri dance-drama
Garasia	Sirohi (Abu Road, Pindwara), Udaipur (Kotra, Jhadol), Pali (Bali)	Third largest; shifting cultivation called 'Walra'
Sahariya	Kishanganj and Shahbad tehsils of Baran (the Dang region)	The ONLY PVTG of Rajasthan; headman called 'Kotwal'

The smaller tribes and nomadic communities - one line each

Community	Where	Identifying fact
Damor	Simalwara and Aspur (Dungarpur), parts of Banswara	Village head called 'Mukhi'; Chadwa Tirth fair

Community	Where	Identifying fact
Kathodi	Kotra, Jhadol and Sarada (Udaipur)	Migrants from Maharashtra; make 'katha' (catechu) from khair wood
Kanjar	Scattered, chiefly Hadoti	Denotified nomadic community
Sansi	Scattered, chiefly Bharatpur-Alwar	Denotified nomadic community
Rabari / Raika	Pali, Jodhpur, Nagaur, Sirohi	Camel and sheep herders - the state's pastoralists
Gadia Lohar	Nomadic, all over the state	Wandering blacksmiths; trace descent to Chittorgarh
Bhil-Mina, Dhanka, Naik, Patelia, Seharla	Southern and eastern districts	All notified Scheduled Tribes of Rajasthan

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 - the largest Scheduled Tribe of Rajasthan? Answer: Meena (Mina), with Bhil second. RPSC repeats this because students instinctively answer 'Bhil'.

TRAP

Two hard traps here. One: the largest tribe is the MEENA, not the Bhil. Two: the Sahariya live in BARAN district, not in Dungarpur or Banswara - and they are Rajasthan's only Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group. Three, a bonus: the Toda are a tribe of the Nilgiris in Tamil Nadu, not of Rajasthan; RPSC has slipped it into a list of Rajasthani STs.

Tribal customs and vocabulary - the words that get matched

RPSC does not ask you to describe tribal society. It asks you to match a word to a tribe. So learn the vocabulary as pairs. There are about eight words that

carry almost every question in this part of the chapter.

Tribal vocabulary - word to tribe, learn as pairs

Word	Tribe	What it means
Palli / Phala	Bhil	The scattered hamlet the Bhil live in
Chimata	Bhil	Shifting cultivation on a hill SLOPE
Dajiya	Bhil	Shifting cultivation on LEVEL land
Gavri	Bhil	Their famous dance-drama, performed after Rakshabandhan
Walra	Garasia	Their slash-and-burn cultivation
Mor-bandiya, Peharavani, Taanana	Garasia	Three of their forms of marriage
Gol-Gadheda	Garasia	Their fair, where a bride may be won
Kotwal	Sahariya	The village headman
Mukhi	Damor	The village or panchayat head
Chadwa Tirth	Damor	Their fair
Katha	Kathodi	Catechu, extracted from khair wood

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 and again in 2018 - 'Walra' is the shifting cultivation of which tribe? Answer: the Garasia. The Bhil equivalents are Chimata and Dajiya. This pair of terms is one of the most repeated facts in Rajasthan Geography.

- Memory hooks for the two headmen - Sahariya has the Kotwal, Damor has the Mukhi.
- Kotwal sounds like a police title; the Sahariya are the group that needed protection.
- Shifting cultivation - Garasia is Walra; Bhil is Chimata on the slope and Dajiya on flat land.

- Chimata from 'chadhai', the climb - that fixes it to the hill slope.

Bhil vs Meena - the two big tribes, opposite in almost everything

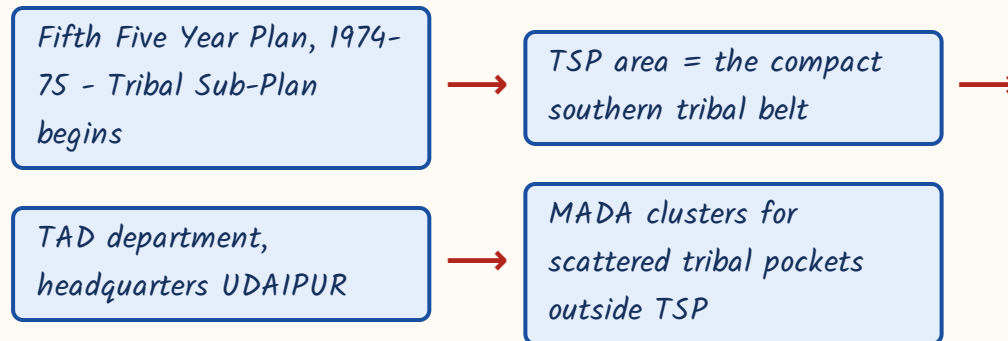
Bhil	Meena (Mina)
Second largest tribe	LARGEST tribe of Rajasthan
Southern hills - Banswara, Dungarpur, Udaipur, Pratapgarh	Eastern plains - Jaipur, Sawai Madhopur, Dausa, Karauli
Forest-edge, shifting cultivation (Chimata, Dajiya)	Settled plough agriculture, landholding community
Hamlet settlement called palli/phala	Village settlement, integrated with the plains economy
Gavri dance-drama; strongly distinct culture	Historically ruling and land-owning; heavy presence in state services

One more thing about the Bhil that shows up in the History paper too. Bhil territory is where the Eki movement of Motilal Tejawat took root, and Bhil archers appear throughout Mewar's military history. If the question names Banswara-Dungarpur-Udaipur, the tribe is Bhil, whatever the paper is.

Tribal administration, migration and the last-minute sweep

The delivery machinery for tribal development is a small, clean list and it is asked as a straight one-liner. The Tribal Area Development department has its headquarters at Udaipur - not Jaipur, which is the surprise. The Tribal Sub-Plan approach began in the Fifth Five Year Plan, 1974-75. And MADA - Modified Area Development Approach - exists for tribal pockets scattered outside the compact TSP area.

How tribal development is organised in Rajasthan



- TAD (Tribal Area Development) department headquarters - Udaipur.
- Tribal Sub-Plan launched in the Fifth Five Year Plan (1974-75).
- MADA covers scattered tribal pockets outside the main TSP block.
- The TSP block is essentially Banswara, Dungarpur, Pratapgarh and parts of Udaipur, Sirohi and Chittorgarh.
- Rajasthan's State Population Policy was announced in 2000.
- Rajasthan is a net out-migration state - the streams go to Gujarat, Maharashtra and Delhi.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 as a four-pair matching question - highest sex ratio Dungarpur (994), highest literacy Kota (76.56%), largest population Jaipur (66.26 lakh), highest child sex ratio Banswara (934). Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - the district with the highest decadal growth 2001-11? Answer: Barmer (about 32.5%).

YAAD RAKHO

Last-minute drill. Say these five aloud: Jaipur is the biggest everything except area. Jaisalmer is the emptiest everything except area, where it is the biggest. Kota is the most literate and most urban. Dungarpur is the best sex ratio and the least urban. Jalore is the least literate. Those five sentences cover most of the district questions this chapter can throw.

REVISION RECAP

1. All Rajasthan population data in the paper = Census 2011. Next census notified for 2027 (as of September 2026).
2. 6,85,48,437 persons = 5.66% of India; 8th in population, 1st in area.
3. Decadal growth 21.31% against India's 17.70%; down from 28.41% in 1991-2001.
4. Density 200 (India 382), up from 165 in 2001. Sex ratio 928 (India 943). Child sex ratio 888 (India 919).
5. Literacy 66.11% - male 79.19%, female 52.12%; a 27-point gender gap, widest among major states.
6. Highest: Jaipur population and density, Kota literacy and urbanisation, Dungarpur sex ratio, Banswara child sex ratio, Barmer growth, Jhunjhunu male literacy.
7. Lowest: Jaisalmer population and density, Jalore literacy, Dholpur sex ratio and area, Jhunjhunu child sex ratio, Dungarpur urbanisation, Sri Ganganagar growth.
8. Top sex ratios in order - Dungarpur 994, Rajsamand 990, Pali 987. Bottom - Dholpur 846.
9. Top populations in order - Jaipur 66.26, Jodhpur 36.87, Alwar 36.74, Nagaur 33.07 lakh.
10. Urban 24.89% vs India 31.16%. Only three million-plus cities: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kota.
11. Religion 2011: Hindu 88.49, Muslim 9.07, Sikh 1.27, Jain 0.91, Christian 0.14 per cent.
12. SC 17.83% (1.22 crore); ST 13.48% (92.38 lakh).
13. ST share highest Banswara; ST number highest Udaipur; ST share lowest Nagaur. SC share highest Sri Ganganagar; SC number highest Jaipur.
14. Tribe order by size: Meena > Bhil > Garasia; Sahariya is the state's only PVTG, in Baran.
15. Bhil = palli/phala, Chimata and Dajiya, Gavri. Garasia = Walra, Gol-Gadheda, Morbandiya.
16. Sahariya headman = Kotwal; Damor head = Mukhi; Kathodi make katha from khair wood.
17. Rabari/Raika herd camels and sheep; Gadia Lohar are nomadic blacksmiths from Chittorgarh; Kanjar and Sansi are denotified communities.
18. TAD headquarters Udaipur; Tribal Sub-Plan from the Fifth Plan, 1974-75; MADA for scattered pockets.
19. State Population Policy 2000; Rajasthan is a net out-migration state towards Gujarat, Maharashtra and Delhi.
20. Administrative map now: 41 districts in 7 divisions - Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer, Kota, Bikaner, Bharatpur, Udaipur.

RG11

Minerals, Energy, Tourism and Transport of Rajasthan

Expect 3-5 questions a paper from this chapter alone. The certainties are: one mineral-to-location matching set, one thermal-station-to-district item, one solar or renewable energy item, and increasingly one on the Pachpadra refinery. Tourism and transport supply another one in most papers, usually the UNESCO list or the Jaipur Metro.

This is the biggest single chapter in Rajasthan Geography, and it contains the most repeated question type in the whole subject - match the mineral to the mine to the district. RESEARCH records mineral-mine matching as asked in every single paper. Learn the mine list the way you learn a multiplication table, then add energy, tourism and transport on top.

Rajasthan - Minerals, Energy, Tourism & Transport

India's **SOLE** producer

- Lead-zinc ore
- Wollastonite
- Selenite
- Jasper

India's **LARGEST** producer

- Gypsum
- Rock phosphate
- Silver
- Marble
- Calcite, soapstone, ball clay, sandstone

Metallic - mine to district

- Zawar, Rampura-Agucha, Rajpura-Dariba - lead-zinc
- Khetri-Singhana, Kolihaan - copper (Jhunjhunu)
- Degana (Nagaur) - tungsten
- Bhukia-Jagpura (Banswara) - gold
- Rohil, Sikar - uranium

Non-metallic

- Jhamar Kotra (Udaipur) - rock phosphate
- Got-Manglodh (Nagaur) - gypsum
- Makrana - white marble
- Sanu (Jaisalmer) - SMS limestone
- Mando ki Pal (Dungarpur) - fluorite
- Khera/Belka Pahar (Sirohi) - wollastonite

Fuel minerals

- Lignite - Palana, Barsingsar, Kapurdi, Jalipa, Giral
- Oil - Mangala, Bhagyam, Aishwariya (Barmer-Sanchore)
- Gas - Tanot, Dandewala (Jaisalmer)
- Pachpadra refinery, HRRL, Balotra

Power stations

- Suratgarh - Sri Ganganagar (largest)
- Kota Super Thermal - first coal station
- Chhabra - Baran; Kalisindh
- Jhalawar
- Rawatbhata - Chittorgarh, nuclear

Renewables

- Bhadla Solar Park - Phalodi, India's largest
- 1st in solar, 2nd in total renewables
- RRECL is the nodal agency
- PM-KUSUM, PM Surya Ghar

Tourism & transport

- 4 UNESCO sites; 6 Hill Forts
- RTDC, Palace on Wheels 1982
- North Western Railway, HQ Jaipur
- Jaipur Metro 2015; Delhi-Mumbai Expressway

Rajasthan's mineral profile - why it is called the mineral museum of India

Rajasthan produces more varieties of minerals than any other state. It does not lead in coal or iron, so it is not the biggest by value, but in the sheer spread of minerals it is unmatched. For the exam the important thing is a very short list: the minerals for which Rajasthan is India's ONLY source, and the ones where it is India's largest producer. Every year one question comes straight out of those two lists.

The two lists that must be memorised exactly

Rajasthan is India's SOLE producer of	Rajasthan is India's LARGEST producer of
Lead-zinc ore	Gypsum
Wollastonite	Rock phosphate
Selenite	Silver
Jasper	Marble
(only these four)	Calcite, soapstone, ball clay, sandstone

- Do not confuse: bauxite is NOT a Rajasthan mineral - it comes from Odisha, Gujarat and Jharkhand.
- Ordinary coal is not a Rajasthan mineral either; what Rajasthan has is LIGNITE, brown coal.
- Both are planted in 'which is NOT produced in Rajasthan' questions.
- Iron ore exists in Rajasthan but in small, low-grade deposits - the state is not an iron producer of rank.

One structural point that helps you remember locations. Metallic minerals in Rajasthan sit along the Aravalli - Udaipur, Rajsamand, Bhilwara, Chittorgarh, Sirohi, Jhunjhunu, Alwar. Non-metallic and evaporite minerals sit in the desert

and the Nagaur-Jaisalmer belt - gypsum, limestone, selenite, bentonite. Fuel minerals sit in the far west - Bikaner and Barmer. If you forget a specific mine, this rule usually gets you the right district family. And for the sole-producer four, remember the line 'Zawar sells jasper and wool' - Zinc-lead ore, SElenite, JASPER, WOLLastonite.

Metallic minerals - the mine-to-district table you cannot afford to miss

Read the table, then close the book and write the mine names against the districts. This exact set is what RPSC turns into a four-pair matching question, and RESEARCH shows it has been asked in every recent paper. Do not try to remember the geology. Remember mine - district - mineral, in that order.

Metallic minerals - mine, district, mineral (part 1)

Mine / belt	District	Mineral
Zawar	Udaipur	Lead-zinc - world's oldest known zinc-smelting site
Rampura-Agucha	Bhilwara	Lead-zinc - India's LARGEST zinc mine
Rajpura-Dariba	Rajsamand	Lead-zinc
Sindesar Khurd	Rajsamand	Lead-zinc - India's largest SILVER-producing mine
Khetri-Singhana, Madan-Kudan, Kolihan	Jhunjhunu	Copper - Khetri Copper Complex, Hindustan Copper Ltd
Kho-Dariba	Alwar	Copper
Deri-Basantgarh	Sirohi	Copper

Metallic minerals - mine, district, mineral (part 2)

Mine / belt	District	Mineral
Morija-Banola	Jaipur	Iron ore
Neemla-Rajpura	Dausa	Iron ore
Nathara-ki-Pal, Dalani	Udaipur	Iron ore
Kalakhunta, Lilwani, Timamori	Banswara	Manganese
Degana (Rewat hill)	Nagaur	Tungsten (wolframite)
Bhukia-Jagpura	Banswara	Gold - the state's principal gold prospect
Rohil, in the Khandela belt	Sikar	Uranium
Jahaj	Bhilwara	Uranium

Zawar vs Rampura-Agucha - the two lead-zinc names RPSC swaps

Zawar	Rampura-Agucha
Udaipur district	Bhilwara district
Famous for ANTIQUITY - zinc distillation from about the 13th century CE	Famous for SCALE - India's largest zinc-producing mine
World's oldest known zinc-smelting site	A modern opencast-to-underground operation
Still worked by Hindustan Zinc Ltd	Also worked by Hindustan Zinc Ltd

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and again in 2024 - the Khetri copper belt lies in which district? Answer: Jhunjhunu, worked by Hindustan Copper Ltd's Khetri Copper Complex. Asked in RAS Pre 2018 - Degana (Rewat hill) in Nagaur is known for which mineral? Answer: tungsten.

- Zawar is in UDAIPUR, not Chittorgarh - Chittorgarh has the Chanderiya smelter, a different thing.
- Rampura-Agucha is in BHILWARA; Rajsamand has Rajpura-Dariba and Sindesar Khurd.
- Silver is not mined as silver - it comes out of the Sindesar Khurd lead-zinc ore.

- Copper is Jhunjhunu first; Alwar and Sirohi are the secondary copper districts.

Non-metallic and industrial minerals - the second big matching set

If the metallic table is the first favourite, this is the second, and one pair inside it - Jhamar Kotra with rock phosphate - is probably the single most asked geography fact about Rajasthan. Jhamar Kotra in Udaipur is India's largest rock phosphate deposit. Got-Manglodh in Nagaur is the gypsum name. Those two, plus Khetri and Zawar, form the four-pair matching set RPSC has used repeatedly.

Non-metallic minerals - mine, district, mineral (part 1)

Mine / belt	District	Mineral
Jhamar Kotra	Udaipur	Rock phosphate - INDIA'S LARGEST deposit, worked by RSMML
Maton, Kanpur-Dakan Kotra	Udaipur	Rock phosphate
Birmania	Jaisalmer	Rock phosphate
Got-Manglodh, Bhadwasi	Nagaur	Gypsum - Rajasthan produces the bulk of India's gypsum
Sanu	Jaisalmer	Limestone - high-grade SMS variety for steel plants
Gotan, Mundwa	Nagaur	Limestone (cement grade)
Makrana	Nagaur region, now Didwana-Kuchaman	White marble - used in the Taj Mahal
Rajsamand district	Rajsamand	Marble - the LARGEST marble-producing district

Non-metallic minerals - mine, district, mineral (part 2)

Mine / belt	District	Mineral
Andhi	Jaipur	Green marble
Babarmal	Udaipur	Pink marble
Bansi Paharpur	Bharatpur region, now Deeg	Red sandstone
Dholpur and Karauli	Dholpur, Karauli	Red sandstone; Jodhpur gives 'chhitar' sandstone
Jalore	Jalore	Granite - the 'granite city of Rajasthan'
Mando ki Pal	Dungarpur	Fluorite (fluorspar) - India's leading deposit, RSMML
Khera and Belka Pahar	Sirohi	Wollastonite - produced only in Rajasthan
Rikhabdeo / Kherwara	Udaipur	Asbestos; also Ajmer, Dungarpur, Rajsamand
Kaliguman-Tekhi belt	Rajsamand-Ajmer	Emerald
Rajmahal	Tonk	Garnet
Barmer and Jaisalmer	Barmer, Jaisalmer	Bentonite
Bikaner	Bikaner	Ball clay; Nagaur gives selenite

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2021 - Jhamar Kotra is associated with which mineral?

Answer: rock phosphate. Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and 2021 as a full matching set - Jhamar Kotra to rock phosphate, Got-Manglodh to gypsum, Zawar to lead-zinc, Degana to tungsten. RESEARCH names this the most frequently repeated matching set in RAS geography.

- Fluorite is Dungarpur (Mando ki Pal); wollastonite is Sirohi (Khera, Belka Pahar) - never swap them.

- Makrana now falls in Didwana-Kuchaman district after the 2023 reorganisation; older books say Nagaur.
- Marble: Makrana is famous for white, Rajsamand produces the most, Andhi green, Babarmal pink.
- Red sandstone is Dholpur-Karauli-Bansi Paharpur; Jodhpur's variety is called 'chhitar'.

YAAD RAKHO

Yaad rakho the four-pair set as a sentence: 'Jhamar ka Phosphate, Got ka Gypsum, Zawar ka Zinc, Degana ka Tungsten.' Four mines, four minerals, one sentence. If you learn nothing else from this chapter, learn that line.

Who mines what - RSMML, Hindustan Zinc and the salt lakes

RPSC asks the operator as often as the mine. There are only three names to know, and each owns a clear set of minerals. Both the big state and public-sector mining houses are headquartered at Udaipur, which is itself a question.

The mining companies and what they work

Company	Headquarters	What it mines / smelts
RSMML - Rajasthan State Mines and Minerals Ltd	Udaipur	Rock phosphate (Jhamar Kotra), limestone (Sanu), gypsum, lignite, fluorite (Mando ki Pal)
Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL)	Udaipur	Lead-zinc and silver - Zawar, Rampura-Agucha, Rajpura-Dariba, Sindesar Khurd
Hindustan Copper Ltd - Khetri Copper Complex	Khetri, Jhunjhunu	Copper - Khetri-Singhana, Madan-Kudan, Kolihan

- Hindustan Zinc's smelters: Debari (Udaipur), Chanderiya (Chittorgarh) and Dariba (Rajsamand).

- Rajasthan is India's **THIRD** largest salt producer.
- Salt sources: Sambhar (India's largest inland salt lake), Didwana, Pachpadra and Lunkaransar.
- Sambhar is also a Ramsar site - the same name serves the environment paper.
- RSMML is a state government undertaking; HZL and HCL are of central origin, HZL now under Vedanta.
- Debari, Chanderiya and Dariba are **SMEALTERS**, not mines - a common wrong option.
- Keep the categories apart: Khetri a mine complex, Makrana a marble centre, Sambhar a salt source.

Fuel minerals - lignite, the Barmer oil basin and the Pachpadra refinery

Rajasthan has no ordinary coal. What it has is lignite, or brown coal, in the western districts, and that lignite feeds power stations right at the pithead. Then, from 2004, came the thing that changed the state's economy - the Barmer-Sanchore oil basin. Learn the lignite fields by district first; they are pure recall.

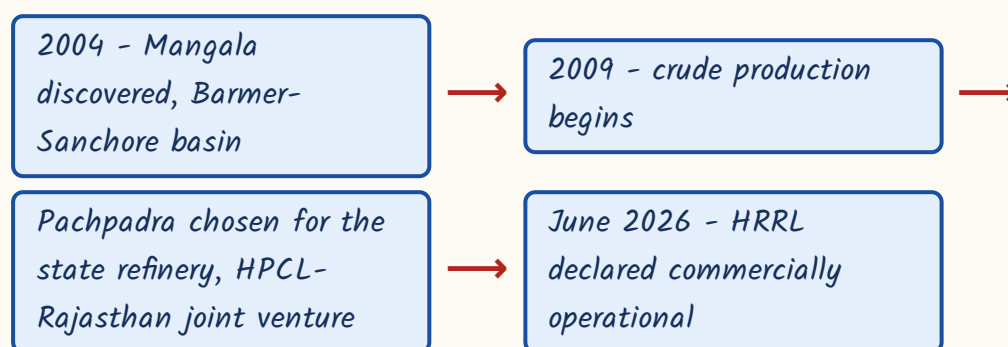
Lignite fields to districts - a standing matching question

Lignite field	District	Note
Palana	Bikaner	Rajasthan's OLDEST worked lignite field
Barsingsar	Bikaner	NLC lignite thermal power station here
Kapurdi	Barmer	Feeds the Barmer lignite thermal project
Jalipa	Barmer	Feeds the Barmer lignite thermal project
Giral	Barmer	Giral lignite power project
Matasukh, Kasnau	Nagaur	Smaller fields

Now the oil. In 2004 Cairn Energy struck oil at Mangala in the Barmer-Sanchore basin - the largest onshore discovery in India for decades. The block is RJ-ON-90/1. Production started in 2009, five years after discovery, and that gap between discovery and production is exactly the kind of detail RPSC checks with a wrong statement. The other fields in the same basin are Bhagyam, Aishwariya, Raageshwari and Saraswati. The operator is Cairn, now Vedanta.

- Petroleum - Barmer-Sanchore basin; block RJ-ON-90/1; operator Cairn / Vedanta.
- Mangala discovered 2004; production began 2009. Bhagyam and Aishwariya are the other big fields.
- Natural gas - Jaisalmer basin: Tanot, Dandewala, Bagitibba, Bhagewala, worked by ONGC.
- That Jaisalmer gas feeds the Ramgarh gas-based power station in Jaisalmer district.
- Remember the split: OIL is Barmer, GAS is Jaisalmer.

From discovery to refinery - the Barmer story in four steps



CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the HPCL Rajasthan Refinery Ltd (HRRL) at Pachpadra in BALOTRA district was declared commercially operational in June 2026. It is a 9 MMTPA refinery with a 2.4 MMTPA petrochemical complex. Shareholding is HPCL 74% and the Government of Rajasthan 26%. It is designed to process both Barmer basin crude and imported crude - so it is not an imported-crude-only refinery, which is how a wrong-statement question is built. This is the highest-probability new fact in the whole chapter. Note also that Pachpadra sits in BALOTRA district after the reorganisation, not Barmer district as older books say, and that Pachpadra has two identities - an old salt source and now the refinery site.

Conventional power - thermal, gas, hydel and nuclear

Thermal station to district is asked as regularly as mineral to district. Four names carry it. Suratgarh is the largest and is nicknamed Rajasthan's thermal power house. Kota Super Thermal was the first coal-based station in the state. Chhabra and Kalisindh are the two Hadoti-region stations that students constantly swap.

Power stations to districts - learn this cold

Station	District	Type / note
Suratgarh Super Thermal	Sri Ganganagar	Largest thermal station; 'thermal power house of Rajasthan'
Kota Super Thermal	Kota	The state's FIRST coal-based thermal station, on the Chambal
Chhabra	Baran	Has both subcritical and supercritical units
Kalisindh	Jhalawar	Two units of 600 MW each
Giral lignite	Barmer	Lignite-fired

Station	District	Type / note
Kapurdi-Jalipa (Barmer lignite project)	Barmer	Lignite-fired
Barsingsar (NLC)	Bikaner	Lignite-fired
Ramgarh	Jaisalmer	Gas-based, fed by Tanot and Dandewala gas
Dholpur combined-cycle	Dholpur	Gas-based
Rawatbhata Atomic Power Station	Chittorgarh	Nuclear, on the Chambal

Rawatbhata deserves a line of its own. It stands on the Chambal in Chittorgarh district and it is India's SECOND nuclear power station - Tarapur in Maharashtra was the first. Unit-1 was built with Canadian collaboration. That 'second, not first' point is asked directly. Rajasthan's hydel comes from the same river system: Rana Pratap Sagar and Jawahar Sagar on the Chambal, and Mahi Bajaj Sagar in Banswara.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2016 and again in 2023 as a matching set - Suratgarh to Sri Ganganagar, Chhabra to Baran, Kalisindh to Jhalawar, Rawatbhata to Chittorgarh. Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - Kapurdi and Jalipa lignite fields lie in which district? Answer: Barmer.

TRAP

Kalisindh is in JHALAWAR, not Kota - the river Kali Sindh flows through Jhalawar. Giral is in Barmer; Barsingsar is in Bikaner - both are lignite, so they get swapped. And Rawatbhata is India's SECOND nuclear station, never the first.

Renewable energy - where Rajasthan actually leads the country

This is the fastest-moving part of the chapter and RESEARCH says renewable energy in Rajasthan has been asked in every paper since 2016. The logic is simple and worth stating in one line: the Thar gives you the highest solar insolation in India plus vast cheap barren land, so solar goes where the desert is. Jodhpur, Jaisalmer, Bikaner and Barmer carry the state's solar and wind capacity.

- Rajasthan ranks FIRST among Indian states in installed SOLAR capacity - about 41.7 GW as of April 2026.
- But Rajasthan is SECOND in TOTAL renewable capacity, behind Gujarat, as of March 2026.
- Bhadla Solar Park - Bhadla village, PHALODI district (carved out of Jodhpur in 2023).
- Bhadla is about 2,245 MW spread over roughly 56 sq km - INDIA'S LARGEST solar park.
- Bhadla was built in four phases by several agencies - NTPC, SECI, ACME, Fortum, Avaada - not by RRECL alone.
- Wind energy hubs: Jaisalmer, Jodhpur and Barmer; Deogarh is another wind site.

TRAP

Two live traps. One: Bhadla is INDIA'S largest solar park. It was long described as the world's largest, but it has since been overtaken - as of 2026 say India's largest and you are safe. Two: first in SOLAR is not the same as first in RENEWABLES. Rajasthan is first in solar, second overall behind Gujarat as of March 2026. RPSC will offer both statements and ask which is correct.

Renewable energy institutions and policies

Name	What it is	Key detail
RRECL	Rajasthan Renewable Energy Corporation Ltd, Jaipur	The state NODAL AGENCY for solar, wind and biomass
Rajasthan Solar Energy Policy 2019	State policy	Framework for solar parks and land allotment
Rajasthan Integrated Clean Energy Policy 2024	State policy	The current umbrella clean-energy policy
PM-KUSUM (2019, MNRE)	Central scheme for solar in farming	A: grid plants on barren land; B: standalone solar pumps; C: solarising existing grid pumps
PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana (Feb 2024)	Central rooftop solar scheme	Up to 300 free units a month; target one crore households nationally

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2018 and again in 2021 - which is the nodal agency for renewable energy in Rajasthan? Answer: RRECL, the Rajasthan Renewable Energy Corporation Ltd, Jaipur. Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - Rajasthan's rank in installed solar capacity among Indian states? Answer: first.

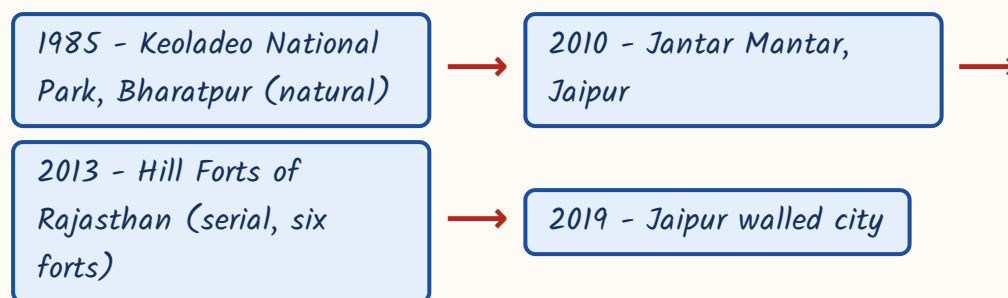
- Power sector structure: RVUNL generates, RVPNL transmits.
- Three discoms distribute - Jaipur, Ajmer and Jodhpur Vidyut Vitran Nigam Ltd.
- Remember the letter: pRasaran = transmission = RVPNL; utpadan = generation = RVUNL.
- PM-KUSUM's three components A, B and C are asked as a match - do not guess the order.

- Hook for PM-KUSUM: A for Area (barren-land plants), B for Bina-grid (standalone pumps), C for Converting existing grid pumps.

Tourism - the four UNESCO sites and the circuits

Rajasthan has exactly FOUR UNESCO World Heritage inscriptions. Learn them with their years, because RPSC asks the year and asks the count. One is natural, three are cultural. And one of the four - the Hill Forts - is itself a serial property of six forts, which gives a second layer of matching.

Rajasthan's UNESCO inscriptions in chronological order



The six Hill Forts of Rajasthan - fort to district

Fort	District	Note
Chittorgarh	Chittorgarh	The largest fort of the group
Kumbhalgarh	Rajsamand	Built by Rana Kumbha; the great wall
Ranthambore	Sawai Madhopur	Fort inside the tiger reserve
Gagron	Jhalawar	A jal-durg at the Ahu-Kali Sindh confluence
Amber	Jaipur	Kachhwaha capital before Jaipur city
Jaisalmer	Jaisalmer	The living fort of the desert

TRAP

Mehrangarh (Jodhpur) is NOT one of the six inscribed Hill Forts, however famous it is - that is the standard wrong option. And Rani ki Vav is a stepwell at Patan in GUJARAT, inscribed 2014, not a Rajasthan site. Jaipur's 2019 inscription made it India's second World Heritage city after Ahmedabad.

- RTDC - Rajasthan Tourism Development Corporation runs state tourism; slogan 'Padharo Mhare Desh'.
- Palace on Wheels flagged off 26 January 1982 by RTDC with Indian Railways.
- Royal Rajasthan on Wheels followed in 2009.
- Rajasthan Tourism Policy 2020; tourism was given INDUSTRY status in 2021.
- Heritage hotel scheme converts old havelis and palaces into hotels - a Rajasthan speciality.
- The state's tourist circuits include Desert, Mewar, Vagad, Dhundhar, Godwar, Merwara-Marwar, Brij-Mewat, Hadoti, Shekhawati and NCR.

You do not need every place in every circuit. Learn the anchor of each: Desert = Jaisalmer-Bikaner-Jodhpur-Barmer; Mewar = Udaipur-Chittorgarh-Nathdwara-Kumbhalgarh; Vagad = Dungarpur-Banswara-Beneshwar; Dhundhar = Jaipur-Dausa-Tonk; Godwar = Mount Abu-Ranakpur-Jalore; Hadoti = Kota-Bundi-Jhalawar-Baran; Shekhawati = Sikar-Jhunjhunu-Churu-Mandawa; Brij-Mewat = Alwar-Bharatpur-Deeg-Sariska. The circuit names match the cultural regions you already learnt in the physiography chapter, so this is nearly free.

Transport - rail, road, metro, air, and the last-minute sweep

Transport gives one clean question most years, and it is almost always a date or a name. Three dates carry it: the North Western Railway created on 1 October

2002, the Jaipur Metro opened on 3 June 2015, and Kishangarh airport starting commercial operations in 2017.

- North Western Railway - headquarters JAIPUR, created 1 October 2002.
- Its four divisions: Jaipur, Jodhpur, Ajmer and Bikaner.
- The Western Dedicated Freight Corridor crosses Rajasthan on its Rewari-Palanpur stretch.
- Jaipur Metro (JMRC) - Phase 1A Mansarovar to Chandpole opened 3 June 2015, the state's FIRST metro.
- Phase 1B extended it underground to Badi Chaupar in 2020; the Pink Line is about 12 km with 11 stations.
- Airports: Jaipur is the main international airport; others at Jodhpur, Udaipur (Dabok), Jaisalmer and Bikaner (Nal).
- Kishangarh in Ajmer district is Rajasthan's GREENFIELD airport, commercial operations from 2017.

National highways worth knowing by number

Highway	Route	Rajasthan stretch
NH-48 (old NH-8)	Delhi - Jaipur - Ajmer - Udaipur - Ahmedabad - Mumbai	Part of the Golden Quadrilateral's Delhi-Mumbai leg
NH-27	Porbandar - Silchar (East-West Corridor)	Enters via Udaipur-Chittorgarh-Kota
NH-58	Fatehpur - Nagaur - Ajmer - Beawar - Udaipur - Palanpur; 679 km	Runs the length of central Rajasthan
NH-62	Abohar - Sri Ganganagar - Bikaner - Jodhpur - Pali - Pindwara; 748 km	The western north-south spine
NH-11	Myajlar (Jaisalmer) - Pokaran - Phalodi - Bikaner - Fatehpur - Jhunjhunu - Rewari; 848 km	Runs across the desert into Haryana

- The Delhi-Mumbai Expressway is about 1,386 km; roughly 373 km of it - the LONGEST state stretch - lies in Rajasthan.
- The Amritsar-Jamnagar Economic Corridor also crosses western Rajasthan.
- Rajasthan's national highway network has crossed 10,000 km; the exact figure moves with each new declaration, so quote the current Economic Review.
- Road DENSITY in Rajasthan is below the national average - the state's huge area is the reason, not a shortage of roads.
- Rajasthan's state highways are managed by the PWD; RIDCOR builds mega-highways on a PPP model.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 and 2018 - the Mangala oil field belongs to which basin? Answer: the Barmer-Sanchore basin, discovered 2004. Transport and tourism questions in recent papers have run to the UNESCO count (four), the Hill Forts list, and the Jaipur Metro opening date.

YAAD RAKHO

Last-minute sweep for this chapter, five lines. Jhamar-Phosphate, Got-Gypsum, Zawar-Zinc, Degana-Tungsten. Suratgarh biggest thermal, Kota first coal, Kalisindh in Jhalawar, Rawatbhata second nuclear. Bhadla in Phalodi, India's largest solar park, RRECL the nodal agency. Four UNESCO sites: 1985, 2010, 2013, 2019. Pachpadra HRRL in Balotra, 9 MMTPA, commercial from June 2026.

REVISION RECAP

1. Rajasthan is India's SOLE producer of lead-zinc ore, wollastonite, selenite and jasper.
2. It leads India in gypsum, rock phosphate, silver, marble, calcite, soapstone, ball clay and sandstone.
3. Jhamar Kotra (Udaipur) - India's largest rock phosphate deposit, worked by RSMML.
4. Got-Manglodh and Bhadwasi (Nagaur) - gypsum. Sanu (Jaisalmer) - SMS-grade limestone.

5. Copper: Khetri-Singhana, Madan-Kudan, Kolihan in Jhunjhunu; also Kho-Dariba (Alwar) and Deri-Basantgarh (Sirohi).
6. Lead-zinc: Zawar (Udaipur, oldest zinc smelting), Rampura-Aguicha (Bhilwara, largest), Rajpura-Dariba and Sindesar Khurd (Rajsamand, largest silver mine).
7. Degana (Nagaur) tungsten; Bhukia-Jagpura (Banswara) gold; Rohil in Sikar and Jahaj in Bhilwara uranium.
8. Makrana white marble (now Didwana-Kuchaman); Rajsamand largest marble producer; Andhi green, Babarmal pink.
9. Mando ki Pal (Dungarpur) fluorite; Khera and Belka Pahar (Sirohi) wollastonite; Jalore is the granite city.
10. RSMML and Hindustan Zinc are both headquartered at Udaipur; HZL smelters at Debari, Chanderiya and Dariba.
11. Lignite: Palana and Barsingsar in Bikaner; Kapurdi, Jalpa and Giral in Barmer; Matasukh in Nagaur. Palana is the oldest.
12. Oil is Barmer-Sanchore - Mangala (2004, production 2009), Bhagyam, Aishwariya, block RJ-ON-90/I. Gas is Jaisalmer - Tanot, Dandewala.
13. HRRL Pachpadra, Balotra district - 9 MMTPA plus 2.4 MMTPA petrochemicals; HPCL 74%, Rajasthan 26%; commercially operational June 2026.
14. Thermal: Suratgarh (Sri Ganganagar) largest, Kota Super Thermal first coal-based, Chhabra (Baran), Kalisindh (Jhalawar).
15. Rawatbhata (Chittorgarh) is India's SECOND nuclear station; hydel at Rana Pratap Sagar, Jawahar Sagar, Mahi Bajaj Sagar.
16. Rajasthan is FIRST in installed solar (about 41.7 GW, April 2026) but SECOND in total renewables behind Gujarat (March 2026).
17. Bhadla Solar Park, Phalodi district - about 2,245 MW over 56 sq km, INDIA'S largest solar park. RRECL is the nodal agency.
18. Policies: Solar Energy Policy 2019, Integrated Clean Energy Policy 2024, PM-KUSUM A/B/C, PM Surya Ghar (300 free units).
19. Four UNESCO sites: Keoladeo 1985, Jantar Mantar 2010, Hill Forts 2013, Jaipur walled city 2019. Six Hill Forts - Chittorgarh, Kumbhalgarh, Ranthambore, Gagron, Amber, Jaisalmer.
20. Transport: North Western Railway HQ Jaipur (1 October 2002), Jaipur Metro 3 June 2015, Kishangarh greenfield airport, 373 km of the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway in Rajasthan.